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W E D N E S D A Y , S E P T E M B E R 2 3 , 2 0 2 6

Election nearing, Healey shifts on gas tax

Calls for a two-month halt after opposing for years; Minogue had called for ‘holiday’

By Kelly Garritty
and Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

For years, Governor Maura Healey has rejected the idea of suspending the state gas tax when the price at the pump was especially painful, echoing lawmakers and finance experts who saw such a move as a threat to the state’s financial footing.

Six weeks out from the general election, she’s changing her mind. Healey on Tuesday proposed in-

stituting a two-month moratorium on the 24-cents-a-gallon tax on gas and diesel, just days after her Republican opponent, Michael Minogue, called for a more sweeping “gas tax holiday” whenever prices top \$4 a gallon. Minogue is also undating the airways with commercials where he makes his pitch next to a gas pump as part of the former Abiomed executive’s seven-figure ad buy.

The GOP candidate, who trailed Healey by 25 percentage points in a

June Suffolk University/Boston Globe poll, was all too happy to paint Healey’s call to suspend the gas tax as politically motivated.

“She’s going to push everything to right after the election and go back to overtaxing our people right after the election,” he said outside the State House on Tuesday. “I’m glad she’s taking the lead, but unfortunately, she’s only planning to do it for two months. So after the election, it will be back to business as normal.”

The candidates’ dueling proposals come as gas prices have surged amid war in the Middle East, pushing gas to \$4.40 a gallon and diesel

to \$6.39 a gallon in Massachusetts as of Tuesday, according to AAA. Healey said Tuesday that her proposal, which her office estimated would cost the state about \$120 million, would be offset by using higher-than-expected revenue from the state’s surtax on high-income earners.

“This is a responsible thing to do, a necessary thing to do,” the first-term Democrat said at a news conference at the State House on Tuesday.

The proposal, however, not only drew the expected criticism from her Republican opponent, but im-

GAS, Page A10

MCAS scores still down across the board

High school English drop raises questions on prep

By Christopher Huffaker
and John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts student achievement has continued to decline on state tests, with Grade 10 English scores posting a particularly steep slide, according to MCAS results released Monday.

The findings show that students have not only failed to regain ground lost during the pandemic, but also have demonstrated little, if any, improvement since last year.

Slumping test scores spanned nearly all student demographics and school district types, from affluent suburbs to lower-income urban districts, stretching from Duxbury to Pittsfield. State Education Commissioner Pedro Martinez offered a blunt assessment of student achievement when he spoke Monday at a press briefing.

“We’re still not where we want to be,” Martinez said, “in terms of our results.”

Across the state, children in grades 3 to 8 scored on average about the same as their predecessors last year in math, while English results only slid slightly. But scores on both tests were far below pre-pandemic levels.

The drop in high school English scores year over year was much more significant. With MCAS no longer a graduation requirement, the results raised questions of whether high school students are less prepared academically or merely less motivated to do well on the test.

On the English exam, the share of 10th-graders meeting expectations fell by 6 points for a second year in a row, to 45 percent. Just five years ago, more than 60 percent of students passed the

MCAS, Page A7



PHOTOS BY CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

The South Boston Street Fest was held last weekend. Few neighborhoods have an array of income levels.

In South Boston, the line is drawn

Vast income disparities are worsening, further dividing the rich and poor

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

In a 1-mile stretch of South Boston, the city’s vast income disparities collide. The shimmering high-rises of the Seaport stand at one end, and just across West Broadway, block after block of three-story brick housing developments are on the other.

Southie resident John Meier sees the vast socioeconomic divide in the young professionals who pay a premium to get groceries delivered from Whole Foods just blocks away from residents who rely on food pantries to feed their families.

It really hit home for Meier, 43, a decade ago when he found out one of his high school students lived in a public housing complex near him. When he told the student they were neighbors, Meier recalled, “He laughed and said, ‘I’m not your neighbor.’”

West Broadway marks the dividing line between the affluent, where the median family income is more than \$250,000, and the underprivileged, where it’s just \$60,000. It’s one of the starkest contrasts in Greater Boston, which is among the

SOUTH BOSTON, Page A10



The Rev. Burns Stanfield, pastor of Fourth Presbyterian Church, mourns the loss of school-age children as parents leave for the suburbs.

With fantasy football, Commish really rules

BETH TEITELL

The tweet came from an account on X that usually gets one or two likes per post, tops. But then, a few days into the NFL season, a formerly private citizen named Harrison Hughes tapped into a matter so raw, so profound — of such cultural importance — that he went viral.

“It’s kinda [messed] up that teachers get paid more than Fantasy Football Commissioners,” wrote Hughes, 30, a sales executive at an AI company.

The love came fast. “Commissioners need to start a union,” read one popular response. “Completely thankless job,” read another.

There may be no harder gig in America than fantasy football commissioner — at least according to the commissioners.

There are approximately 40 million

FANTASY, Page A6

Mistakes are made as marketing speeds up

Issues of judgment may reflect ad agencies’ struggles to keep pace

By Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF

The outcry over Converse’s latest social media ad from critics who said it echoed Ku Klux Klan iconography is just the latest in a recent string of advertising controversies that all follow a similar pattern: mounting criticism, the hurried apology, and the pledge to be better.

“We’re sorry,” said Converse, owned by Nike, in a statement. “We understand why this image is deeply upsetting and recognize that we got this wrong.”

“This should not have happened and we will do better,” added the company, which pulled the ad from its channels.

It all sounded rather familiar.

From a controversial Callaway golf commercial depicting violence against women to a Sydney Sweeney sports-betting campaign criticized for its portrayal of women, quite a few brands of

late have had to beg forgiveness for ads that left many wondering how on Earth multiple layers of creative and corporate review allowed such a thing to go public.

The answer, some experts say, may have less to do with one person making a bad call than with the hurried way modern advertising gets made amid the brutal pace of social media.

Yanique DaCosta, a brand development consultant and president of the Graphic Artists Guild who has worked on corporate creative for Apple, Google, Hilton, and Marriott, said advertising teams are producing more work on tighter deadlines, with each department often reviewing only its own piece of the campaign, not

CONVERSE, Page A7



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Converse, with headquarters in Boston, has seen its revenues tumble over the past two years. The pulled ad with KKK connotations could hurt the brand.



Falling for it

Wednesday: Breezy, pleasant. High 61-66. Low 50-55.

Thursday: More of the same. High 60-65. Low 52-57.
High tide: 9:39 a.m., 9:49 p.m.
Sunrise: 6:32 Sunset: 6:40

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

VOL. 310, NO. 85

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



The Nation

Mental health of teens is improving, CDC finds

Data show declines in sadness, suicidal behavior in 2025

By Azeen Ghorayshi
NEW YORK TIMES
ATLANTA — After hitting its lowest levels in a decade in 2021, teenage mental health is showing significant improvements, according to new data released by the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention.

Continuing a trend first observed in 2023, teenagers surveyed at high schools across the country in 2025 reported improvements in several key measures, including persistent feelings of sadness or hopelessness, serious thoughts of suicide, and attempting suicide in the last year.

But the data, released Monday, show that many teenagers, especially girls and teenagers who identify as lesbian, gay, or bisexual, are still struggling. Thirty-three percent of high school students reported persistent feelings of sadness or hopelessness in the last 12 months, down from a peak of 42 percent in 2021. Fourteen percent of teenagers reported that they had seriously considered attempting suicide, down from 22 percent in 2021.

“Those declines in depression and suicidal thoughts are very

striking, particularly that they’re lower than 2019,” said Jean Twenge, a psychologist at San Diego State University who has studied the mental health impacts of smartphones and social media use on teenagers. “This isn’t just post pandemic anymore, this is a more long-standing trend in improvement.”

The CDC’s Youth Risk Behavior Survey has been conducted at high schools across the country every two years since 1991. Rates of mental health issues in teenagers had gone up in the data set every year since 2011.

Twenge noted that the steady increases in mental health problems in young people were visible in other data sets as well starting around that time, including data on clinical depression diagnoses and emergency room visits resulting from self harm or attempted suicide.

The pandemic “just took it to that next level of concern and just really, really high numbers,” she said. “That’s why it’s so striking here to see these declines. It’s not just, OK, we’re coming out of COVID and obviously things are getting better for teens.”

The data show that interven-

tions to improve teenage mental health in schools helped, said Kathleen Ethier, former director of the Division of Adolescent and School Health at the CDC.

“There were really incredible efforts to focus on mental health for young people, particularly in schools, and it looks to me like that’s working,” Ethier said. “COVID and the disconnection from school absolutely affected those numbers in 2021 and 2023. What we’re seeing now is a rebound, and that’s wonderful.”

This is the first iteration of the survey to be released under Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.

Survey data on gender identity, which was included for the first time in the 2023 survey, was removed in 2025 in order to comply with President Trump’s executive order requiring the federal government to recognize only two sexes, male and female.

The new data continued to show a trend seen in previous surveys finding that teenagers who identified as lesbian, gay, or bisexual reported worse mental health outcomes than their peers. Nearly 60 percent of lesbian, gay, or bisexual teenagers reported



KENDRICK BRINSON/NEW YORK TIMES/FILE

The CDC’s survey showed worse mental health outcomes for girls and queer young people.

persistent feelings of sadness in the last year, compared with 28 percent of heterosexual teens. And 32 percent reported seriously considering attempting suicide, compared with 11 percent of heterosexual students.

Girls were more likely than boys to report negative mental health. Nearly 43 percent of girls said they felt persistent sadness

over the last year, compared with 24 percent of boys.

The report showed a continuation of some other long-standing trends. Nineteen percent of teenagers reported being sexually active, a steady decline from nearly 38 percent when the survey was first offered in 1991. Twenty percent reported currently drinking alcohol, com-

pared with nearly 51 percent in 1991, and fewer than 10 percent reported using illicit drugs, compared with 27 percent when the question was first asked in 2001.

Thirty-six percent of teenagers said that they used social media every hour or more, a similar percentage to what was seen in 2023, when the data was first reported.

DAILY BRIEFING



MARTA LAVANDIER/ASSOCIATED PRESS

WAITING GAME — Jelen Gutierrez held her 1-year-old daughter Amanda Poldete as a security guard called out the names of those with upcoming appointments at the Miami Immigration Court on Tuesday in Miami.

Woman’s death after Bronx wellness spa injection ruled a homicide

NEW YORK — The death of a 27-year-old woman who was injected with a substance at a Bronx wellness center in July has been ruled a homicide, according to a spokesperson from the city medical examiner’s office.

The woman, Elizabeth Baron, of the Bronx, died from a cardiac air embolism, according to the autopsy results. An embolism can occur when air en-

ters an intravenous catheter, and the gas travels straight to the heart.

The ruling paves the way for prosecutors to seek more serious charges against the man, Luis Rojas Cabrera, who administered Baron an intravenous infusion of nicotinamide adenine dinucleotide, or NAD+, in July. Baron died about an hour after receiving the infusion.

Cabrera pleaded not guilty

that month to reckless endangerment and unauthorized practice of a profession. It was unclear Monday whether he had been charged with additional crimes.

Cabrera’s lawyer, Donald Vogelmann, said Monday that “a homicide is not necessarily a murder but may be caused by an accident.”

“Homicide is defined as the taking of a person’s life, regard-

less of the intent or the circumstances surrounding the death,” he said. “In this case, if there was a homicide, it was caused by an accident.”

NAD+ is a molecule found in cells that is critical for energy production. NAD+ has become a popular longevity supplement, but there is little evidence it works in humans, and its use is largely unregulated.

NEW YORK TIMES

Actor died from accidental overdose

Actor Hayden Panettiere died from an accidental overdose of several drugs, including fentanyl, a coroner in South Carolina said Tuesday.

Panettiere, 36, was found unresponsive in an apartment in Greenville, S.C., on Aug. 16. Her on-and-off boyfriend Brian Hickerson and his brother Zach Hickerson were at the home.

According to a statement from the Greenville County Coroner’s Office, a combination of fentanyl and its chemical byproduct, as well as the anti-anxiety medication alprazolam, a muscle relaxer and a drug used to treat major depression and other serious mental health disorders, were found in Panettiere’s system.



Hayden Panettiere

The office did not include further details from the autopsy report in its initial release.

Asked for comment on the coroner’s report, Kasey Kitchen, a publicist for the family, told the Associated Press that “the investigation is still ongoing and the case is complex.”

Greenville police confirmed Tuesday that their investigation into Panettiere’s death is continuing.

Paramedics responded to Panettiere’s apartment last month after a 911 call and performed CPR and other advanced resuscitation efforts for more than 40 minutes before she was declared dead.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Fat Bear Week opens in Alaska

ANCHORAGE — After a summer spent packing away sockeye salmon, Alaska’s heftiest brown bears are ready to throw their weight around.

Online voting began Tuesday for Fat Bear Week, the annual contest that pits the round residents of Katmai National Park and Preserve against each other for the title of most oversized ursine.

Last year’s winner, Chunk — known officially as Bear 32 — is hungry for a repeat. Chunk’s weight in 2025 was estimated at 1,200 pounds, which gave him a narrow victory. This year he’s back and facing corpulent competition like Gully — aka Bear 903 — the offspring of two-time champion Grazer.

The contest, which is in its 12th year, celebrates the resilience of the 2,200 brown bears that live in the preserve on the

Alaska Peninsula, which extends from the state’s southwest corner toward the Aleutian Islands. Fat Bear Week was started in 2014 as an interactive way to inform the public about brown bears, the coastal cousins of grizzlies.

The event this year features 16 bears facing off in a single-elimination, bracket-style tournament. All voting is done online at www.fatbearweek.org, with the winner declared Sept. 29. The public can watch the bears on explore.org’s live-stream cameras before deciding on their favorite.

“Fat bears are successful bears,” the nonprofit’s website says. They gorge on the abundant salmon that return to the Brooks River starting in late June in order to accumulate fat reserves.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

New research offers hope for detecting CTE in the living

Scientists seek tools to confirm, treat brain illness

By Andrew Jacobs

NEW YORK TIMES

How do you fight an illness you can’t diagnose?

In recent years, hundreds of people, most of them professional football players, have been diagnosed with CTE, or chronic traumatic encephalopathy, which is associated with repeated impacts to the head.

But in every case, the diagnosis has been made through an autopsy. The inability to confirm the presence of the disease in living patients has been an enormous impediment to finding treatments for their memory loss, volatile mood swings, and erratic behavior.

Now, two decades after CTE was first discovered, scientists believe they are closing in on tools that can identify the disease in living patients. A diagnostic test would help scientists figure out who is at risk — high school athletes? soccer players? — and whether potential interventions are effective.

The urgency for such a test has intensified following the publication last month of a study that found that at least a quarter of NFL players who died from 2016 to 2021 might have had CTE. Some experts, citing the limitations of the study, said the true rate may be far higher.

“You can’t really help a patient if you can only tell them they have the disease when they’re dead,” said Dr. Julian Bailes, a neurosurgeon in Evanston, Ill., who is widely considered a pioneer in the field.

The tests furthest along in development are PET scans, which are already used to diagnose brain conditions such as Alzheimer’s disease and dementia and to monitor the progression of cancer and heart disease. But CTE has proved a more elusive foe.

Scientists believe repeated blows to the head jolt the brain and injure the nerve fibers that connect different parts of the brain and facilitate communication between them.

In a normal brain, so-called tau proteins help keep nerve cells stable and structured. But the repeated trauma experienced by football players, wrestlers, and military personnel can cause tau to change shape, forming abnormal clusters around blood vessels and inside neurons.

The affected cells eventually die, causing the brain to shrink and waste away.

The unique shape of tau found in CTE patients has forced researchers to create diagnostic tools from the ground up, said Neil Vasdev, director of the Brain Health Imaging Centre in Toronto. Much of that work, he said, has involved the development of radiochemistry tracers that can bind themselves to CTE tau, allowing it to be seen on PET scans.

“Almost all the existing scanning tools were optimized or designed and built for imaging the Alzheimer’s tau shape, so you can think of it as having the wrong key for the lock,” said Vasdev, who has spent three decades working on PET imaging agents for neurodegenerative diseases.

Most candidate tracers have failed. But last year Vasdev’s team demonstrated that a new tracer, OXD-2314, was able to enter the brains of living volunteers without any adverse effects. Vasdev and his colleagues have begun testing the tracer in patients with accumulations of tau in their brains.

Working with researchers at UCLA, Bailes has taken a similar tack, developing a biomarker that makes CTE’s abnormal tau visible on PET scans. A Phase 3 clinical trial is now underway to determine whether the scan is an effective diagnostic.

A PET scan is a complex and expensive diagnostic technique. So scientists are also working on simple blood tests that detect the neuron damage and inflammation associated with CTE.

A team of researchers at Boston University has been collecting blood samples from hundreds of people at risk for the disease who also have agreed to donate their brains, said Dr. Michael Alosco, codirector of clinical research at the CTE Research Center at Boston University.

He is leading a number of studies that seek to match biomarkers found in the blood of these people to evidence of CTE found in their brains at autopsy.

Despite the lack of effective treatments, patients and their families say having a definitive diagnosis would help explain, and prepare for, the erratic behavior and memory lapses that are among the hallmarks of CTE.

Currently, doctors reach a diagnosis in living patients only through a process of elimination. Even then, a diagnosis is considered “nondefinitive” and requires confirmation after a patient’s death through autopsy.

AN OPEN LETTER FROM OVER 120 OF THE WORLD’S LEADING CHEFS

To our fellow chefs:

Nobody ordered this.

Salmon was once cooked seasonally. Wild salmon returned from the sea to rivers in such numbers that the water seemed alive with them. Yet since the 1970s, many **wild salmon populations have collapsed by 80% or more. Wild Atlantic salmon in particular could disappear in our lifetime.**

The loss is easy to miss. Salmon has never seemed more abundant.

But this abundance is manufactured, and it comes at a great cost. Today, **99% of Atlantic salmon served in restaurants and grocery stores is raised in industrial sea cages**, often in the same waters wild salmon must pass through to survive.

Ocean-farmed salmon has become one of the greatest threats to wild salmon’s future.

Because these crowded cages are open, they pollute surrounding waters; waste does not stay contained. Nor do sea lice parasites, disease, or chemical treatments. Sea lice spread from farms to vulnerable young wild salmon. When nets break, farmed fish escape and breed with wild salmon, weakening the genetic inheritance they depend on to survive.

The impact extends beyond the cages. Feeding one ocean-farmed salmon requires hundreds of ground-up wild fish that marine life and vulnerable subsistence communities depend on.

Then there is the product itself. Its color is synthetic, engineered to match the pink we expect, and it is often marketed with unjustified claims of sustainability.

Ocean-farmed salmon should never have existed at this scale. Not when the cost is wild salmon and all that depends on them.

Empty rivers mean less food for bears, eagles, and otters — and traditions lost before they can be passed down.

Communities seeing these effects firsthand are already taking a stand.

Chefs can, too. **We commit to not serving ocean-farmed salmon until the industry can operate without causing this harm. And we are asking chefs and restaurants around the world to join us.**

Our decisions shape what diners value, what suppliers prioritize, and ultimately which foods — and species — survive.

Every menu is a choice about what belongs on our tables. Ocean-farmed salmon does not — not as long as it continues to cause this kind of harm.

Let’s take it off the table.

With hope,

Francis Mallmann
Patagonia, Argentina

Virgilio Martinez
Central
Lima, Peru

Michael Cimarusti
Providence
Los Angeles, California

Gabriela Cámara
Contramar
Mexico City, Mexico

Heinz Reitbauer
Steirereck im Stadtpark
Vienna, Austria

Darina Allen
Ballymaloe
Shanagarry, Ireland

Manu Buffara
Restaurante Manu
Curitiba, Brazil

Peter Tempelhoff
FYN Restaurant
Cape Town, South Africa

Kyumin Hahn
Kadeau
Copenhagen, Denmark

Jessica Rosval
Al Gatto Verde
Modena, Italy

Jeremy Lee
Quo Vadis
London, England

Bernt Sætre
Under
Lindesnes, Norway

Elizabeth Falkner
Los Angeles, California

Tashi Gyamtso
JIMGU
Oita, Japan

Pierce Abernathy
New York, New York

Tomer Blechman
Theodora
New York, New York

Mitsuo Nakajima
Kyoyamato
Kyoto, Japan

Omar Tate
Honeysuckle
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania

Thomas Imbusch
100/200 Kitchen
Hamburg, Germany

Sophie Lehmann
100/200 Kitchen
Hamburg, Germany

Hwoo Lee
Los Angeles, California

Alice Waters
Chez Panisse
Berkeley, California

Mitsuharu Tsumura
Maido
Lima, Peru

Pia León
Kjolle
Lima, Peru

Norbert Niederkofler
Atelier Moessler Norbert Niederkofler
Brunico, Italy

Elena Reygadas
Rosetta
Mexico City, Mexico

Sam Kass
Chicago, Illinois

Emmanuel Renaut
Flocons de Sel
Megève, France

Riad Nasr
Le Veau d’Or, Frenchette
New York, New York

Serigne Mbaye
Dakar NOLA
New Orleans, Louisiana

Alon Shaya
Saba
New Orleans, Louisiana

Gunnar Karl Gislason
Dill Restaurant
Reykjavik, Iceland

Gisli Matthías Auðunsson
NÆS
Vestmannaeyjar, Iceland

António Galapito
Prado
Lisbon, Portugal

Chantelle Nicholson
Apricite
London, England

Simon Furley
Bangalay Dining
Shoalhaven Heads, Australia

Brian Limoges
Enclos
Sonoma, California

Woolery Back
Table & Main
Roswell, Georgia

Cybill St. Aude-Tate
Honeysuckle
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania

Charlie Ebell
The Little Seed
Tasmania, Australia

Peter Clarke
The Little Seed
Tasmania, Australia

Sarah Clare
Tasmania, Australia

Dan Barber
Blue Hill at Stone Barns
Tarrytown, New York

Rasmus Kofoed
Geranium
Copenhagen, Denmark

Dominique Crenn
Atelier Crenn
San Francisco, California

Enrique Olvera
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Mexico City, Mexico

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Lincoln, Canada

Stefano Secchi
Rezdóra
New York, New York

Jordy Navarra
Toyo Eatery
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Kobi Ruzika
Dier Makr
Tasmania, Australia

Julián Galende
Alcanfor
Buenos Aires, Argentina

Kevin Vincent
Newfound Sushi Izakaya
Newfoundland, Canada

Massimo Bottura
Osteria Francescana
Modena, Italy

Josh Niland
Saint Peter
Sydney, Australia

Narda Lepes
Narda Comedor
Buenos Aires, Argentina

Jeremy Charles
Newfoundland, Canada

Hugh Fearnley-Whittingstall
Dorset, England

Rafa Costa e Silva
Lasai
Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

Alberto Landgraf
Oteque
Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

Mary Sue Milliken
Border Grill
Las Vegas, Nevada

Steven Satterfield
Miller Union
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Eric Robertson
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Lincoln, Canada

Matthew Kammerer
The Harbor House Inn
Elk, California

Matthew Raiford
Brunswick, Georgia

Kerry Heffernan
Grand Banks
New York, New York

Sam Lawrence
Bridges
New York, New York

David Bies
Ticonderoga Club
Atlanta, Georgia

Matt Taylor
Affinity Fish
Toronto, Canada

Jacob Potashnick
Feld
Chicago, Illinois

Matias Sallaberry
South Fire
Victoria, Canada

Chris Velden
The Flying Apron
Summerville, Canada

Julián Díaz
Los Galgos
Buenos Aires, Argentina

Martin Molteni
Puratierra
Buenos Aires, Argentina

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El Celler de Can Roca
Girona, Spain

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Mark Bittman
Community Kitchen
New York, New York

Susan Feniger
Border Grill
Las Vegas, Nevada

Þráinn Freyr Vigfússon
ÖX
Reykjavik, Iceland

Drew Deckman
Deckman’s En El Mogor
Valle de Guadalupe, Mexico

Sally Clarke
Clarke’s
London, England

José Luis Hinostroza
Arca
Tulum, Mexico

Ed Kenney
Mud Hen Water
Honolulu, Hawaii

Agnar Sverrisson
Moss
Grindavik, Iceland

Matthew Evans
Fat Pig Farm
Tasmania, Australia

Jon Klip
Affinity Fish
Toronto, Canada

Daniel de La Falaise
Toulouse, France

Burt Bakman
Trudy’s Underground Barbecue
Los Angeles, California

Nathan Flaim
Luca
Lancaster, Pennsylvania

Musashi Osaki
New York, New York

Luiz Filipe Souza
Evvai
São Paulo, Brazil

Mauro Colagreco
Mirazur
Menton, France

Ángel León
Aponiente
El Puerto de Santa María, Spain

Grant Achatz
Alinea
Chicago, Illinois

Brandon Jew
Mister Jiu’s
San Francisco, California

Eneko Atxa
Azurmendi
Larrabetzu, Spain

Daniel Patterson
Jacaranda
Los Angeles, California

Antonia Klugmann
L’Argine a Vencò
Dolegna del Collio, Italy

David Barzelay
Lazy Bear
San Francisco, California

François-Emmanuel Nicol
Tanière³
Quebec City, Canada

Cristina Martinez
Casa México & South Philly Barbacoa
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania

Hugo Ortega
Hugo’s
Houston, Texas

Peter McKenna
Eleven Fifty Five
Glasgow, Scotland

Inés Páez Nin
Aguají
Sosúa, Dominican Republic

Samuel Jett
Audrey
Nashville, Tennessee

Massimo Falsini
Caruso’s
Montecito, California

Nichole Accettola
Kantine
San Francisco, California

Simon Ford
Marefold
Tasmania, Australia

Analiiese Gregory
Lumachelle
Tasmania, Australia

Taylor Mason
Luca
Lancaster, Pennsylvania

Sylvan Mishima Brackett
Rintaro
San Francisco, California

The World

Biggest threat is still climate change, not AI

But little matters in worst scenario: human extinction

By Chico Harlan
NEW YORK TIMES

New warnings that humans are flirting with out-of-control artificial intelligence raise an uneasy question: Has AI surpassed climate change as one of humanity’s gravest risks?

Although the danger of the technology is hard to assess, the worst-case scenario — human extinction — makes other earthly concerns seem small.

Yes, climate change is creating dangerously hot conditions, fueling superstorms and killing crops, and it may lead to planetary upheaval. But that only matters if our civilization is still recognizable.

“In terms of things that could be the end of humanity, I think AI is a bigger risk,” said Toby Ord, a researcher at Oxford University and author of “The Precipice: Existential Risk and the Future of Humanity.”

All of this leaves climate activists competing for a finite pool of political consideration. As diplomats and world leaders gather at the United Nations this week to grapple with the planet’s most pressing problems, some worry that global warming could be overlooked even as it worsens.

When President Xi Jinping of China meets in Washington on Thursday with President Trump, the leaders of the countries that produce the most greenhouse gases are expected to discuss AI safety, among other issues. Climate change, which Trump dismisses as a “con job,” is unlikely to be on the agenda.

Leah Stokes, a professor of environmental politics at University of California Santa Barbara, wrote last week that AI was “eating up all our attention” and argued that climate change posed the more concrete danger, citing deadly heat waves in Europe this summer and a horrific glacier collapse last month in Nepal.

“Unlike AI, climate change’s

existential threat is not hypothetical. It is killing people now,” Stokes wrote. “It also feels like a lot of people have conveniently forgotten about the urgency of solving this problem.”

Humans are notoriously poor at assessing dangers, and in the case of artificial intelligence, the risks are largely speculative at this point. Even the boldest AI extinction predictions often say little about how the disaster could unfold.

Climate change, on the other hand, is full of knowns. The science linking fossil fuel emissions and global temperature rise is long-established and irrefutable. The solutions to help curb emissions, such as solar energy and electric vehicles, are proven and abundant. At the global level, the annual conferences aimed at averting the crisis have become a fixture on the international calendar, replete with scientific and political jargon along with diplomatic wrangling over long-term action plans.

That may make them feel more bureaucratic than existential — but they’ve proved meaningful.

As threats to humanity, AI and climate change have some notable links.

In both cases, the risks stem from human-made pursuits, whether it’s the development of advanced computer “frontier models” or the burning of fossil fuels that powers the modern global economy. And in both cases giant companies (trillion-dollar tech firms or globe-spanning energy giants) hold outside influence over the course of history.

AI has the potential to be a tool in the fight against climate change. It could design more sophisticated warning systems for disasters, for example, or dream up innovations that ease global water shortages.

But in the short-term, at least, AI is making it more difficult to cut greenhouse gas emissions. That’s because it is increasing energy needs, with electricity consumption from AI data centers surging 50 percent last year, according to the International Energy Agency.



CRISTINA MATUOZZI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Demonstrators waved flags as they criticized the Iranian regime outside the UN headquarters in New York on Tuesday.

After threat, US, Iranian officials meet

At UN, Trump warns he may ‘annihilate’ Iran

By Aamer Madhani, Farnoush Amiri, and Edith M. Lederer
ASSOCIATED PRESS

UNITED NATIONS — President Trump said US and Iranian officials met on Tuesday, an unexpected engagement that came even as he threatened in his address to the UN General Assembly that he may “annihilate” the Islamic Republic if a deal isn’t reached soon to end the nearly seven-month war.

Trump told reporters that his chief envoys, Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, met with the Iranian officials on the sidelines of the annual gathering of world leaders, but he offered few details about how the discussions transpired or the substance of the exchange.

“It was a very good meeting,” Trump said. The president later added that the Iranian officials were “not the highest level, but it’s something.”

The engagement comes after months of US-Iran communications languishing following the

collapse of a short-lived ceasefire that was brokered in June. US and Iranian negotiators met separately with Qatari and Pakistani mediators in Doha in early July for indirect talks.

Earlier Tuesday, Secretary of State Marco Rubio said that Trump is open to meeting with Iran’s president, Masoud Pezeshkian, while he’s in New York for the General Assembly.

Trump also met on Tuesday with leaders and senior officials from Gulf Cooperation Council nations — Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, and United Arab Emirates — as well as Jordan to discuss the way ahead with the war in Iran.

In his address to the General Assembly, Trump made the case that he’s shown fortitude while other leaders have equivocated as he defended his decision to start a war with Iran.

But Trump also suggested that he could be at a crossroads in the conflict even as he called on the Islamic Republic to fully reopen the Strait of Hormuz and return to the negotiating table to find a settlement to end the conflict.

“I have a big decision to make,” Trump said. “Will a deal be made with Iran that lets

them rebuild and create a far greater country than it ever was before, maybe one of the greatest in the Middle East or even the world. Or do I annihilate the Islamic Republic and do it quickly, never giving them a chance to kill and destroy people and countries again?”

The president’s comments came in his wide-ranging address to the international body in which he also celebrated this year’s US military operation to oust Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro from power and a new pact to expand the US military presence in Greenland, and pushed back against calls for greater regulation of the artificial intelligence industry.

But at the heart of the address was a fulsome defense of the war and pushback on the notion that Iran has shown a measure of resilience.

Most of Iran’s delegation walked out of the chamber as Trump railed against the Islamic Republic.

Trump also held talks with new British Prime Minister Andy Burnham, Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi, and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky. He’s expected to hold a more informal meeting on

Tuesday evening with Venezuela’s acting President Delcy Rodríguez, according to the White House.

Trump also took part in an event on the Shield of Americas, an initiative Trump launched with Latin American countries earlier this year focused on combatting violent cartels.

The visit to the UN comes as Trump’s foreign policy approach — particularly his decision to start a war with Iran — has become a drag on his fellow Republicans’ hopes of retaining control of both chambers of Congress during the coming midterm elections.

In last year’s address at the UN, Trump claimed the United States had “demolished” Iran’s nuclear capabilities after he ordered the June 2025 bombardment of three key facilities. He returned to the General Assembly nearing the seven-month mark of a new war against Iran.

In his address, the president also touched on Russia’s continuing war against Ukraine — a conflict that during his 2024 campaign he predicted would be resolved on Day One of his second term. He once again expressed hope that the conflict will soon be resolved.

DAILY BRIEFING

Pope will meet with French abuse survivors

PARIS — Pope Leo XIV, during his four-day visit to France beginning Friday, will meet privately with seven survivors of sexual abuse by priests and other Catholic personnel. The outcome will be closely watched by critics who say the church hasn’t done enough to confront the problem.

The meeting is scheduled for Sunday in Lourdes, one of Catholicism’s most important pilgrimage sites. Some survivors’ groups have criticized the decision to select individuals rather than representatives of established organizations.

The seven survivors said in a joint statement last week that they don’t claim to represent all survivors.

“Engaging in dialogue does not mean endorsing,” they said. “Being received does not mean abandoning our demands.”

“Each of us is taking part in this meeting in our own name, free to express our own views, convictions and choices,” the survivors said.

The French Bishops’ Conference said that the group includes people who were abused as minors or adults in Catholic schools, parishes, and religious congregations.

In recent years, the French Catholic Church has established an independent compensation system for survivors.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Sri Lankan court sentences 15 men to life in prison for roles in 2019 bombings

COLOMBO, Sri Lanka — A Sri Lankan court convicted 15 men on Tuesday over their involvement in the 2019 Easter bombings that killed more than 260 people, and sentenced them each to 200 years in prison, meaning they will spend the rest of their lives behind bars.

The three-judge High Court panel also ordered the property of the defendants confiscated. The verdict was delivered amid tight security, with hundreds of police officers deployed around the courthouse, following a lengthy trial that spanned nearly five years.

The April 21 attacks targeted three churches and three hotels across the island nation during Easter services and celebrations, and they also wounded about 500 people. The bombings, which were inspired by the Islamic State group, were among the deadliest attacks in Sri Lanka’s history. They killed 42 foreigners and devastated communities across the country.

All the convicted men were



ISHARA S. KODIKARA/APP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Police escorted one of the defendants during the trial at the Colombo High Court on Tuesday.

from Sri Lanka’s minority Muslim community.

Authorities filed 23,270 charges in 2021 against 24 sus-

pects accused of planning or inspiring the attacks. The charges included murder, conspiracy to commit terrorism, and firearms

and explosives offenses under the Prevention of Terrorism Act.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Amateur archaeologist finds Germany’s biggest hoard of Roman coins

BERLIN — An amateur archaeologist who discovered several Roman silver coins in a field in western Germany realized he had stumbled upon something bigger when his metal detector kept beeping.

Oliver Riedl called the authorities for help, and a group of

experts who began digging immediately discovered a total of 934 Roman silver denarii. It is the biggest coin treasure ever found in Germany from the time of Roman Emperor Hadrian, the local office in charge of archaeological monuments said Tuesday.

“It was clear to me that there

was something bigger buried here,” Riedl said, describing how his metal detector continued signaling even after he had found several coins near Wesseling, south of Cologne, a year ago.

The hoard of coins, which weighs 6.8 pounds, went on display at the LVR-LandesMuseum

Bonn on Tuesday.

The collection of coins was probably buried deliberately in the second quarter of the second century A.D., according to the LVR Office for the Preservation of Archaeological Monuments in the Rhineland.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Hurricane rapidly strengthens off coast of Mexico

A tropical system that barely existed a day ago has quickly intensified off the coast of Mexico, and officials are warning that the storm could bring dangerous conditions to the region this week.

Polo is a relatively small storm, but its explosive intensification — from tropical storm to Category 5 hurricane in less than a day — has drawn the sharp attention of forecasters at the US National Hurricane Center, who warned it was likely to grow even stronger.

“The intensification rate over the past 24 hours is truly remarkable,” the forecasters wrote in an overnight update.

The storm’s anticipated trajectory was more uncertain than its intensity Tuesday.

Forecasters urged residents to monitor subtle shifts in the track while Polo drifted offshore of southwestern Mexico, where the Mexican government issued tropical storm watches. The storm was expected to turn northwest later Tuesday and Wednesday, away from land, but its core of severe winds and torrential rain could brush closer to the coastline.

By Thursday, Hurricane Polo was expected to make its closest approach to the mainland before veering toward the Baja California peninsula.

NEW YORK TIMES



ALLISON ROBERT/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A PROTEST ABOVE — A demonstrator scaled a light pole and unfurled a banner to protest the upcoming state visit by China’s President Xi Jinping as members of the National Guard walked by Tuesday in Washington. President Trump is hosting Xi this week as their economic and tech competition escalates.

Thousands ejected from Obamacare

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration has ejected more than 750,000 enrollees from the Affordable Care Act insurance marketplaces, Vice President JD Vance announced Tuesday, claiming that many were receiving premium subsidies they did not qualify for and that some were not even real people.

“We’re actually making sure that the people receiving Obamacare subsidies are actually entitled to receive them,” Vance said at a news conference. He estimated that removing the Obamacare enrollees would save the government \$2.2 billion.

The announcement is the latest initiative by an antifraud task force Vance leads that has often turned its efforts toward federal health care programs. In recent months, the task force has been involved in withholding billions in Medicaid funding from Minnesota and California, contending that the states have not adequately combated fraud.

Governors have criticized the Trump administration’s anti-fraud work as politically motivated, often targeting states with Democratic leadership.

The enrollees that the Trump administration plans to remove account for about 4 percent of the 19 million Americans who receive coverage through the marketplaces created by the Affordable Care Act, also known as Obamacare.

Vance said the 750,000 who would lose coverage were a mix

of people who either did not meet the eligibility requirements or did not even exist. The administration plans to do more research on an additional 440,000 people who may also fall into one of those categories.

Enrollment in coverage sold in the Affordable Care Act marketplaces had already fallen by several million this year, after Congress allowed extra subsidies that helped people buy coverage to expire. Prices rose substantially, and many low-income Americans lost access to free coverage. Early filings from insurers suggest that prices will increase substantially again next year.

NEW YORK TIMES

Republicans in tight Senate races call for end to Iran war

WASHINGTON — Two Republicans in tight Senate races have called for an end to the war in Iran, the latest sign that some candidates feel compelled to distance themselves from President Trump as they face voters angry about surging prices tied to the conflict.

Representative Ashley Hinson of Iowa, running for the open Senate seat in her state against Josh Turek, a Democrat, and Mike Rogers, who faces Abdul El-Sayed, a Democrat, in Michigan, both separated themselves from the president after months of defending his authority to attack Iran.

It was a particularly surprising shift in posture for Hinson, who voted less than a week ago against a resolution calling on Trump to halt military opera-

tions in Iran or seek congressional approval for them. Seven Republicans joined Democrats in supporting that measure, and two were Hinson’s Iowa colleagues — Zach Nunn and Mariannette Miller-Meeks.

Persistently high fuel prices driven by the US-Israeli war in Iran, launched in February, have caused frustration especially in rural areas and red states where trucks and farms rely on diesel, which reached \$6.50 per gallon Sunday, according to AAA.

The candidates’ remarks underscore mounting concern among some Republicans that the fallout from the conflict could prevent the party from retaining control of Congress.

In a social media post, Hinson said she supported the suspension of gas taxes, a pause in diesel exports, and “a successful and immediate end” to the war. “Iowans are being squeezed and shouldn’t have to foot the bill at the pump or the checkout line for the war in Iran,” she said.

NEW YORK TIMES

Trump administration to admit 17,500 white South Africans

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration plans to limit the number of refugees admitted to the country to 17,500 mostly white South Africans, the administration told Congress Tuesday, as it continues to transform a program that at one point served as a pathway to safety for people fleeing war and strife from countries around the world.

In a notice to Congress, the

administration said the white South Africans faced seizures of their land and other forms of persecution and would be likely to assimilate when they come to America. The South African government has repeatedly rejected the idea that the white South Africans, who are Afrikaners, are a persecuted minority in the home country.

The Trump administration has dramatically altered a refugee program that historically enjoyed strong bipartisan support as it welcomed tens of thousands of refugees from countries around the world to new lives in America, and instead the administration has transformed it into a vehicle to resettle white South Africans in America.

The administration told Congress in the announcement that it intended to spend about \$500 million to resettle the new arrivals to the United States.

Organizations that have historically worked to resettle refugees in new homes in America criticized the administration’s decision to once again limit the program to white South Africans.

“For more than four decades, America’s refugee program has provided a lifesaving pathway for people fleeing violence and persecution,” said Naomi Steinberg, HIAS vice president for refugee and immigration policy and advocacy, in a statement. “But again, this administration is diminishing and distorting this legacy in service of its political whims.”

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Jury finds no evidence in teen’s death

Family pushes back against the decision

By Sophie Bates, Claudia Lauer, and Dave Collins

ASSOCIATED PRESS

PASCAGOULA, Miss. — A grand jury determined that there wasn’t evidence to warrant charges in the death of Nolan Wells, a Black college student whose body was found after a July 4 boating trip and party on an island off the Mississippi Gulf Coast. Wells’s family swiftly pushed back on the findings.

District Attorney Angel Myers McIlrath, who has overseen the investigation into the 18-year-old’s death, announced the grand jury’s findings late Monday, after months of intense speculation about how Wells went missing from the bustling party and why the friends who ferried him to Horn Island left without him.

The grand jury found no evidence of criminal conduct and said that based on various factors, including the position and condition of Wells’s body when found two days after he was last seen, his death was “consistent with drowning.” Although the state medical examiner’s office’s autopsy results haven’t been made public, the grand jury report said that it and a separate autopsy conducted by a forensic pathologist hired by Wells’s family found bruising on the back of his head but couldn’t determine the cause of death.

Wells’s mother, Christine Wonsley, said at a news conference Tuesday that she didn’t understand how the grand jury concluded that her son had accidentally drowned given the autopsy findings.

“How can a jury come to the conclusion of drowning, despite knowing that there was trauma to his body, and despite hearing many inconsistencies?” she said.

Attorneys for friends of Wells who have been the subject of on-line rumors and accusations hailed the report’s findings, with one saying his client can now properly grieve.

During its investigation into whether crimes were committed, the grand jury issued 132 subpoenas and heard from 43 witnesses through direct testimony, sworn statements, and recorded interviews, according to the report. It weighed evidence, including cell-phone data and forensic reports, videos, and GPS data.

Lawyers for Wells’s family, in-

cluding civil rights attorney Ben Crump, said the grand jury’s report yielded more questions than answers, and they accused the district attorney of ending the investigation despite not determining what caused blunt force trauma to Wells’s head and body.

“All other causes must be ruled out prior to certifying a death as drowning,” Crump said at the news conference. “What is another cause the district attorney failed to rule out? Blunt force trauma. ... Common sense tells you that this child did not just drown.”

A witness testified that he saw Wells slip awkwardly off the side of a boat around 3:30 p.m. on July 4, but that Wells continued to socialize after the fall and didn’t appear injured, the report said. The panel said it couldn’t determine whether the fall caused the bruising on Wells’s body.

Wonsley said she was informed of the grand jury’s findings only minutes before McIlrath posted a video about them on her office’s Facebook page, and that this lacked empathy.

“Last night was a reminder that our son’s life does not matter to those who hold positions that are supposed to serve and protect the public,” Wonsley said, struggling through tears. “Nolan is loved. He is cherished. He is honored. And he did not deserve to have his life taken away so suddenly.”

Crump and others renewed their request Tuesday for the US Department of Justice to conduct an independent investigation, and called on McIlrath to release the investigation file and the state medical examiner’s full autopsy report. Kristen Clarke, general counsel for the NAACP and a former head of the DOJ’s Civil Rights Division, said it would make sense for the Justice Department to open an investigation given the island is federally maintained and patrolled.

The case has led to rampant speculation and suspicion as people grapple with Mississippi’s history of racial tension and what it means to be a Black person in a majority white setting. Everyone else in the group that traveled with Wells to the island is white.

Shortly after Wells was found dead, Jackson County sheriff’s officials said investigators didn’t suspect foul play, sparking widespread concerns about whether law enforcement would conduct a thorough investigation. McIlrath repeatedly promised a fair, thorough investigation into his death.

When it comes to fantasy football, the Commish really rules

►FANTASY
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fantasy football players in the United States. And with ego, bragging rights, and often money at stake, players take every point seriously. Ruling over this roiling cauldron, making decisions that can determine a person’s sense of self-worth for an entire year, are the commissioners.

And anyone who thinks it’s all fun and games, well, let’s let the commissioners take it from here.

“I’m called ‘Stalin,’ ” said Shamus Coyne, 29, who runs a league that started back at Malden Catholic High School.

If his league’s managers don’t like one of his rulings — such as whether a trade between two teams is fair — they ridicule him in the group chat. “In the rest of their lives people have matured,” said Coyne, who works in wealth management, “but fantasy is an outlet for people to be immature.”

“Imagine having Thanksgiving dinner and everyone is competing over who made the best dish, and at the end there is a winner,” said Canton native Adam Clyve, 22, the commissioner of his family league. “And as commissioner, you’re the one who sets the rules.”

“You’re signing yourself up for torture,” said Mike Golden, 39, the veteran commissioner

of a league that started when he was at Northeastern University.

The past few years, he said, he’s been under attack because he won’t kick out newer members to make room for original members who decided to leave the league and now want back in.

“They want me to get rid of Uncle Ken,” Golden said, referring to a newer member known by that name. “But Uncle Ken didn’t do anything. He’s good. He shows up. He’s the only one who doesn’t make fun of me.”

That, of course, is one of possibly a million decisions a commissioner might make, either unilaterally or with input from the league.

Others include: whether or not the league will award points per reception, and if so, how many; what the last-place punishment should be; setting the buy-in price and then collecting the money; and something that sounds simple, but as anyone who’s ever tried to organize anything knows, is anything but: scheduling the draft.

“You would not believe how frustrating it is to get a group of 10 people to commit to being on their computer [for the draft] at a specific time,” said Hughes, the X user.

“Guys,” he said, addressing an invisible audience, “you’ve had months of warning.”

When I called Jeff Schaffer, a



MELISSA RAWLINS/ESPN IMAGES

ESPN once created a Fantasy Football Commissioner of the Year award, with prizes.

co-creator of the cult TV favorite “The League,” and asked him to describe the commissioner role, he likened it to “an unhealthy combination” of being the adult in the room, a den mother, a sheriff, and a referee, “but even more thankless.”

Commissioners play in the leagues over which they reign, he noted, and can be accused of self-interest. “It’s like if Roger Goodell had his own team.”

The role is so important, he added darkly, that a bad commissioner “can sink a league.”

Indeed, right now, the commissioner of a league is facing a mini mutiny. One of his league members, Joseph Omeste, 28, a health care worker in Boston,

recently took to Reddit. “Ways to seek revenge against a tyrannical commissioner,” he posted soon after the season began.

Omeste also drew up a Declaration of Independence, of sorts. “When in the course of fantasy football events, it becomes necessary . . . to rise against the unchecked authority of a Commissioner,” it began.

Reached by phone, Omeste detailed his commissioner’s main alleged sin (which involves league members who are new to fantasy feeling tricked by the commissioner’s pre-season guide), then griped (cheerfully) about his alleged arrogance.

“He wants us to call him

‘Commish’ when we are hanging out at a bar,” Omeste said of his childhood friend.

When I spoke with Jon, the Commish, who did not want his last name used lest his employer see his fantasy drama, he clarified that he only demands to be called “Commish” during the season. He took the opportunity to gripe about his subjects.

“If I win, it’s because I cheated, and if I lose it’s because I [stink],” Commish said sarcastically.

If passions seem high, it’s because people are often more invested in their fantasy teams than their hometown teams, said Zach Scola, an assistant professor at UMass Boston, whose work focuses in part on fantasy sports.

“It has a lot to do with the fact that there is ownership — I did something to make this happen,” he said, channeling fantasy players’ thoughts. “These are *my* players, *my* team.”

Sometimes the commissioner is simply the person who started the league, and never manages to shed the obligation. But others seek it out, said Reginald James, the host of the Fantasy Commissioner Show podcast.

“The role attracts certain types,” he said. And one is: “Someone who likes to be in control and this is their king-

dom. They can set the rules and tell people what to do. They are drawn to power.”

Alas, the nobility of the role is rarely recognized. In part to rectify that (and obviously in larger part to generate marketing buzz) in 2015, Pizza Hut and ESPN created a Fantasy Football Commissioner of the Year award, with prizes that included two years’ worth of Pizza Hut pizza, and a ruby-and-diamond encrusted ring valued at \$10,000.

Kevin Murray, a chiropractor in Seattle, won the award in its second and final year (when the ring was valued at \$7,000) with a stunning display on his part of cheerful, organized, and creative commissioner-ship, and said the job is wrongly maligned.

“People think it’s about ruling,” said Murray, who after winning the “life changing” award went on to write “The Commissioner’s Playbook” and host the “Fantasy Football Unlimited” podcast. “But it’s really about managing and leading people.”

Maybe. Or, as Jon, the Commish, put it: “Being a commissioner is almost like being a mother to a bunch of babies, and they all have their lists of demands.”

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MCAS scores are still down across the board

►**MCAS**
Continued from Page A1

test. International test scores have shown similar declines across much of the world, reinforcing concerns about the impact of artificial intelligence, school-issued laptops, and cell-phones on student learning.

While Massachusetts still tops the rankings on the Nation’s Report Card tests, the state’s continued decline in test scores, including among the youngest students, suggests that position could be in jeopardy.

“Our leaders have been asleep at the wheel, and I hope they wake up before Massachusetts loses its lead in K-12 education,” said Thomas Kane, a professor at Harvard University’s Graduate School of Education.

The results did not surprise former state education secretary Paul Reville, who noted that scores are down across the country. But Reville said he fears that many students are not learning skills they need to thrive as adults.

“That should be an urgent concern,” Reville said.

The new scores are the results of the Massachusetts Comprehensive Assessment System exams that are given in spring. The tests, better known as MCAS, are administered to students in grades 3 through 8 and 10. Statewide, more than 450,000 students at traditional public schools and charter schools took the exams, representing roughly about half the publicly funded school population.

Research shows that the exams matter. Students who consistently score well on standardized tests such as MCAS are more likely to attend and graduate from college and earn more as adults.

For a second year in a row, Martinez expressed optimism despite declining test scores, saying Massachusetts’ high standards and investment in education will help schools reverse the trend.

He pointed to the state’s recent overhaul of reading instruction as a reason to hope a turnaround is already underway. That law, signed by Governor Maura Healey in June, will require districts to use state-approved evidence-based literacy curriculums that include teaching children to sound out words, vocabulary building, oral comprehension, and more.

“We’re already working with hundreds of schools on what we know are the right solutions,” Martinez said. “The literacy bill now allows us to implement those practices statewide.”

Education Secretary Stephen Zrike also praised increased school funding and highlighted the administration’s proposed new high school graduation requirements. That plan, which may still need legislative action, would introduce new tests in core subjects that could influence whether students earn a diploma, among other requirements.

“Every Massachusetts student should leave high school not just with a diploma,” Zrike said, “but with meaningful choices and real opportunities ahead.”

Massachusetts continues to have large achievement gaps by race, income, and native language, with the size of those disparities changing little. Deputy Education Commissioner Robert Curtin said that in some cases gaps narrowed because higher-performing groups declined particularly fast, “not because the bottom group rose.”

Scores declined even for students who were not yet in school during the pandemic.



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF FILE

Students who consistently score well on standardized tests such as MCAS are more likely to attend and graduate from college and earn more as adults.

This cohort of third-graders, who were toddlers during COVID, had a passing rate 13 points lower in English and 7 points lower in math than their counterparts in 2019.

Results in many individual school districts were similarly dismal. The state’s largest cities of Boston, Springfield, and Worcester all reported sharp declines in high school English scores and little progress elsewhere.

Boston officials issued a press release highlighting a rise in math scores in grades 6 and 8 and an uptick on the 8th-grade science exam. Superintendent Mary Skipper declined an interview request but was quoted in the release.

“These results reflect steady progress across Boston Public Schools,” Skipper said, “while also reinforcing the importance of our continued focus on improving student academic performance.”

formance.”

Chelsea Superintendent Almi Guajardo Abeyta pointed to bright spots in her city, which included a jump in math scores in grades 3 to 8. However, high school scores fell in both English and math. Abeyta noted that because MCAS is no longer a graduation requirement, there has been less investment in student assessments.

“Massachusetts districts will need to think carefully about how we communicate the purpose and importance of the Grade 10” MCAS, Abeyta said. “At the same time, we are not using that as an excuse for our results.”

Scores at the state’s charter schools also remained well below pre-pandemic levels. In Grade 10, for example, nearly two-thirds of students earned passing grades in 2019, but last year fewer than half of them did.

The new MCAS scores echo the latest international PISA test results, which earlier this month showed declines among 15-year-olds in the United States and across the world.

Students scored worse on the PISA test if they used AI chatbots regularly, used computers for leisure at school, or reported high levels of digital distraction, according to an analysis of the results by Andreas Schleicher, the education chief of the organization that released the test.

A few countries, including the United Kingdom and Turkey, bucked the trend of declining scores, which indicated that schools can successfully manage technological challenges.

In Massachusetts, last spring’s MCAS included the second year of eighth-grade civics testing, which covers the principles behind the US political system, the structure of Massachusetts state government, and

more. Forty percent of students passed the new assessment, a slight increase from 39 percent the previous year.

The state on Tuesday also released accountability determinations for schools and districts, which are based on MCAS scores and other indicators, such as graduation rates and absenteeism. Fifty-six schools were named “Schools of Recognition” based on growth or achievement, including some with high poverty rates such as Boston’s Grew Elementary School and Lynn’s Lincoln-Thomson School.

The state also identified 37 districts and 315 schools as needing assistance or intervention, with both groups growing slightly since 2025. Although the MCAS is no longer a graduation requirement, it remains the core of the state’s accountability system, which is a federal requirement. Schools and districts that perform poorly, in whole or among particular subgroups, can face state intervention or even a state takeover.

Massachusetts has not done enough to stop the decline in test scores, according to Edward Lambert, executive director of the Massachusetts Business Alliance for Education. Even a 2019 law that pumped more money into schools in low-income communities, Lambert said, hasn’t revered the trend.

“We need to get serious about getting back to the business of accountability,” Lambert said.

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As marketing speeds up, judgment mistakes are made

►**CONVERSE**
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the whole picture. “The number of people that are involved in execution goes up, but the number who personally are responsible for the impact goes down,” DaCosta said.

Reviews that once stretched over weeks can now happen in a single Slack thread, as brands try to keep pace with social platforms and an increasingly fragmented media environment, said Evan Nierman, CEO of crisis public relations firm Red Banyan.

That can leave a campaign with plenty of reviewers, but no single person who is asking how the finished product might be interpreted by someone outside the organization.

“Every company needs someone in the room whose job it is to raise a hand and say, ‘This could hurt us,’” said Nierman.

Stefanie Boyer, a Bryant University marketing professor, said the approval process can help explain how things might get missed: Legal is evaluating legal exposure, marketing may be looking at the brand strategy, and an agency may be focused on the creative idea.

“Who is looking at the whole thing through the eyes of the customer?” said Boyer.

Part of the problem, said Shailendra Pratap Jain, a marketing and branding scholar, is that the people making an ad know far more about it than the people who eventually see it.

He calls this the “curse of creative context.”

Marketers and creatives see the brief and iterations that led to the finished product. Customers see a single image on their phones, often stripped of context and interpreted through their own cultural references and history.

The Converse ad is a striking example of that so-called curse.

An Instagram photo — a single shot from a longer video — showed K-pop singer Karina wearing a skirt and holding a pair of Chuck 70 X sneakers. Critics online said that the white triangular image created by lighting on the skirt resembled a KKK hood, and that the way she held the sneakers made them look like the dangling feet of a lynching victim.



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Converse would not say whether the controversial ad campaign was developed in the United States or elsewhere.

Converse pulled the ad from its channels, but the Boston-based company refused to answer the Globe’s questions asking who created it, whether an outside agency was involved, how the image was reviewed before publication, or whether anyone inside the company raised concerns about it. The company also would not say whether the campaign was developed in the US or elsewhere.

Who, if anyone, was responsible for asking whether the image could be interpreted this way before millions of people saw it?

As the first Black president of the Graphic Artists Guild, DaCosta said she has seen firsthand how the person most likely to flag a problem may not always be in the room.

“Diverse teams aren’t a PR move. They are quality control,” she said. “When everyone approving the campaign has the same background, they all miss the same things.”

On social media, critics

pounced.

“Shadow, light, and composition. Every photographer can tell you, whoever did this ad knew EXACTLY what they were doing,” Stephanie Schwartz, a Chicago-based photographer, wrote on Threads.

Beyond the Converse blunder, there are real business reasons why some brands keep chasing attention, even if that attention is negative. In digital advertising, engagement is measurable almost immediately through views, shares, comments, searches, and other forms of online activity that can make a campaign look successful.

For some marketing teams, “going viral” has become an objective in itself. That’s a risky endeavor.

Nataly Kelly, chief marketing officer of Boston-based market research firm Zappi, said marketers are producing more advertising for more platforms and audiences than ever, and without increasing the amount

of consumer testing they do.

“Brands are creating more assets, but their testing budgets have stayed relatively the same or grown at such a slow pace that they can’t keep up with the need for testing,” said Kelly.

That can create opportunities for something to slip through that should never see the light of day.

Kelly said Zappi’s synthetic consumer testing flagged the problematic scene in the recent Callaway ad with Good Good Golf, which showed a man forcefully shoving a woman to the ground. Good Good said the ad was supposed to be a parody of the horror movie “Obsession,” but critics said it tried to make light of violence against women.

“Even AI could catch this,” Kelly said.

The pressure to generate attention also also means not every controversial campaign is a failure.

For instance, the recent Converse, Callaway, and Target controversies (the latter apologized

for selling a children’s Halloween costume that critics said evoked racist minstrel caricatures) appear different than the recent Sydney Sweeney campaign for sports prediction platform Novig. The ad deliberately used provocative imagery, displaying Sweeney with little or no clothing, covering parts of her body only with placed footballs or other sports-related apparel. Female athletes have gone on social media to criticize the ad, calling it disrespectful to women.

“Attention and effectiveness aren’t the same thing,” Boyer said. “If five million people are talking about your brand but fewer people trust you or want to buy from you, that’s not necessarily a marketing win.”

Sometimes, however, the attention can translate into real results. American Eagle’s 2025 “Great Jeans” campaign — also with Sweeney — drew criticism over its play on “jeans” and “genes.” Online critics said pairing a blonde-haired, blue-eyed

‘Every company needs someone in the room whose job it is to raise a hand and say, “This could hurt us.” ’

EVAN NIERMAN,
CEO of crisis public relations firm Red Banyan

celebrity with a pun about genetic traits had problematic undertones and represented outdated beauty standards.

The company declined to apologize and its stock soared after the campaign, which executives later credited with boosting brand awareness and sales.

“When attention becomes the primary currency, controversy can become an acceptable business risk,” said Steve Inguinta, a production services manager at XR Extreme Reach, an advertising operations platform.

For Converse, the stakes are particularly relevant as Nike tries to reset the struggling sneaker company. While it remains a billion-dollar global business, its revenue has fallen by 44 percent in just two years.

As the brand tries to regain cultural relevance, a pulled ad can mean wasted production and media spending. But the more consequential cost may be one that won’t appear on Converse’s next earnings report: whether consumers trust the brand enough to keep buying it.

“It just takes years to do that,” said Kelly. “Once consumers have an idea about the brand in their heads, they won’t go back to it.”

Material from the Associated Press was used in this report. Alexa Gagosz can be reached at alexa.gagosz@globe.com. Follow her @alexagagosz and on Instagram @AlexaGagosz.

Opinion

BOSTONGLOBE.COM/OPINION

EDITORIAL

The data center challenge: Mass. can lead on how to balance economic growth with clean energy

Perhaps even more controversial than artificial intelligence itself is the backbone that powers the technology: Data centers can be loud and polluting, while requiring tremendous amounts of electricity and water resources.

These data centers are also a key to future economic growth. AI, like it or not, is here to stay.

The question in Massachusetts has become: What approach should the Commonwealth take?

Massachusetts is a knowledge economy that already leans heavily on AI. Turning our backs on data centers feels hypocritical. That doesn't mean, however, that we should roll out the welcome mat with tax credits and let data center builders dictate the shots.

Governor Maura Healey has offered up a solid framework to guide any future data center buildout. Her "bring your own clean energy" approach strikes the right note. It says to developers: Yes, you can build here but not on the backs of energy ratepayers. And you can't burn planet-warming fossil fuels or pass along the costs of connecting your enterprise to the power grid. The governor wants data centers to either build their own clean energy supplies or pay into a ratepayer protection fund.

The governor's stated approach is to try to balance economic growth alongside protections for Massachusetts residents. Healey also signed an executive order this month requiring community approval before state permits are issued to new data centers.

Jennifer Granholm, a former secretary of energy under former president Joe Biden, called the governor's plans a "good blueprint for the rest of the country."

Granholm said Healey "isn't reflexively saying 'no' to data centers, and she isn't writing them a blank check either. She's saying: if you want to build here, bring something to the table."

A framework from a governor can offer guidance to state agencies, but it doesn't carry the weight of law.

The Massachusetts Legislature is working on solutions, tucked into two behemoth energy bills making their way through the House and Senate. The House is proposing that data centers "procure" renewable energy to power at least 80 percent of a data center's needs. The Senate has proposed putting a pause on

The Massachusetts Legislature is working on solutions, tucked into two behemoth energy bills making their way through the House and Senate.

growth to buy time to study the best path forward. The chamber is also discussing putting limits on tax breaks for data centers. (The governor halted applications for data center tax incentives in June.)

As with any new and quickly evolving industry, many questions will need to be sorted out.

A key sticking point: What could renewable energy procurement look like? Should data centers be required to physically build solar panels with battery storage, for example? Or, if data centers are relying on renewable power from the grid, how do we ensure this isn't pushing another customer off of clean energy and onto fossil fuels? Should nuclear energy count as a clean source?

Lawmakers and energy regulators should quibble over the details. But Beacon Hill also needs to prioritize getting some set of rules to the governor's desk before this legislative session adjourns in January. There's simply too much hand wringing, fear, and confusion in our communities not to establish a legal-

ly binding road map.

If new guidelines are too onerous, data center developers may say no thank you and move onto the next state. That wouldn't be the worst thing in the world.

"It's not a big loss," Erin Baker, a University of Massachusetts Amherst professor who researches mathematical modeling of energy decisions, told the editorial board. "It's not super clear to me what value we get from data centers in our community. They don't have a lot of jobs."

In the other scenario, if rules for building data centers are too loose or not established, it would be much harder to go in reverse, warns Democratic state Senator Michael Moore of Millbury, who worries the state could someday be left with gigantic white elephant eyesores.

It's a fair point. The fact is, all technologies become more efficient with time. There's no reason to expect otherwise with data centers, which should become more efficient and less polluting, and may no longer need vast facilities.

If Massachusetts can establish rigorous standards, not outright bans on data centers, other states will undoubtedly follow suit, as Granholm suggested, and a national or regional standard could be set. That sounds much better than the current race to the bottom between states chasing short-term construction jobs.

If done right, data centers could even become a way to lower our electricity bills. For example, if data centers were required to pay higher costs for the upkeep of transmission lines, that would help the rest of us. Or imagine a data center powered by solar panels with battery storage sending excess electricity back to the grid.

Baker says all this will be tricky to operationalize. But making data centers work for us is worth trying.

The humanities have a reading problem

By Eugene Scott

Eugene Scott, a journalist based in Washington, D.C., is a contributing Globe Opinion writer.

When I reflect on my undergraduate education, the classes that have stuck with me, more than 25 years after I enrolled, are those most often accused of having little value; courses in subjects like sociology, philosophy, and gender studies. They changed how I saw the world and how I wanted to move through it, and the critical thinking skills I developed through those curricula have served me well, both in my journalism career and my personal life. As a result, I always encourage young people I mentor to study liberal arts. But I have found it quite discouraging that so many college students are taking a starkly different approach when selecting a major.

According to a recent report from the American Academy of Arts and Sciences, the percentage of students pursuing a bachelor's degree in the humanities fell by nearly 30 percent between 2015 and 2025. And while the decision not to study world languages, history, and ethnic studies might be influenced by political attacks on the liberal arts or growing concerns about artificial intelligence replacing white-collar jobs, declining interest in the humanities is also rooted in a less obvious place: the literacy crisis.

More young people arrive on college campuses frightened — and incapable — of meeting the reading demands of academia, and that fear is shaping how they go about choosing which subjects to study. Many liberal arts fields

require significant reading. And as a result, fewer students enroll due to concerns about the course load. Robert Townsend, the author of the AAA&S report, told Inside Higher Ed that reading ability among recent college grads is one of the biggest challenges facing students.

"Many students just don't feel comfortable with long-form reading that they'd do in an English or history class," Townsend said. "That seems one of the bigger headwinds that the field is facing right now. If students don't feel comfortable with text, they're more likely to be attracted by something that doesn't require them to do that reading."

Reading scores for American 15-year-olds have dropped significantly since 2022 and are near their lowest point in 25 years, according to the Program for International Student Assessment, a global study of academic achievement. The omnipresence of social media, the lingering effects of the coronavirus pandemic, and the controversial fallout of the increased emphasis on standardized testing have all been cited as major factors in the current state of reading.

An effective solution to the decline in interest in courses that require much reading is to get higher education more involved with the college preparatory process. Last September, the Trump administration cut funding for about 100 federal educational programs, part of the TRIO grants that help improve college readiness for students from racial and socioeconomic backgrounds who are often underprepared for postsecondary education. A federal judge temporarily blocked some cuts and forced the administration to reverse others. But the administration has proposed to make even larger cuts next fiscal year, including eliminat-



GLOWONCONCEPT/ADOBE

ing the TRIO grants altogether. Administration officials argued that there is no longer a need for the programs — arguing that they are relics of the past — and if there is, colleges need to find a way to fund them instead of relying on federal dollars to do so.

Given the continued challenges facing the students that these programs serve, there is still a need for their existence. But officials do have a point that colleges and universities need to become more involved in college prep.

Fortunately, many already are. Multiple universities and colleges in New England have programs that help improve the college readiness of high school students. And while their future is uncertain given the changing budget priorities in higher education, prioritizing saving these programs is in the best interest of not just the specific programs at risk of disappearing but also of communities as a whole.

After the Trump administration ended a grant last year that funded a tutoring program for first-generation students, Massachusetts Commissioner of Higher Education Noe Ortega told the Globe editorial board that TRIO "helps level the playing field" for these students and "lifts barriers for students who contribute on our campuses, in our workforce, and in our communities."

Therefore, if colleges want to see more students ready to tackle the reading that is often required in the liberal arts, they must allocate the necessary resources to reaching students before they get to college. Investing in the academic development of young people even before they enroll in college could help reinforce the fact that higher education institutions benefit communities beyond the campus. And even if these young people don't enroll in college but simply become better readers, it benefits us all.

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INBOX



ALEX WROBLEWSKI/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

The James S. Brady Press Briefing Room at the White House in Washington on Sept. 21.

Trump’s attack on free press marks another step toward authoritarianism

President Trump’s unsurprising banning of news outlets CNN, MS NOW, and Politico from covering the White House, barring their journalists from entering the grounds, was the act of a vindictive president whose war against open and free expression has been notable for years (“3 news outlets lose White House access,” Page A5, Sept. 20).

Trump’s impudent behavior in front of the press and abusive treatment of selected reporters whose questions he’s found critical, overly inquisitive, or otherwise objectionable were a clear lead-up to this latest step.

Trump’s abrupt exclusion of the three outlets was especially egregious since it raises the likelihood that he will act against others in the media in the same way.

Most presidents have been at odds with the press at some point but few have been as flagrantly combative or gone as far as challenging the right to free speech. Trump’s barring of major news organizations from the White House constitutes a glaring breach of First Amendment freedoms.

The president’s attack on a free press suggests that he doesn’t accept his role as a servant of the American people or as a leader in a constitutional democracy. Left unchecked, it could put the country farther on an ominous path toward authoritarianism than many ever thought possible.

ROGER HIRSCHBERG
South Burlington, Vt.

Clancy case makes it clear: Mass. needs statute protecting identity of jurors

No Massachusetts juror should have their identity revealed without their consent. Recent events following the Lindsay Clancy trial make clear that Massachusetts needs a statute protecting the identity of jurors. Individuals or media outlets that violate the statute should face criminal penalties and be subject to a civil suit for damages.

The doxing of the lone holdout juror in the Clancy trial and his public vilification will have a chilling effect on future jurors, especially in high-profile, emotionally charged cases. A juror who angers fellow jurors with whom he disagrees may face the prospect of his life being turned upside down for the sin of following his conscience and view of the evidence, as the judge would have instructed him was his obligation.

While a juror identity protection law undoubtedly would face a First Amendment challenge, outing a juror without their consent threatens another fundamental constitutional right: the right to trial by a fair and impartial jury. The entire structure of our jury trial and criminal justice system will be threatened if jurors facing strong and aggressive fellow jurors who disagree with them are afraid to stand their ground.

KENNETH N. MARGOLIN
Newton

The writer is a retired attorney.

Mass. AG’s Meta settlement is a key advance for youth health

Massachusetts Attorney General Andrea Joy Campbell is right that her office’s recent settlement with Meta matters (“Big Tech built social media for kids. Now it must protect them,” Opinion, Sept 14). The landmark agreement Massachusetts and dozens of other states reached with Meta strengthens protections for young people online and empowers parents.

New safeguards, including expanded content controls, options to disable autoplay, screen-time limits, parental supervision tools, limits on likes, and restrictions on extreme filters, will make a major difference.

New research from the Coalition to Empower our Future found that 81 percent of parents nationwide support the plan and strongly believe these measures will improve youth mental health; 84 percent want the protections to go further, saying platforms such as TikTok, YouTube, and Snapchat should adopt the same protections. Parents want consistent guardrails no matter the platform.

It’s also clear that parents nationwide would support calls for legislative action such as Campbell’s if the other platforms don’t follow in Meta’s path. More than 8 in 10 parents support their state legislature signing similar measures into law, and two-thirds would be likelier to vote for politicians who support them.

This agreement is a meaningful step forward and an important component of a comprehensive approach to youth well-being.

GLEN WEINER
Executive director
Coalition to Empower Our Future
Tarrytown, N.Y.

A regular roost in the Wednesday paper, perhaps till the end of time

Change is an inevitable aspect of the universe and of the human condition. People are born, people die. Styles and fashions come and go. Empires rise and fall. Mountain ranges arise and are eroded away. Niagara Falls is several miles farther south than it was some 12,000 years ago. The Berlin Wall fell. The Red Sox even broke an 86-year-old World Series curse.

But it seems one thing never changes: Turn to the last page in Wednesday’s Globe, and there you will find that the very last article in the print edition is “Bird Sightings.”

JAMES F. JILLET
Lewiston, N.Y.

RENÉE GRAHAM

Hitting Trump where it hurts — cutting his TV coverage

It’s a known fact that President Trump does not drink alcohol. But he is addicted to something that, to him, has always been just as intoxicating: television cameras and microphones.

Even before his first White House tenure, Trump recognized that media attention equaled importance and influence, and far too often the press complied. Whether it was helping Trump weave fables of his business prowess or giving him airtime to

To Trump, “fake news” is any report that underlines the myriad ways that he is the worst president in American history. Since entering politics, he has believed that journalists are his personal PR team, and anyone who fails to do so is, as he has stated, “the enemy of the people.”

No president loves the media. But most have understood the duties of the job that journalists are constitutionally protected to serve. Trump never has. And as his fascistic tendencies have metastasized in his second

For now, at least, Trump seems to have lost his most willing accomplice and punching bag — the media.

spread lies, Trump never missed an opportunity to get in front of a TV audience.

But for now, at least, Trump seems to have lost his most willing accomplice and punching bag — the media.

After Trump suddenly issued a ban last week to keep CNN, MS NOW, and Politico out of the White House, ABC, CBS, CNN, Fox News, and NBC, all part of the rotating TV pool that travels with and reports on the president, announced that they would halt coverage of presidential events until Trump lifts his unconstitutional ban.

The banned companies filed a lawsuit against the Trump administration, saying, “This ban could not be a more direct assault on the First Amendment nor a more blatant violation of our most fundamental constitutional principles.”

Trump, in a social media post on Friday, said the ban was “a result of [the media’s] constant ‘reporting’ FAKE NEWS!” He added, “Media Outlets shouldn’t be able to constantly write or report FICTION and LIES” about him, his administration, or the country.

term, so has his animosity toward the press.

This isn’t new. During Trump’s first term in 2018, his administration suspended the press pass of Jim Acosta, then a CNN White House correspondent. Trump has publicly berated reporters — especially women — at press conferences. Last year, he tried to ban the Associated Press from the White House for its continued use of the Gulf of Mexico instead of Trump’s preferred “Gulf of America.”

Trump’s attitude toward the media hasn’t changed. But its response to Trump’s bullying finally has.

On Monday, at an event for yet another costly and unnecessary construction project — a new helipad on the White House lawn — Trump gestured and talked, but he couldn’t be heard without the TV pool’s audio equipment. Drowned out by helicopter noise, Trump’s words were inaudible and he looked like a silent movie actor.

As footage of Trump played on the right-wing cable outlet Newsmax, Bianca de la Garza, one of the channel’s hosts said, “Maybe this is one example

of [Trump’s ban] backfiring just a little bit.”

That backfire is long overdue.

When Trump suspended Acosta, the correspondent’s colleagues and competitors should have walked out. Every time Trump insulted a reporter, others in the room should have pushed back. When the AP was banned for ignoring his silly “Gulf of America” edict, its fellow journalists should have done exactly what they are doing now — refuse to cover this president on his narrow and self-serving terms in exchange for access.

Certainly, the media’s Trump coverage has improved since his first campaign, when cable news cameras were routinely trained on empty podiums as they waited for him to arrive. Even when he wasn’t there, he could hog the spotlight and dominate the airwaves.

As president, Trump has expected what he received as a bloviating businessman and reality show host — enthusiastic, myth-making coverage — though his only expertise was his willingness to get in front of a camera or microphone anytime and anywhere.

What Trump has received in terms of media coverage, especially as his cruel and chaotic second administration unravels and his poll numbers continue to plummet, must feel like a betrayal. His only response is to lash out, even though he’ll probably lose in court as he did with the lawsuits filed by Acosta and the AP.

With its newfound solidarity against an authoritarian president, the media may finally recognize that a threat to one journalist or press organization is a threat to all of them. We should all hope that their resolve holds. More than a fight for journalistic independence, this is an existential battle for democracy.

Renée Graham is a Globe columnist. She can be reached at renee.graham@globe.com.

Good capitalism requires listening to workers

By Peter Palandjian

Peter Palandjian is chairman and CEO of Intercontinental Real Estate Corp. and a producer and executive producer of “Union Town,” a documentary film.

For more than two weeks, roughly 1,300 workers at Encore Boston Harbor, the large casino that dominates Everett’s skyline, have been on strike, disrupting operations at one of Greater Boston’s largest hospitality and entertainment employers. They are seeking higher wages and stronger protections for health care, benefits, and job security.

These are the housekeepers, cooks, bartenders, servers, slot attendants, warehouse workers, drivers, and other employees whose labor makes Encore function. Represented by UNITE HERE Local 26 and Teamsters Local 25, they are not peripheral to the business. They are the people who create the experience Encore sells.

I know something about both sides of that equation. My company, Intercontinental Real Estate Corp., develops and owns unionized hotels in Boston, Chicago, and Minneapolis, builds with union labor, and manages capital for Taft-Hartley pension and health and welfare funds, as well as public pension funds serving teachers, firefighters, and police officers across the country. In Boston, we own the 427-room Hampton Inn and Homewood Suites by Hilton in the Seaport District, and we developed and formerly owned the Nine Zero Hotel.

For decades, we have been entrusted to manage retirement and benefit capital on behalf of working people. That experience has taught me that labor negotiations are never merely about contract language: They affect people’s paychecks, health care, retirement security, and ability to provide for their families.

So my respect for organized labor isn’t theoretical.

Collective bargaining can be difficult. Management and labor have different interests and won’t always agree. But disagreement is precisely why we have a bargaining table.

Encore Boston Harbor and its owner, Wynn Resorts, should listen more sympathetically to the people who make Encore successful and work with their unions with a genuine determination to reach an agreement.

I say that as a capitalist. I believe deeply

in private enterprise, investment, entrepreneurship, and profit. Businesses need to make money, investors are entitled to appropriate returns, and companies must be able to compete and grow.

But capitalism works best when the people whose labor contributes to that success have a meaningful voice in determining the conditions under which they work.

An individual housekeeper, cook, warehouse worker, limo driver, valet attendant, or cashier has very little bargaining power when sitting across from a large corporation. Collective bargaining changes that equation. It gives workers the ability to negotiate together over the value of their labor and the conditions of their employment.

I’ve been thinking a great deal about

Encore Boston Harbor and its owner, Wynn Resorts, should listen more sympathetically to the people who make Encore successful and work with their unions with a genuine determination to reach an agreement.

these questions because for the past several years I have been producing and funding “Union Town,” a new documentary directed by Barbara Kopple, which recently had its world premiere at the Venice Film Festival.

Fifty years ago, Kopple made “Harlan County, USA,” her Academy Award-winning film about Kentucky coal miners fighting for a union contract. She later made “American Dream,” about workers confronting enormous economic pressure in a changing American economy.

I approached Kopple with the idea of returning to labor because I believed the American workplace was again undergoing a profound transformation. “Union Town” follows workers at UPS and Amazon and app-based delivery workers on the streets of New York.

The industries and technology have changed. But the fundamental question Kopple has been asking for half a century hasn’t: Who has power, who doesn’t, and what becomes possible when working people stand together?

Making “Union Town” has reinforced something I have also learned over decades

in business: Management and labor do not have to regard each other as enemies. Management has legitimate interests. So does labor.

Encore has said that labor costs have been rising faster than revenues and that any agreement must be financially sustainable and protect jobs over the long term. Those concerns deserve to be taken seriously.

But the workers’ concerns deserve the same seriousness. They need to support their families, afford health care, plan for retirement, and have reasonable confidence in the security of their jobs. And when their labor helps create a successful enterprise, they understandably want to participate appropriately in that success.

A hotel can have a magnificent building, beautiful rooms, extraordinary restaurants, and every imaginable amenity. But hospitality is ultimately delivered by people — the housekeeper preparing a room, the cook preparing a meal, the server welcoming a guest, the driver getting someone safely home. They are essential participants in creating both the customer experience and the value of the enterprise.

Some may find it unusual for a business owner, investor, and hotel owner to make the case for organized labor. I see it the other way around. My experience in business is precisely why I make it.

Capital and labor need one another. Neither prospers sustainably by treating the other as an adversary to be defeated. Negotiated agreements require compromise, but compromise isn’t weakness. It is often how enduring business relationships — and enduring businesses — are built.

Encore Boston Harbor has been an important investment and employer in Greater Boston. I want Encore to prosper. I want its workers to prosper, too.

Those aspirations aren’t contradictory. In a well-functioning capitalist economy, they should reinforce one another.

So my appeal to Encore and Wynn is simple: Listen harder. Try to see the dispute from the other side of the table. Recognize the legitimate economic concerns of the people outside your doors. And bargain with the goal not merely of prevailing in a negotiation but of reaching an agreement that respects the people whose work helps make your enterprise successful.

Work has dignity. Workers deserve a voice. Businesses deserve the opportunity to succeed.

Constructive capitalism requires all three.

Income disparities worsening in South Boston

►SOUTH BOSTON
Continued from Page A1

most income-segregated metropolitan areas in the country and has experienced some of the largest increases in income divergence in recent years, according to new research by the MassINC Policy Center. This polarization has increased more in Massachusetts than in any other state since 2020.

That means fewer neighborhoods with an array of income levels. The rich are clustered with the rich, the poor with the poor.

This separation can limit access to relationships and resources that spur upward mobility, the report states, perpetuating inequities across generations.

Massachusetts also has one of the highest levels of income segregation between school districts, generating a lawsuit in May. This indicates that these sharply divided levels of economic mobility will continue, said Ben Forman, director of the policy center.

“The more the economy produces inequality, the more people sort themselves out,” Forman said.

In West Broadway public housing, home to nearly 1,500 people, some residents play bingo in the West Broadway Task Force building, competing for prizes such as detergent and dish soap. Most tenants stick close to home, said Luz Leon, the task force secretary, who has lived there for more than 20 years. But now that the Family Dollar on West Broadway has closed, Goodwill is one of the only affordable places to shop among a sea of high-end stores.

Leon, 51, is grateful for donations of diapers and Christmas gifts from wealthier residents, whom local nonprofit leaders praise for their generous contributions, but she’s highly aware that they occupy an entirely different space.

“There is a line,” she said. “They can help, but we know our place.”

The seclusion that results from inequality also perpetuates it, said Steven Durlauf, director of the Stone Center for Research on Wealth Inequality and Mobility at the University of Chicago. Where children grow up can determine what school they go to, which resources are accessible, how much crime they’re exposed to, and whom their role models are.

It also has a profound impact on how long a person lives. In 2023, the Boston Public Health Commission found a 23-year difference in life expectancy between an area in Roxbury, where the median family income is around \$60,000, and



PHOTOS BY CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Joel Depina and Jordan Bonilla shot baskets last week during the South Boston Street Fest, and a crowd filled East Broadway during the event. Gentrification has spread, as young college graduates snapped up apartments near the beach and the T.

one in Back Bay, where it’s more than \$250,000.

“There is extremely powerful empirical evidence that neighborhoods matter,” Durlauf said. “They mold people.”

Indeed, low-income people who have contact with well-off residents are more likely to go to college and have higher earnings, recent research shows. And these cross-income interactions also help prosperous people “understand America as a whole,” Durlauf said.

But as the rich keep getting richer, they’re becoming more isolated. The increase in income segregation in Greater Boston over the past four decades has been driven mainly by the rise of high-income households, according to a 2025 Boston Indicators report.

South Boston was solidly working class when public housing was built there in the 1930s and ’40s. But when the waterfront started transforming in the early 2000s, the city allowed luxury developers to pay into an affordable housing fund rather than put those units on-site, and the “white, wealthy waterfront” was born, said Donna Brown, executive director of South Boston Neighborhood Development Corporation, who has lived in the neighborhood since 1989.

The gentrification spread, as young college graduates started snapping up apartments near



the beach and the T, driving up rents and pricing out working families.

“Everybody benefits from a neighborhood that is safer and nicer,” Brown said.

But it’s unclear how much that’s helped low-income residents.

Sister Margaret Lanen, 86, came to South Boston as part of the Sisters of Notre Dame and has lived in West Broadway housing since 1975. She likes to go walk by the water at Castle

Island but stays away from the Seaport, where the unfairness of the economy is on full display.

“There’s so much money available to people who have money,” she said.

Soaring costs make it more challenging for people to work their way out of subsidized housing because they can’t afford to rent nearby, said Kenzie Bok, administrator of the Boston Housing Authority. But West Broadway public housing residents are a “force,” she not-

ed, particularly leaders who pushed to create a community garden and build mini soccer pitches open to the neighborhood.

At Fourth Presbyterian Church on Dorchester Street, the congregation is a striking blend of low-income and affluent families. This connection builds empathy and openness, said the Rev. Burns Stanfield, who has been a pastor at the church for 35 years. But he mourns the loss of school-age

children as parents increasingly leave for the suburbs.

“Nothing brings out altruism like kids,” he said. “We get better restaurants, we have better coffee, but it seems like less investment in the community as community.”

Income segregation is “extraordinarily hard” to fix without policy solutions, said Durlauf, at the University of Chicago, because parents who can afford to live anywhere want to provide the safest, most-resource-rich environment for their children.

Meier, the South Boston resident, saw this happen as his wife’s Harvard Business School friends left the city for Wellesley after they had children. Meier, who has a PhD in mechanical engineering and is currently a stay-at-home dad, and his wife, the CEO of a small energy company, have no plans to leave.

“It just seems like the American way is to segregate yourself off and set up neighborhoods that are insulated,” he said. “We want our children . . . to understand how the world actually works.”

Sharp income divides aren’t confined to cities. Some affluent suburbs — including Wellesley, Lexington, and Sudbury — contribute greatly to the Boston area’s income segregation. In one census tract in Natick, the median family income is \$209,000, according to MassINC data; in an adjacent tract in Framingham, it’s just \$49,000.

The high cost of living in Massachusetts, coupled with high rates of income inequity, mean that lower-income households have to grapple with prices shaped by one of the country’s most expensive markets armed with disproportionately low spending power.

“We’re all shopping at the same mall, we’re all shopping at similar grocery stores,” said Rachel Vingsness, executive director of the Natick Service Council, which assists low-income residents. “The cost for everyday living is the same regardless of where you live and what your income and financial situation is.”

Take kids’ sports, she said, where children from well-off families pay to play in club sports year-round and end up dominating school teams that used to be accessible to everyone.

“It’s just getting harder and harder,” she said. “I’m not sure people fully understand what’s happening right in their community or in the community next door to them.”

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With election nearing, Healey shifts her position on gas tax

►GAS
Continued from Page A1

mediately put Healey at odds with fellow Democrats on Beacon Hill, who cast the idea as “irresponsible” and an election-year gimmick.

Even before Healey released her proposal, House Speaker Ron Mariano on Monday had dismissed the idea coming from Minogue as a “desperate attempt to distract voters from the source of the problem.”

“Historically, the Legislature has chosen not to suspend the gas tax because it would limit our ability to fund critical infrastructure projects while doing little to alleviate costs for residents,” Mariano said in the Monday statement. “With no end to the war in sight, a suspension of the gas tax would be fiscally irresponsible.”

A spokesperson for the Quincy Democrat referred back to the statement when asked for comment Tuesday after Healey shared her own plans.

The Massachusetts Department of Transportation reported the state’s gas and diesel fuel excise taxes funneled nearly \$700 million into the transportation fund in fiscal year 2025.

Healey pitched the plan as an effort to “provide some relief” to Massachusetts residents facing rising costs at the pump, a burden Healey cast as “the result of a direct choice by President Trump to get us into a war that we shouldn’t have been in

in the first place.”

It’s not the most novel political pitch — gubernatorial candidates in Ohio, for example, have offered similar suggestions. But the proposal marks an about-face for Healey, who opposed the idea as recently as March. Gas prices at the end of that month were about \$3.80 per gallon — about 60 cents less than today, per AAA.

“I just don’t think it’s going to get us very far right now in the overall picture,” Healey told WBZ then.

She similarly opposed a Republican-backed effort to suspend the gas tax during her first bid for the governor’s office four years ago, when the state’s average gas prices jumped to a record high of over \$5 per gallon at one point. Then the state attorney general, Healey argued that the state should “look to real solutions to reduce costs and put money back in people’s pockets.”

But 2022 was a “different time,” Healey said Tuesday. “We didn’t have a president in Donald Trump who every day is jacking up the cost of everything, and we didn’t have a situation where it looks like there’s no end in sight and no plan.”

Healey already has a series of priorities collecting dust on Beacon Hill, where some remain in the hands of negotiators from the House and Senate or have been outright rejected by legislative leaders. The gov-



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey said President Trump “every day is jacking up the cost of everything.”

ernor, ahead of her reelection fight, has repeatedly urged lawmakers to pass a bill aimed at reducing energy costs, for example, or proposed sending another \$100 million to local school districts — the latter of which was shut down almost immediately by the House’s budget chief.

Healey plans to include the gas tax proposal in a supplemental budget she is expected to file to close out the books on the last fiscal year, which ended June 30. It would require legislative approval, and there are already signs that securing buy-in from the State House’s most powerful Democrats could be

difficult.

Doug Howgate — president of the Massachusetts Taxpayers Foundation, a business-backed budget watchdog — has noted the gas tax already faced money troubles in recent years amid changes such as increasing electric vehicle ownership, cutting into what the state has collected from the levy.

A suspension of the tax could exacerbate some “real, legitimate public finance constraints on resources that may be pledged to things like supporting our roads and bridges,” he said.

“It’s important that we make sure whatever relief we try to

pursue in the near term is not coming at the expense of greater costs or further investment deficits going forward,” Howgate said.

Senator Jamie Eldridge, a Marlborough Democrat who co-chairs the Legislature’s revenue committee, said he was “really shocked” to see Healey propose suspending the gas tax. Eldridge said the prospect of voting against the proposal “absolutely creates a challenge” in his district, which he said is “sort of blue” but includes a mix of voters. Eldridge is facing a Republican challenger, Joseph Shea, in November.

“Just days ago, this was pro-

posed by the Republican nominee,” Eldridge said of suspending the gas tax. “To me, it comes across as a bit gimmicky to suspend the gas tax in an election year.”

In a statement, Senate President Karen E. Spilka said she would review the language whenever Healey filed it, but she otherwise praised Healey for trying ways to find relief during what she called a “needless war in Iran and trade wars with our allies.”

“Governor Healey has pulled every lever at her disposal to lower costs for Massachusetts residents at a moment when Donald Trump and Republicans in Congress are driving prices higher,” the Ashland Democrat said.

Advocates for more transportation funding, too, were taken aback by Healey’s proposal.

“I know the governor has put affordability front and center in the past couple months . . . but transportation investments have also been a major priority of hers,” said Lizzy Weyant, executive director at the Metropolitan Area Planning Council. “Anything that would short-change that was a little surprising to me.”

Samantha J. Gross of the Globe staff contributed to this report. Kelly Garrity can be reached at kelly.garrity@globe.com. Anjali Huynh can be reached at anjali.huynh@globe.com.

Metro

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THE BOSTON GLOBE WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 23, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/METRO

SJC orders new trial in festival slaying

Rules that prior proceeding in J’ouvert shooting flawed

By John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF
and Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The man convicted of firing the shot that killed Dawnn A. Jaffier, a beloved youth mentor who became an innocent victim of gunfire while attending Boston’s J’ouvert parade in 2014, was granted a new trial Tuesday.

In a unanimous ruling, the Supreme Judicial Court said the Suffolk Superior Court trial of Keith Williams was constitutionally flawed because a judge wrongly allowed prosecutors to present gun-



Dawnn N. Jaffier was fatally shot in 2014 while attending the J’ouvert celebration in Boston.

shot residue evidence to the jury.

Police found only two microscopic particles of gunshot residue, a mixture of barium nitrate, lead styphnate, and antimony sulfide, on Williams’s hands, the SJC said.

However, a minimum of three particles are considered necessary for the testing to be considered valid, the decision said, and during Williams’s 2017 trial, Superior Court Judge Christine M. Roach allowed prosecutors to use the inadequate data.

Writing for the court, Justice Elizabeth N. Dewar emphasized that the gunshot residue was the linchpin of the prosecution’s case.

“The disputed gunshot residue testimony figured prominently in the Commonwealth’s case ... and [prosecutors] used this evidence to conclude that the defendant was the shooter,” Dewar wrote. “The Commonwealth’s evidence identifying the defendant as the shooter was not overwhelming.”

Citing the overall weakness of the evidence against Williams, along with the importance prose-

RULING, Page B4

Clancy’s lawyers file motion to drop case

Contend judge erred in declaring mistrial

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

Lawyers for Lindsay Clancy filed a motion to dismiss on Monday, claiming the judge’s mistrial declaration earlier this month was done in error and therefore Clancy should not be able to be tried again for killing her three children.

The lawyers contend Superior Court Judge William F. Sullivan should have done more to probe jurors about whether the lone holdout juror against finding her not guilty by reason of insanity was deliberating inappropriately and therefore should have been removed. Because the judge should have taken those other steps to dig deeper, Clancy’s lawyers argue, Sullivan should not have declared a mistrial. Therefore, they argued, to try her again would violate the longstanding constitutional prohibition against prosecuting a person twice for the same crime.

“Accordingly, any successive trial would constitute a violation of Ms. Clancy’s Double Jeopardy rights,” Clancy’s lawyer Martin G. Weinberg wrote in the filing.

The judge did not act on the motion immediately, and the prosecution has yet to file a response. But the motion to dismiss the charges will be a major focus of future proceedings in the triple-murder case that’s drawn national attention and superheated internet speculation; it’s one of several attempts by her defense in the weeks that have followed the mistrial to end the case ahead of a retrial. If it’s granted, the prosecution of Clancy for the killing of her three children would end.

Though Clancy would be technically found not guilty of killing Cora, 5, Dawson, 3, and Callan, 8 months, during

CLANCY, Page B4

MIT snags No. 1 spot on U.S. News list

Supplants Princeton after 15-year streak

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

Move over, Princeton.

The Massachusetts Institute of Technology has claimed the No. 1 spot among national universities in the U.S. News & World Report’s 2027 Best Colleges Rankings, ending the New Jersey Ivy’s 15-year reign and topping Harvard, at No. 3.

Other New England schools continued to shine in the rankings. Williams College once again topped the list among national liberal arts colleges, with Amherst College holding steady at No. 2.

Babson College, eligible for the overall rankings for the first time, got off to a winning start at No. 1 for northern regional universities due to “the strength of its financial resources, high graduation rates, and strong outcomes of its graduates,” according to U.S. News.

In a statement, MIT said it is proud to be “part of a strong network of ex-

MIT, Page B3



PHOTOS BY JIM DAVIS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Kris Kucera removed the decorative bucket he uses to cover the well on his property in Topsham, Maine. He’s had to let dozens of tomatoes (below) and peppers go to save water for his hundreds of trees and shrubs. In parts of the state, precipitation levels are now between 9 and 17 inches below normal, said an official with Maine’s Drought Task Force.

‘It was definitely dry last year, but it was nothing like this.’

TODD SIMONS, owner, Simons Hancock Farms & Greenhouse

Drought taking toll on Maine farmers

For 2nd straight year, lack of snow, rain also impacting state’s residents

By Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

As fall begins, Maine remains in the grips of an intense drought for the second straight year, a dry stretch that federal officials estimate is affecting more than 90 percent of residents.

Last fall, an extended dry spell brought record groundwater lows and choked off water supplies. This summer’s sequel has been even worse, many farmers said.

“It was definitely dry last year, but it was nothing like this,” said Todd Simons, owner of Simons Hancock Farms & Greenhouses, one of the largest vegetable growers

along a strip of coastal Maine from Hancock to Cumberland counties.

He’s estimating roughly \$75,000 to \$100,000 in losses this harvest from crops that didn’t survive the drought, including corn, lettuce, potatoes, peppers, and squash.

It’s a familiar refrain these days from produce farmers across the state, particularly in the hard-hit Midcoast and southern coastal regions, where conditions have been designated as severe to extreme by the US Drought Monitor.

As reports of drying wells surge, some communities have issued water restrictions, while the state’s Drought Management Task Force



550 number of residents who reported to the state that their wells had run dry last year. The numbers this year are lower but are beginning to climb again.

recently announced plans to hold its second emergency meeting in as many months.

In parts of the state, precipitation levels are now between 9 and 17 inches below normal, said Nick Stasulis, a supervisory physical scientist with the US Geological Survey who cochairs Maine’s Drought Task Force.

That kind of deficit, he said, won’t be made up quickly, he said.

“It’s not just short term,” he said. Dry conditions in the state are “becoming the new norm.”

Heavy rains brought by a nor’easter are expected to blanket the region this weekend, including

the southern most parts of Maine. If that storm pushes further north, under the best case-scenario, it could be a “drought buster,” meteorologist and Boston Globe contributor Dave Epstein said.

This year’s drought coincides with an increase in extreme weather across New England, he added.

While Maine experienced one of its hottest seasons on record this summer, southern Massachusetts saw record rainfall, while Cape Cod and Nantucket remain in the throes of their own significant drought, according to Massachusetts environmental officials.

DROUGHT, Page B4

City officials slam move to not replace Allston post office

By Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

Several local and state officials who represent Boston are fiercely criticizing the United States Postal Service after Allston residents learned this month that USPS no longer plans to reestablish a post office location in their neighborhood, which has been without

one for nearly seven years.

The reversal comes as USPS continues to face a “severe financial crisis,” with federal officials sounding the alarm that the postal service could run out of money by February next year. A number of Boston’s elected representatives, speaking at a council hearing on the issue Tuesday, said that the

USPS move to walk back its plans to reopen an Allston branch is part of a troubling trend of post office closures around the state, and inadequate mail service.

“The Allston neighborhood was promised a post office, and they deserve a post office,” said Senator Ed Markey in a statement Tuesday. “The United

States Postal Service is meant to be the front face of the federal government in every community, but it is turning its back on neighborhoods across the Commonwealth.

Boston City Council President Liz Breadon, who represents Allston-Brighton and called for Tuesday’s hearing, also slammed the decision and

called on USPS to “honor its commitments.”

“After years of public engagement, planning, and anticipation ... this abrupt reversal is incredibly frustrating for our community,” Breadon said. “Many residents, including Allston’s older adult population, immigrant communities, and

POST OFFICE, Page B3

INSIDE
Charged
Online influencer Clavicular has been charged with drugging and raping a teenager on Cape Cod, records show. **B2.**

Grounded
Delays at Logan Airport continued in the morning before easing later. **B2.**

WAVE ACTION



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

High surf pounded Nantasket Beach Tuesday in Hull as the historic Boston Light located on Little Brewster Island was seen in the distance, about 4 miles away in outer Boston Harbor. The high surf canceled some Cape and Islands ferries.

Influencer Clavicular faces rape charges

Allegedly drugged, assaulted teenager

By Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

Online influencer Clavicular is facing sexual assault charges for allegedly drugging and raping a teenager on Cape Cod, records show.

Authorities this month filed charges in Orleans District Court against Clavicular, 20, whose given name is Braden E. Peters, alleging rape, drugging someone for sexual intercourse, and procuring alcohol for someone under 21, according to legal filings.

Peters is not in custody and is scheduled for arraignment Oct. 14, records show. He had appeared on a livestream injecting the teen with a fat-dissolving compound laced with methamphetamine, legal filings allege.

The accuser has also filed a civil lawsuit against Peters stemming from the encounter that remains pending in Florida.

Mitchell Jackson, a spokesperson for Clavicular, said in a statement that the accuser initially filed a lawsuit against Peters “and doesn’t include sexual



A lawyer for Braden E. Peters told Rolling Stone earlier this year that the influencer “denies the claims.”

assault as a count. Then she amends it and adds it a couple of months later.”

Peters “then filed a motion to dismiss fighting the civil lawsuit because letter/text messages show she knew what was happening with the injections and he refused to pay money,” Jackson said. “She and her lawyer then go to police.”

The alleged assault occurred on May 23, 2025, at the Chatham home of Peters’s parents, according to a police report. The alleged victim was 17 at the time.

Peters was broadcasting a livestream video in his bedroom, police said.

“Before entering his bedroom, he instructed her to lie on the livestream to say that she is

18 years old,” the police report said. “He also instructed her to say that the alcohol is water, so that neither his Twitch account nor livestream gets banned.”

The teenager told police that she began to relax after consuming the vodka Peters offered her, police said.

“She stated that she only began to be flirty after the alcohol was consumed, where she and Mr. Peters ‘kissed once on the stream,” the report said.

She told police the two later made out on a couch when the stream ended, the report said.

Police said she also “stated that she fell asleep in his bed and the next morning, she woke up to Mr. Peters ‘having sex with me.’ She stated that because it was already occurring, she did

not tell Mr. Peters to stop. [Redacted] advised that she did not consent to the sexual intercourse.”

The teenager said she “did not have any intention on having sex with Mr. Peters either the night before or morning after,” the report said.

In August, police twice tried to call Peters’s phone to question him, but he did not pick up either time and his voicemail was full.

“At this time, Mr. Peters has not reached out to the Chatham Police Department regarding this case,” said a supplemental police report dated Aug. 31.

The charges come months after the woman, now 18, filed her suit against Peters in Miami, alleging he had served her several rounds of vodka and had non-consensual sex with her at his parents’ home on Cape Cod.

A lawyer for Peters, a leading avatar of the “looksmaxxing” wave popular with young men, told Rolling Stone earlier this year that the influencer “denies the claims and disputes the characterization of events.”

The term “looksmaxxing” refers to the viral movement that

involves going to radical lengths to optimize physical attractiveness.

According to the woman’s lawsuit, Peters also injected her cheeks with a fat-dissolving compound laced with methamphetamine during a livestreaming session in November 2025, leaving her with a perforated cheek. The woman, also a “looksmaxxing” influencer, alleges in the suit that she landed a \$15,000-a-month sponsorship with an online trading platform in January but lost it after Peters bad-mouthed her and used his “enormous following and popularity online” to discredit her.

On Monday night, Clavicular appeared to adopt a combative posture in response to the allegations, writing on X, “Happens to all successful young men, people try to come for your money. Greed is evil.” He also posted a Tiktok video of the accuser from November who said during a live chat that she’s “not dating Clav, just did a little stream together where he injected Aqualyx. It was really fun.”

Travis Andersen can be reached at travis.andersen@globe.com.

This day in history

Today is Wednesday, Sept. 23, the 266th day of 2026. There are 99 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Singer Julio Iglesias is 83. Actor-singer Mary Kay Place is 79. Rock star Bruce Springsteen is 77. Director-playwright George C. Wolfe is 72. Actor Rosalind Chao is 69. Actor Jason Alexander is 67. Actor Chi McBride is 65. Singer Ani DiFranco is 56. Producer-rapper Jermaine Dupri is 54. Filmmaker Yorgos Lanthimos is 53. Actor Anthony Mackie is 48. Actor Skylar Astin is 39. High diver Molly Carlson is 28. Singer Artemas is 27.

►In 1780, British spy John Andre was captured along with papers revealing Benedict Arnold’s plot to surrender West Point to the British.

►In 1806, the Lewis and Clark expedition returned to St. Louis, more than two years after setting out for the Pacific Northwest.

►In 1952, Republican Senator Richard M. Nixon of California salvaged his vice presidential nomination by appearing on television from Los Angeles to refute allegations of improper campaign fundraising in what became known as the “Checkers” speech for its reference to his family’s cocker spaniel.

►In 1955, a jury in Sumner, Miss., acquitted two white men, Roy Bryant and J.W. Milam, of killing Black teenager Emmett Till. (The two later admitted to the crime in an interview with Look magazine.)

►In 1957, nine Black students who entered Little Rock Central High School in Arkansas were forced to leave under police escort because of a white mob outside. The Little Rock Nine returned under federal troop escort two days later for their first full day at the school.

►In 1962, “The Jetsons,” an animated cartoon series about a Space Age family, premiered as the ABC television network’s first program in color.

►In 2002, Governor Gray Davis signed a law making California the first state to offer workers paid family leave.

►In 2018, capping a comeback from four back surgeries, Tiger Woods won the Tour Championship in Atlanta, the 80th victory of his PGA Tour career and his first in more than five years.

►In 2022, Roger Federer played his final professional match after an illustrious career that included 20 Grand Slam titles.

►In 2024, Israeli military strikes on Lebanon killed more than 490 people, including more than 90 women and children in one of the deadliest barrages since the 2006 Israel-Hezbollah war.

More delays at Logan, US after equipment woes

By John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF

Hundreds of flight delays were reported at Boston Logan International Airport Tuesday, appearing to signal an end to technical problems that disrupted air travel across the Northeast the day before.

There were 284 flights delayed at the airport as of Tuesday evening, and 15 cancellations, according to FlightAware, the online tracking platform.

Nationally, the Federal Aviation Administration’s national airspace status reported no major issues nationwide on Tuesday.

FlightAware’s Misery Map reported 567 delays and 9 cancellations nationwide as of Tuesday evening.

The travel problems began Monday morning after a circuit failed at a FAA facility in Philadelphia.

When the system attempted to switch to a backup connection, workers discovered that a fiber-optic line had been cut, the FAA reported Monday.

Delays at Logan have also been impacted by the closure of a runway for a safety construction project that started Aug. 31. It is due to be completed before Thanksgiving, Logan said on its website.

“During this time, travelers



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

A runway construction project has also delayed air traffic at Logan Airport.

may experience temporary flight delays, particularly during afternoon and evening hours, and neighboring communities may notice changes in aircraft activity,” an airport advisory states. “If you’re flying through Logan, please check your flight status directly with your airline before heading to the airport.”

Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy on Monday blamed

an Amtrak construction crew that had accidentally cut the fiber line in New Jersey, causing a telecommunications outage that disrupted air traffic across the Northeast.

The mechanical issue was repaired by 6 p.m. Monday, Duffy wrote on social media.

The FAA issue, along with construction at Logan, contributed to hundreds of flights being delayed, and dozens of can-

cellations by Monday night, according to FlightAware.

Confusion and frustration spread around Logan Monday night as passengers crowded flight information screens and lined up for airline assistance, The Boston Globe reported.

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The Boston Globe

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	City	Retail	Other
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Sunday only home delivery	\$22.50	22.50	22.50
Daily single copy	\$4.00	4.00	4.00
Sunday single copy	\$6.00	6.00	6.00

Lottery

TUESDAY MIDDAY Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet) <u>EXACT ORDER</u> All 4 digits \$5,676 First or last 3 \$795 Any 2 digits \$68 Any 1 digit \$7 <u>ANY ORDER</u> All 4 digits \$236 First 3 \$132 Last 3 \$132	MASS CASH Sept. 22 5-24-25-26-34 Jackpot: \$100,000; no winners MEGA MILLIONS Sept. 22 7-13-26-37-68 Megaball 8 Jackpot: \$261m; TBD winners PREVIOUS DRAWINGS <table><tr><td></td><td>Midday</td><td>Night</td></tr><tr><td>Monday</td><td>4848</td><td>0487</td></tr><tr><td>Sunday</td><td>2639</td><td>0856</td></tr><tr><td>Saturday</td><td>0287</td><td>8360</td></tr><tr><td>Friday</td><td>3053</td><td>7632</td></tr><tr><td>Thursday</td><td>2516</td><td>9389</td></tr></table>		Midday	Night	Monday	4848	0487	Sunday	2639	0856	Saturday	0287	8360	Friday	3053	7632	Thursday	2516	9389
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MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE Sept. 21 7-14-40-44-51 MB 1 Jackpot: \$1 million per year																			

MIT claims top spot on US college ranking list

►MIT
Continued from Page B1
cellent colleges and universities across the nation, dedicated to educating students and pursuing curiosity-driven research,” noting that “America’s economic strength, scientific leadership, and national security depend on world-class education and research institutions.”

This year marks the 42nd edition of the report, which evaluates about 1,700 institutions and it arrives during a tumultuous time for many of them.

The Trump administration continues its pressure campaign on multiple fronts, and students and families question the value of a college degree amid rising costs. Last spring, the Commonwealth saw the financial meltdowns of two small colleges, Hampshire and Anna Maria.

The annual college rankings list is like the Oscars for higher education, but it remains controversial. Some in the sector say it doesn’t matter if one school replaces another in a long list of top schools.

“It has no meaning unless you’re looking solely for cocktail party banter, if you’re looking to brag: ‘My child is going to a college that U.S. News says is number one,’” said Larry Ladd, a college finance expert and former Harvard budget officer.

Many colleges have long refrained from publicly promoting the rankings because of concerns about reinforcing potential biases in any one formula, contributing to admissions frenzies, and lending validity to the idea that educational success can — or even should — be ranked.

Two decades ago, about 20 college and university presidents made their positions official in a signed statement



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

This year marks the 42nd edition of the U.S. News & World Report’s Best Colleges report.

pledging “not to mention U.S. News or similar rankings ... since such lists mislead the public into thinking that the complexities of American higher education can be reduced to one number.”

Nevertheless, for many prospective students and their families, U.S. News is still considered “the king of college rankings. Every other ranking lives in its shadow,” said Jayson Weingarten, a senior admissions consultant with the Manhattan-based Ivy Coach. “In some corners of the country, and the world, it’s treated almost like the Bible.”

He granted that it’s an “imperfect” system, adding that, in the past, “some schools, like Northeastern, have gamed it masterfully and climbed up quickly,” while others — he named Brown and Dartmouth — have long underperformed.

As for liberal arts colleges, “They’re practically an afterthought,” Weingarten said, noting Williams has ranked No. 1 among liberal arts colleges for over two decades. “How many people even know that?”

According to U.S. News, the 2027 report is based on adapted methodology meant to address the question of the moment: “Is college worth it?” Changes include adding a “new earnings by major” ranking fac-

tor, which evaluates graduate earnings four years after graduation using data from the US Department of Education’s College Scorecard.

There’s also a new focus on federal financial aid recipients in the workforce whose highest degree is a bachelor’s, for the purpose of minimizing the impact of pre-existing family financial advantages.

“With families increasingly scrutinizing the true cost and return on investment of a college degree, our goal is to provide clear, actionable data,” LaMont Jones Jr., managing editor for education at U.S. News, said in a statement.

Among the top 25 national universities, MIT ranks high, at No. 3, for the percentage of students receiving federal Pell Grants. It performs at the highest level in post-graduate earnings metrics, as well as faculty research and incoming students’ SAT/ACT scores.

Weingarten pointed out that MIT graduates a large number of students in lucrative STEM fields, with some landing at companies such as Anthropic and OpenAI.

“We may not be able to see inside the U.S. News algorithm,” he said, “but this is as clear an indication as any of why MIT could supplant Princeton at No. 1.”

Harvard placed second in the category of top-five value schools for national universities, after Princeton, while Amherst College leads in economic diversity among the top 25 liberal arts colleges.

Brown University is in a third-place tie with Washington University in St. Louis in the category of top five schools for veterans: national universities.

The University of Massachusetts Amherst, meanwhile, climbed five spots to No. 24 for public national universities, making it the only public institution in New England to place in the Top 30.

In a statement, UMass Amherst chancellor Javier A. Reyes reaffirmed the university’s commitment to “teaching, research and service for the common good.”

While recognition never hurts, Ladd warned against taking the rankings too seriously.

“It’s a disservice to aspiring students and parents to give them the feeling that these minute differences matter,” he said. “What matters is: Is this the right place for your child? And these rankings don’t answer that question.”

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Restaurant owner facing charges

Allegedly pulled gun on customers

By Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The owner of a Mediterranean restaurant in Springfield was charged with armed robbery for allegedly following two teenage customers on Friday who didn’t pay their bill, threatening them with a gun, and hitting both in the face while demanding payment, police said.

Nadim E. Kashouh, the 61-year-old owner of Nadim’s Downtown Mediterranean Grill, pleaded not guilty Monday in Springfield District Court to charges of felony armed robbery, two counts of assault with a dangerous weapon, and two misdemeanor assault charges.

After an 18-year-old man and a 17-year-old girl left the restaurant without paying their \$92.40 bill shortly before 8 p.m. on Friday, Kashouh allegedly followed them to a nearby convenience store and flashed a gun at them, grabbing the girl’s phone and demanding to be paid before he would return it, police said, citing security footage that captured the altercation.

Both teenagers will be issued criminal complaints for defrauding a restaurant, police said.

The pair said they tried to pay their bill, but after their card was declined multiple times, they left the restaurant, the report said, heading along Harrison Avenue and turning onto Chestnut Street while Kashouh began “running after them” ahead of an employee.

He confronted them outside the convenience store where he allegedly elbowed the girl in the face and punched the man in his face, causing bruising and lacerations, police said.

Still holding the girl’s phone, Kashouh began walking back toward his restaurant as the two followed him, now joined by a small group of bystanders who asked him to return it.

At that point, Kashouh alleg-

edly pointed his gun at the group, waving it in the air, according to multiple witnesses, including restaurant employees, the report said.

In a statement posted on the restaurant’s social media page Monday, a representative for Kashouh wrote that he “maintains his innocence and says he acted in self-defense.”

He “looks forward to the opportunity to fully address the facts and circumstances surrounding the incident,” the statement said. “Mr. Kashouh was grateful for the opportunity to appear in court today and respond to the allegations against him.”

When police spoke to the female patron, she said “she believed she was going to lose her life.”

Kashouh admitted to pointing the gun at the group but told police he’d done so in self-defense, stating someone in the group had already told him they had a gun.

A license check revealed Kashouh had two guns registered to him and an active license to carry, the report said.

Nadim’s Downtown Mediterranean Grill celebrated its 25th anniversary earlier this month in a ceremony attended by Mayor Domenic Sarno, designating Sept. 10 as Springfield’s “Nadim’s Mediterranean Restaurant and Grill Day,” according to a posting by the restaurant.

A spokesperson for Sarno did not immediately respond to a request for comment. A lawyer for Kashouh could not be reached for comment.

Following news of the allegations, multiple residents took to social media to voice support for Kashouh, including Maureen Pinette, a former employee of the Springfield Business Improvement District, who wrote on Tuesday that the restaurateur is “respectful, fair, calm, and incredibly hardworking.”

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Boston officials slam move to not replace Allston post office

►POST OFFICE
Continued from Page B1

small business owners, rely on USPS for the essential services that it provides.”

USPS closed its only Allston location in 2019 due to structural issues with the building at 47 Harvard Ave. Residents and elected officials have advocated for USPS to replace the branch for years.

In a June 2025 letter, a USPS official told Mayor Michelle Wu that the postal service made a “final decision” to reopen the Allston post office at a new location, “as close as reasonably possible” to the old one. A new space would allow USPS to “re-establish retail operations for our customers in Allston, MA for the long term” and “maintain and improve our service for the community.”

But earlier this month, Allston residents received letters from USPS saying the postal service is reversing course and intends to “permanently close” its Allston branch, according to copies of the letters shared by Breadon.

In the letters, USPS officials noted that the decision is not final, and the postal service is collecting public feedback, evaluating customer needs, and studying the feasibility of ending its in-person retail presence in Allston.

Breadon, along with several other Boston city councilors and some state lawmakers, sent a letter to the USPS last week opposing the proposed closure and demanding that USPS reopen an Allston post office.

Breadon on Tuesday emphasized that about 87,000 residents in Allston and Brighton depend on a single post office location in Brighton, while Newton has 10.

USPS officials declined invitations to testify at Tuesday’s council hearing, Councilor Sharon Durkan said. USPS also refused to speak at an emergency council hearing on mail delays

in 2024, and flouted a rare subpoena the council issued in an attempt to compel officials to attend.

Judy Ferriera, a spokesperson for USPS in New England, said in a statement to the Globe that USPS has a process it must follow before closing a branch, and that no final decision has been made about the Allston location. Those steps include so-

‘Many residents, including Allston’s older adult population, immigrant communities, and small business owners, rely on USPS for the essential services that it provides.’

LIZ BREADON, *Boston City Council president*

liciting and evaluating public feedback, she wrote.

Officials got wind that USPS was questioning whether to reopen its Allston branch in April this year, when Breadon received an email from a USPS official saying the postal service will “temporarily pause looking for an alternative facility while it further reviews the operational needs of the Allston, MA area.”

Later in April, the Boston real estate development firm Eden Properties said USPS abruptly pulled out of a plan to move into one of its properties.

Eden Properties purchased the site of the old Allston post office on Harvard Avenue in 2021, and worked closely with

USPS to design the ground floor to accommodate a new post office, said Noah Maslan, a principal at Eden Properties, at the hearing Tuesday.

But after Eden redesigned the space according to USPS specifications and renegotiated a lease agreement, USPS backed out, Maslan said.

“Reestablishing the post office was number one on everybody’s list, so we diligently started to try to make that happen,” Maslan said. “We’ve probably spent more time working on this tenant than any tenant we’ve ever worked with. ... We were just devastated.”

USPS officials emphasized the decision was made out of financial necessity in a letter sent to Senators Markey and Elizabeth Warren and Representative Ayanna Pressley in July.

“Please understand that we must carefully evaluate proposals for multi-million-dollar expenditures — such as Allston — at a time when our financial position is dire,” wrote Scott Slusher, a government relations director for USPS.

At Tuesday’s hearing, a number of longtime Allston residents testified before the council to criticize the proposal of a permanent closure. Some said that they often have to wait in long and frustrating lines at the Brighton branch or have had packages stolen, and emphasized the importance of a post office to their community.

“It is a constitutional issue; the inconvenience of not having a post office is tangible,” said Allston resident Wendy Schwartz. “The federal government is not living up to its obligations, and the fact that it reversed itself, I think is just inappropriate, and that we should keep fighting and get our post office back.”

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Lawyers for Lindsay Clancy claim double jeopardy

►**CLANCY**
Continued from Page B1

what she called a postpartum psychotic episode, she would not necessarily be released if the motions are approved; she would likely be committed by a judge to a mental health hospital.

Clancy's first trial ended in a mistrial earlier this month. She has admitted to killing her children, but has claimed what's often referred to as the insanity defense — that she should not be criminally responsible because, in her case, she was deep in the throes of postpartum mental illness.

Clancy's monthlong trial this past summer ended controversially, with the jury sending multiple notes to Sullivan that there was one juror holding out for guilt in a way that the other jurors, who wanted to find her not

guilty by reason of insanity, found inappropriate. They said he expressed doubt that she was

‘Accordingly, any successive trial would constitute a violation of Ms. Clancy’s Double Jeopardy rights.’

MARTIN G. WEINBERG

legally sane, but wouldn't find her not guilty by reason of insanity, as would then be required; he has since said through a lawyer that he did not have such doubts and was merely sticking by his beliefs about the case.

Weinberg, a well-known law-

yer Clancy hired to handle these post-trial arguments, argued in his 34-page motion to dismiss on Monday that the notes alleged juror misconduct and therefore the judge should have conducted more questioning of jurors than he did, particularly of the foreperson, who wrote the notes, and the holdout.

“Clancy, like all criminal defendants, had a Constitutional right to have her fate decided by an impartial jury of her peers, faithfully applying the law as instructed rather than superimposing the juror’s own view of legal right and wrong, including the foundational principle that, absent proof beyond a reasonable doubt of her guilt, she must be acquitted,” Weinberg wrote. “The multiple reports of a juror violating this bedrock principle, therefore, required a judicial in-

quiry sufficient to ascertain whether her right to an impartial jury was being violated.”

Much of the specifics of what led up to the mistrial remain out of public view. For example, many of the notes were not read aloud in court, so the specifics of what the other jurors told the judge about the holdout aren't publicly available. This filing fills in few gaps: Weinberg's motion cites multiple notes but redacts much of them in the filing available to the public.

Clancy's motion to dismiss carries echoes of the proceedings that followed the mistrial declaration that ended the first trial of Karen Read, the Mansfield woman who was accused of killing her boyfriend. That mistrial declaration too was controversial when it came in July 2024, and, like this case, Weinberg joined

the legal team to argue that a defendant should not be tried again because of split jury deliberations. Ultimately, Read did not prevail and was retried last year, though she was acquitted of all charges in her boyfriend's death at the end of that trial.

Weinberg himself notes the similarities in this case, citing the proceedings against his former client multiple times in the filing he entered for Clancy on Monday. But he calls this case the “antithesis” of Read's.

For Read, the controversy came from the strongly worded notes that the jury sent, claiming that they were deeply deadlocked. After the judge declared a mistrial, multiple jurors spoke out publicly to clarify that they were only deadlocked on one count, that of manslaughter, and actually seemed to be in agree-

ment on the others. The argument was that they'd miscommunicated the reality of deliberations on most of the charges, because they didn't know what to do with the situation they were in.

The state's highest court ultimately rejected Weinberg's argument for Read, saying the judge in that case had acted reasonably based on the notes she'd received.

In Clancy's case, “by contrast, we have a jury that was calling out for help, not once but twice informing the Court that its deliberations were being hijacked by a juror's disregard of the Court's instructions,” Weinberg wrote.

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For 2nd straight year, drought taking toll on Maine farmers

►**DROUGHT**
Continued from Page B1

“New England's always had extreme weather, but the dry is becoming drier, and the wet wetter,” Epstein noted, saying the trend was “most likely due to human-induced climate change.”

This year's drought in Maine is primarily a result of a dearth of snow and rainfall during the winter and spring, which prevented the already arid ground from replenishing itself after last fall's drought, Stasulis said.

If conditions persist, similar trends could continue and possibly affect another growing season, said Tom Gordon, a public service coordinator with the state's Department of Agriculture, Conservation and Forestry.

“It's definitely hitting the wallets of farmers,” said Gordon, who coordinates drought relief funding for farmers. They're left “hoping for rain . . . [at] the most important time of the year,” he added.

Last year, apple farmer Bob Sewall enjoyed one of his best yields from his orchard outside Camden.

This year, it's down about 70 percent.

Digging even 6 feet down on his property, “there wasn't a drop of groundwater,” Sewall said.

Most crops need about 1 inch of precipitation a week during the growing season, especially during the end of summer, Gordon said.

But that level hasn't been reached in months.

For now, the state's forests are holding up OK, said state forest health pathologist Aaron Bergdahl, and the drought will likely extend this year's fall foliage season by causing early coloration.

But the drought has exposed cracks in Maine's agricultural infrastructure, where 85 per-



JIM DAVIS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Kris Kucera tended to a dried out shin deshojo Japanese maple tree on his property in Topsham, Maine.

cent of farmers lack irrigation and water crops by hand, Stasulis said.

Keena Tracy, operator of Little Ridge Farm in Lisbon, where only a few fields have irrigation, said the persistent lack of rainfall has caused spikes in labor costs to keep everything watered.

Even then, many fruits grew small this year while other crops were given up entirely, she said.

“If we're not getting the yield . . . then we're not even breaking even with that extra labor,” Tracy said.

Water supply issues are impacting nonfarmers, too, since large sections of the state rely

on well water for drinking, showers, and other needs.

Last year, more than 550 residents reported to the state's drought task force that their wells had run dry using a state survey.

This year, that number is down to 83, though many of the cases have just begun being reported this month.

Drilling a new well to access deeper water supplies can cost about \$20,000, Gordon added.

Communities with public water access aren't faring much better.

Several communities across the state have implemented water restrictions including Kittery, where residents like John

Bailey face a \$500 fine and having their water shut off if they don't comply with a mandate limiting lawn watering to two days per week.

Bailey said the restriction killed his vegetable garden and caused the neighborhood to be overrun with “dirty cars,” and “dirty animals.”

“It's absolutely ridiculous,” he said, adding he's frustrated Kittery has restricted water use while neighboring communities have kept pumps flowing.

Kris Kucera, a retired Topsham resident, has a working well but said he “can't in good conscience water my yard,” during a drought.

Trying to keep the plants and

vegetables on his land healthy is “like I'm Sisyphus with a hose,” he said, adding he's had to let dozens of tomatoes and peppers go to save water for his hundreds of trees and shrubs.

“You can just look at the trees and see how bad they're hurting,” Kucera said, adding his grass feels like “walking on tinder.”

He's slowly giving up hope for wetter days.

“At this point we almost need a deus ex machina to come in and save the day,” he said.

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SJC orders new trial for man convicted of ‘14 shooting

►**RULING**
Continued from Page B1

cutors placed on the gunshot residue, the SJC ordered a new trial.

“The testimony about the subthreshold number of gunshot residue particles should not have been admitted,” the court ruled. “Because this error was prejudicial in the circumstances here, the defendant is entitled to a new trial.”

The killing of Jaffier, 26, during one of the city's largest celebrations of Caribbean culture, devastated her family and the large number of people whose lives she had positively impacted.

“We were all there in the courtroom for the entire trial [and] it was so painful,” Andrea Howard, chief executive of the West End House, a youth development group where Jaffier once worked, said Tuesday. “To think that that might have to be repeated, I really haven't got past that.”

Jaffier was the rare young person who knew exactly what she wanted to do and was doing it “extraordinarily well” early in life, Howard recalled.

“She knew she wanted to help young people and she went about it in such a powerful way

that she was able to impact so many kids across the city in such a short period of time,” she said. “It takes people years to decades to have the reach that she did.”

Since Jaffier's death, the West End House has dedicated various philanthropic projects in her honor, including hosting a Boston Marathon team in her name, allocating various student grants, and hosting the Light of Dawnn Awards, which honor front-line nonprofit professionals.

“She was one of those people who, even as a teen, you just knew she was going to make the world a better place,” John Leary, who knew Jaffier at the West End House, told the Globe in 2014. “The younger kids looked up to her, her friends looked up to her, and even staff members looked to Dawnn. Big or small, she was there to help.”

Her father, Ian Jaffier, publicly mourned the loss of his daughter and at the time appealed for the public's help in catching her killer.

Howard said that the detectives in the case seemed “earnest in getting justice,” when they met with her and Jaffier's family after the shooting.

“I can't question their com-

mitment,” she said on Tuesday, but “somebody didn't do something right in the justice system . . . [and] I'm still just thinking about how difficult this must be for the family.”

Tuesday's decision comes five years after the SJC threw out the first-degree murder conviction of Wesson Colas, whom Williams was allegedly to have been shooting at when Jaffier was struck.

Although antagonists at the time of the Jaffier shooting — Colas allegedly pointed a pistol at Williams and his two friends — the two men were tried jointly in 2017.

In reversing Colas's conviction, the SJC said the fact that he was armed during the incident was not enough evidence to support a first-degree murder conviction.

Colas pleaded guilty to a reduced charge of involuntary manslaughter in 2022 and was sentenced to seven years in prison, which he had already served, records show.

On Aug. 26, 2014, Williams was 18 and with two other men when they argued with Colas near a Blue Hill Avenue convenience store.

Jaffier happened to be walking nearby while attending the



Keith Williams sat during his 2018 murder trial in Suffolk Superior Court.

J'ouvert celebration and was struck in the head by one of several shots Williams allegedly fired from a .357 caliber pistol, the SJC said.

It was 8:17 a.m.

While finding fault with the gunshot residue evidence, the SJC rejected a separate defense argument that there was insufficient evidence that Williams's alleged actions met the legal definition of deliberate premeditation when he fired the gun.

Williams “was captured on surveillance footage outside the store” an hour before the shooting and was also shown “holding the murder weapon mere seconds after the shooting.”

Williams's attorney, Robert F. Shaw Jr., said Tuesday said that Williams has been wrongly identified as Jaffier's killer.

“Keith Williams was not the person who fired the gun,” he said.

Shaw also said that whoever did fire the shots should not be convicted of murder. He said Colas was pointing a gun at Williams and two other men when someone saw the gun and screamed a warning.

“I don't know what other set of facts more clearly establishes self-defense or defense of another,” Shaw said. “It's a tragic situation and just a terrible situation, but it's not a first-degree murder.”

Suffolk District Attorney Kevin R. Hayden, whose office has inherited the case, said they are studying the 33-page ruling and had no immediate comment.

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The Globe has been unable to confirm the exact date, time, or location of the alleged assault depicted in the video, and police declined to comment further on Tuesday.

“We encourage parents and guardians to know where their children are, who they are with, and what activities they are participating in, particularly during the evening and weekend hours,” Kelly wrote.

McDonald's did not immediately answer a request for comment.

In a statement posted Monday night, Mayor Jared Nicholson said he was “deeply concerned by the incidents involving young people in our community this weekend,” but added he's confident police will hold the individuals responsible to account.

“We have a responsibility to support our young people and help them navigate an increasingly challenging world,” he said, adding “we will continue to address violence when it occurs, hold individuals accountable and, just as importantly, work together to give our young people the support, structure and opportunities they need to succeed.”

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Business

City councilor takes aim at surveillance ‘loophole’ police use without approval

Utilize license plate readers and social media monitoring tools

By Yogev Toby

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

After complaining about being kept in the dark regarding the kinds of surveillance technology Boston police are using, a city councilor has filed a measure for Wednesday’s agenda that aims to improve the council’s oversight.

The city’s surveillance ordinance, which took effect in 2022, requires police to seek City Council’s approval whenever the department adopts new technologies. But councilors were displeased to discover that the department began using new surveillance tools, including automatic license plate

readers and social media monitoring tools, this year without disclosure.

“It was time to go back to the ordinance and try to make it work better,” said City Councilor Ben Weber, who filed the amendment and serves on the city’s Surveillance Oversight Advisory Board.

This summer, documents obtained by the Globe revealed that Boston police launched pilots for artificial intelligence-enabled license plate cameras with Axon Enterprise and Motorola Solutions. Those pilots followed a different, undisclosed pilot with Flock Safety, a company that has drawn nation-

wide controversy in recent months over cases of police misconduct and privacy concerns.

City officials have previously said the department didn’t need new council approval since they were just switching vendors.

In an annual surveillance report released last week, the department disclosed use of social media monitoring tools that at least some council members thought were no longer in use.

“We thank Councilor Weber for his leadership on these issues,” a spokesperson in Mayor Michelle Wu’s office

BPD SURVEILLANCE, Page B6



CHIP SOMODEVILLA/GETTY IMAGES

Boston police launched pilots for AI-enabled license plate cameras.

A revolving door

The Edward M. Kennedy Institute has seen high turnover among leaders



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE 2015

Vicki Kennedy said she doesn’t see the leadership changes at the nonprofit Kennedy Institute “as revolving, as much as evolving.”

SHIRLEY LEUNG
POWER PLAY



Ted Kennedy may have been one of the country’s longest-serving senators, but longevity doesn’t seem to apply to those running his namesake institute.

Since launching in 2009 to honor the late senator’s legacy of bipartisanship, the Edward M. Kennedy Institute for the United States Senate has had a revolving door of leaders: nine presidents and executive directors, plus six board chairs. Forgive me if I’ve missed one, but it’s hard to keep track of all the Kennedy acolytes

and interim execs for hire who’ve blown through there.

I’ve been wondering who’s in charge since news broke about a controversial party at the Kennedy compound in Hyannis Port. The institute, among its assets, owns the famous Kennedy home and has been renting it out — including to disgraced former Tyco International boss Dennis Kozlowski for his 80th birthday. That, as you can imagine, didn’t sit well with some of the Kennedys.

Turns out the institute’s last chief executive — former state

POWER PLAY, Page B6



Get in the loop with a twice-weekly dive into the power players and moves driving business in Massachusetts. Sign up for The Boston Globe’s scoop-driven Power Play newsletter, authored by prominent Globe columnists Shirley Leung and Jon Chesto.

Unions rally to get ahead of threat of AI

Contracts starting to include rules about implementation

By Rebecca Davis O’Brien

NEW YORK TIMES

Tim Sutter knows change is coming to Bath Iron Works, creeping up the adjacent Kennebec River in Maine like a foreboding fog.

Sutter, the president of the union that represents more than 4,400 workers who build ships for the US Navy at the shipyard, knows the workers must be prepared for the arrival of artificial intelligence.

“It’s going to be here,” said Sutter, 50, who has worked at the shipyard for nearly 30 years. “You have to wrap your head around it.”

Last month, when Local S6 of the International Association of Machinists and Aerospace Workers negotiated a new five-year contract with the defense company that runs the shipyard, the union insisted on updating longstanding language about technology. Now the union must be informed at the “conceptual stage,” rather than at implementation, of “any proposed addition or modified technology, equipment or process,” including AI and robotics.

UNIONS, Page B7



ROBERT F. BUKATY/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE/2020

Workers left after a shift at Bath Iron Works. A new contract requires that the union be informed “at the conceptual stage” of AI plans.

STAT

Addiction clinics see rise in kratom use

Even lower-strength products come with a risk of dependence

By Theresa Gaffney

STAT

Addiction clinics around the country are seeing a growing number of cases related to gas station products made from the kratom leaf and its derivatives.

At the telehealth addiction clinic Boulder Care, for example, people who report using kratom products constituted 3 percent of all new patients in September 2025. By July 2026 that number was 8 percent, and in August it jumped to 14 percent.

“That really is quite an explosion,” said Ayesha Appa, the company’s head of medical affairs.

Kratom has been sold in the US for decades, historically as a powder made from the dried leaf that’s native to Southeast Asia. People tout it for its mood- and energy-boosting powers, as well as pain relief.

Even for these lower-strength products, there’s a risk for

STAT, Page B8

THE BOSTON GLOBE

25

Index of publicly traded companies in Massachusetts

Globe 25 index

Total market cap: \$1,677.2b

High: 266.93
Low: 247.54
Last: 264.23

Yesterday 264.23 ▲ 3.09 ▲ 1.2% ▲ YTD 9.2%

	Price	Chg	% chg	Market cap (bil.)
GE VERNOVA INC (GEV)	950.28	+4.06	+0.4	253.1
THERMO FISHER (TMO)	658.52	-0.24	-0.0	243.5
ANALOG DEVICES (ADI)	390.37	+7.37	+1.9	189.2
TJX COS INC (TJX)	130.79	-0.17	-0.1	143.9
VERTEX PHARM (VRTX)	514.99	+4.27	+0.8	130.5
AMERICAN TOWER C (AMT)	175.25	+0.65	+0.4	81.7
MODERNA INC (MRNA)	182.56	+9.62	+5.6	72.9
BOSTON SCIENTIFC (BSX)	44.92	+1.20	+2.7	65.1
TERADYNE INC (TER)	398.69	+17.15	+4.5	62.3
STATE ST CORP (STT)	180.25	-4.15	-2.3	49.5
KEURIG DR PEPPER (KDP)	31.51	+0.89	+2.9	42.9
WATERS CORP (WAT)	425.74	+1.82	+0.4	41.8
IRON MOUNTAIN (IRM)	118.13	+1.24	+1.1	35.2
ALNYLAM PHARMACE (ALNY)	251.65	+7.33	+3.0	33.7
BIOGEN INC (BIIB)	225.36	+6.29	+2.9	33.3
SYMBOTIC INC (SYM)	45.07	+1.11	+2.5	27.3
EVERSOURCE ENERG (ES)	66.38	-0.51	-0.8	25.0
VERALTO CORP (VLT)	95.79	+0.61	+0.6	23.4
ENTEGRIS INC (ENTG)	151.11	+7.97	+5.6	23.1
MACOM TECHNOLOGY (MTSI)	279.69	+0.58	+0.2	21.4
MKS INC (MKS)	260.37	+3.45	+1.3	17.6
AKAMAI TECHNOLOG (AKAM)	118.34	+0.93	+0.8	17.0
CLEAN HARBORS (CLH)	312.85	+1.42	+0.5	16.5
PTC INC (PTC)	140.00	+4.72	+3.5	15.2
VICOR CORP (VICR)	268.34	+44.44	+19.8	12.4

Markets

Sparse returns as oil down a bit

The US stock market held near its record high on Tuesday after oil prices eased again. Stocks had been higher in the morning, when the price for a barrel of Brent crude briefly fell below \$98. But oil prices later trimmed their losses, and Brent settled at \$99.25 per barrel, down 1.1 percent. That's down from the nearly \$110 that it touched last week, but it's still much more expensive than the \$72 it was fetching before the war with Iran began. On Wall Street, AutoZone rose 3.3 percent after the retailer reported a stronger profit for the latest quarter than analysts expected, though its revenue fell short. CEO Phil Daniele said the auto parts seller faced "a difficult selling environment" in the first two months of the quarter, but it improved afterward and "we feel we are well positioned for sales growth" in its upcoming fiscal year. At Thor Industries, which sells recreational vehicles, the mood was more muted. CEO Bob Martin said expensive fuel, high interest rates, and still-high inflation are stretching its customers' budgets. Its stock rose 5.5 percent, though, after it delivered a stronger profit for the latest quarter than analysts expected.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS

DOW JONES industrial average

High: 54,349.12
Low: 51,461.9
Last: 51,863.69

Yesterday 51,863.69 ▼ 185.14 ▼ 0.4% ▲ YTD 7.9%

NASDAQ Composite index

High: 27,244.28
Low: 24,442.94
Last: 27,244.28

Yesterday 27,244.28 ▲ 122.19 ▲ 0.5% ▲ YTD 17.2%

S&P 500 index

High: 7,798.99
Low: 7,316.15
Last: 7,764.64

Yesterday 7,764.64 ▼ 0.06 ▼ 0.0% ▲ YTD 13.4%

SOURCE: Bloomberg News

Institute sees high turnover at the top

►POWER PLAY

Continued from Page B5

senator and United Nations negotiator Adam Hinds — left at the end of last year, around the same time board chair Bruce Percelay stepped down. For all of you steeped in the nonprofit world, you're screaming: Who does that?

Hinds, who took the \$300,000-a-year post in 2022, had one of the longer tenures, at just over three years. Percelay, a Boston developer and publisher of Nantucket's N Magazine, was at the helm for about five years.

Since December, Joe Hale, the institute's chief advancement officer, has filled in as interim chief executive. He previously ran the Indianapolis Motor Speedway Museum.

Then in April, Joe Kennedy III, the former Newton congressman and Ted Kennedy's

grand nephew who's served on the board, stepped in as cochair. He brought in Washington public affairs honcho Patrick Dorton to chair the board with him.

So what does Vicki Kennedy, Ted Kennedy's widow and the institute's cofounder, make of all this? "I don't see it as revolving, as much as evolving," Vicki Kennedy told me on Tuesday. Kennedy explained that the leadership changes reflect how the nonprofit has needed different skill sets at each stage — from concept, to groundbreaking, to broadening its scope.

The institute built its own museum located next to the JFK Library and Museum in Dorchester, on the water at Columbia Point.

Vicki Kennedy initially served on the institute's board but gave up her seat in 2021, when she was appointed ambas-

sador to Austria by then-President Biden. She left that post in 2025 and is back in Boston helping raise money and awareness about the institute. "We have a good leadership team to take it to the next level," said Kennedy, who does not have a formal managerial role at the institute.

And if you're wondering what she thought about the Kozlowski party at the Kennedy house, she didn't want to go there. (Sorry readers, I tried.)

The board is wrapping up a national search for a new chief executive and is updating its strategic plan for the next five years, according to the institute's leadership. The nonprofit said it runs experiential civic education programs and hosted nearly 200,000 students; it plans to unveil new exhibitions and programming this fall.

Despite all the turmoil at the

top, the Hinds-Percelay era ushered in a period of relative financial stability. For years, the institute had been losing millions of dollars, especially during the pandemic, when it shut down for about six months. Hinds and Percelay were able to stop the bleeding, and the institute operated in the black in 2022, 2023, and 2024, according to the latest financial filings.

Ted Kennedy was onto something when he wanted to create a place where future generations could learn the value of reaching across the aisle to get big things done. But it remains to be seen if there are enough people who still believe bipartisanship is worth fighting for in a country as deeply divided as ours.

Shirley Leung is a Business columnist. She can be reached at shirley.leung@globe.com.

JUSTIN SULLIVAN/GETTY IMAGES

Police have hailed surveillance technology as a powerful tool for finding criminals and solving serious crimes, but critics warn it can be used to invade people's privacy.

City Council to review police use of surveillance 'loophole'

►BPD SURVEILLANCE

Continued from Page B5

said Tuesday in a statement. "The city is reviewing this proposal and will continue working with councilors as they review the use of surveillance technology, including appropriate transparency measures and safeguards for Boston residents."

Police have hailed surveillance technology tools as powerful for finding criminals and solving serious crimes. Critics, however, warn that without sufficient oversight, these tools can be used to invade people's privacy and target individuals based on speech or political ideologies.

The proposed amendment aims to change key elements in the ordinance that Weber said previously gave Boston police a loophole to use new technology without City Council oversight: use of so-called "exigent circumstances" and switching vendors.

Switching vendors without notifying councilors "creates a loophole and goes against the original intention of this Ordinance," the proposed amendment says.

Under the current ordinance, Boston police can use surveillance technology without notifying the council if exigent circumstances apply. These circumstances mean that there is no time to seek approval due to a reasonable belief of an ongoing emergency that could lead to physical injury, death, or significant property damage.

The department cited exigent circumstances when it began using social media monitoring tools in 2023 and 2024, pointing to emerging threats online around the 2024 elections.

Last year, the council voted against the use of these tools.

But they are still being used today. The department disclosed its use of a new AI-powered social media analysis tool, LifeRaft, in the annual surveillance report. It's not immediately clear if the department cited exigent circumstances for that tool as well.

The Boston Police Department did not respond to a request for comment.

Weber's amendment would clarify that exigent circumstances are temporary, and the department will still need to seek council approval. If the City Council votes against using the technology, the department will need to stop its use or prove that there are "emergent threats that may impact public safety."

The amendment also clarifies that the department must notify the council whenever it switches vendors for a certain technology, even if the general use of the technology was already approved.

Additionally, Weber's amendment addresses privacy and data sharing concerns over police use of automatic license plate readers.

JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

'It was time to go back to the [city's surveillance] ordinance and try to make it work better.'

CITY COUNCILOR BEN WEBER, *who filed the amendment and serves on the city's Surveillance Oversight Advisory Board.*

The amendment requires that Boston police report a list of license plate reader vendors it is using, the number and locations of all cameras, the number of reads or "hotlist" hits per camera, as well as disclosures related to misuse of the technology and the policies meant to prevent it.

The approval process for the amendment could take months, Weber said. After being presented to the council on Wednesday, it will likely go to the Committee on Government Operations, where the chair can choose to hold a hearing or launch a working session in which members deliberate the amendments' clauses.

In a hearing, public safety officials, civil liberties advocates, and academics would testify before the committee, which will then make changes to the amendment and send it back to the council for a final vote.

"This is a highly specialized area that implicates ... technologies, civil liberties, and public safety. I want to make sure we hear from experts," Weber said. "Something like this, we want to get right."

Yogev Toby can be reached at yogev.toby@globe.com.

N.Y., Calif. sue over nixed wind projects

Call Trump buybacks illegal

By Matthew Daly and Jennifer McDermott

ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Democratic attorneys general from California and New York sued the Trump administration Tuesday over its plans to buy back offshore wind leases as President Trump seeks to discourage the expansion of wind energy in favor of fossil fuels.

California Attorney General Rob Bonta said he is suing over removal of a project off his state's coast planned by Chicago-based Invenergy. The Trump administration said in June that it's buying back the company's US offshore wind leases for four wind projects on the East and West coasts.

New York Attorney General Letitia James, meanwhile, led seven states in suits seeking to block the Invenergy deal and another proposal with Bluepoint Wind, which agreed in April to end a wind farm under development off the New York and New Jersey coast.

The deals would hand energy companies \$1.4 billion in taxpayer dollars in exchange for the cancellation of multiple projects. In all, the Trump administration has pledged nearly \$4 billion to companies to walk away from projects across the country.

James called the deals illegal and said they will ultimately increase Americans' electricity bills by sabotaging states' ability to meet growing energy demands.

"Americans are facing increasing energy costs because this administration would rather pay off energy companies than let us build the new power sources we need," James said in a statement. "These illegal backroom deals take money that should have gone toward lowering New Yorkers' bills and hand it to fossil fuel projects in other states."

Bonta said that as a national and global leader in the fight against climate change, California finds itself enmeshed in "avoidable and unnecessary battles with our own federal government" to advance climate action and move toward clean energy.

Trump, who often talks about his hatred of wind power, has said his goal is to not let any "windmills" be built. Offshore wind produces electricity cleanly. Oil, coal, and natural gas emit carbon pollution when burned.

Bonta, speaking at a Climate Week event in New York City, said climate action needs to match the scope, speed, and scale of the problem.

"Because we have to go to court and block an unlawful action by the Trump administration each time, it takes time. It slows the process down and we know we are running out of time and we need to be urgent and aggressive," Bonta said Tuesday in remarks just before Trump addressed the UN General Assembly.

"We're still all in, in California," Bonta said. "No matter what the Trump administration does, we're going to push to participate in the climate action that is needed to meet this moment and to rise to the occasion."

Attorneys general in Connecticut, Delaware, Maine, Massachusetts, New Jersey, Rhode Island, and Vermont joined New York's suits.

TALKING POINTS

TELEVISION

TRUMP IS BACK ON TV, BRIEFLY, AS MANY NETWORKS CARRY HIS UN SPEECH LIVE



President Trump was, once again, all over American television screens Tuesday. Almost every major news channel — with the exception of CNN — carried a live feed of Trump’s speech to the UN General Assembly, even as five networks continued to suspend pool coverage of the president after he banned several outlets from the White House. How does that add up? The answer is United Nations TV, a UN-operated broadcasting system that functions as a kind of C-SPAN for events taking place on the United Nations campus in New York City. UN TV is not part of the five-network consortium that takes turns as the designated camera crew for many presidential events, especially in small spaces like the Oval Office. That group — consisting of ABC, CBS, CNN, Fox News, and NBC — suspended its pool duties Monday in solidarity with CNN, after Trump barred its journalists from the White House. (CNN, alongside two other banned outlets, has sued to regain access.) UN TV is filming speeches at the General Assembly, and many networks on Tuesday carried its feed of Trump’s address. In most cases, the networks included an onscreen caption that identified the UN as the source of the footage, to distinguish from their own cameras. (The New York Times also carried the live UN feed of Trump’s speech.) CNN was the exception. The channel aired other stories, including news about the cause of death of actress Hayden Panettiere, as Trump spoke. After the president concluded, CNN aired some short clips. “Despite the White House barring CNN and other news organizations from the presidential press pool, we do have a live signal of the president’s remarks provided by United Nations television,” CNN news anchor Wolf Blitzer told viewers. “We will monitor his speech and bring you any newsworthy moments as they happen.” When Trump entered the United Nations on Tuesday, he was greeted by a group of reporters, including CNN correspondent Kaitlan Collins. “I’m surprised that CNN is here covering me,” the president said. “The United Nations allowed us in, sir,” Collins replied. “You should not be here covering me,” Trump said. “You said you weren’t going to cover me. You shouldn’t be covering me.” — NEW YORK TIMES

DELIVERY

DOORDASH TO PAY \$131M FOR UNDERPAYING DELIVERY WORKERS IN NEW YORK CITY



DoorDash will pay \$131.5 million to settle claims that it underpaid delivery workers in New York City, Mayor Zohran Mamdani announced Tuesday. The agreement, which officials described as the largest worker settlement in city history, also requires the company to submit to a new monitoring system to ensure compliance with delivery worker pay laws in the city. In a statement, DoorDash admitted errors, saying: “Simply put, we screwed up.” “While these mistakes weren’t intentional, that doesn’t make them okay. We pride ourselves on operational excellence at DoorDash — and this was not excellent, nor was it acceptable. Dashers should be paid in full, on time, every time. We are sorry to the Dashers we let down,” the company said. Most of the settlement will be returned to more than 260,000 workers who were underpaid, not paid, or paid late for deliveries by DoorDash, according to City Hall. The company will also pay about \$16 million in civil penalties and other costs to the city. DoorDash said many of the errors in payment were caused by “technical bugs or happened in complicated situations,” such as deliveries that went outside city boundaries, had multiple pickup or drop-off spots, or included deliveries that were cancelled or partially completed. — ASSOCIATED PRESS



VOTING

PATAGONIA OFFERS \$100 TO CUSTOMERS WHO HELP OTHERS PLAN TO VOTE



Patagonia is offering customers a financial incentive to encourage friends and family to make a plan to vote in the midterm elections. The outdoor apparel company said it would give up to 112,000 customers a \$100 discount on Patagonia merchandise if they enroll three people in a program to encourage registered voters to cast a ballot in the midterms. The initiative begins Saturday. Support for the environment has been a core part of Patagonia’s brand for decades, yet the move is an extraordinary step in corporate activism. The company, based in Ventura, California, previously bought political ads, campaigned against the oil and gas industry, and endorsed candidates who ran against lawmakers who rejected the scientific consensus on climate change. Ryan Gellert, CEO of Patagonia, said he was concerned that many Americans had become disengaged with politics and environmental issues since President Trump returned to the White House last year. Company executives want to “get people off the sidelines,” he said. “A lot of people are feeling a sense of hopelessness,” Gellert said in an interview. “We’re trying to cut through the apathy.” The people Patagonia customers refer are sent to a third-party website where they can check their voter registration, and find out if they can vote early and whether they need to show identification at their polling site. They must then develop a plan to cast their ballot — by voting early, by mail, or in person on Election Day. — NEW YORK TIMES

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

ANTHROPIC RELEASES A NEW ‘SAFEST’ AI MODEL AMID SLOWDOWN DEBATE



Anthropic on Tuesday unveiled a faster and cheaper version of its flagship artificial intelligence model that it also billed as its “safest,” in its first release since its CEO called on the industry to slow down technology development. The San Francisco company said the model, Opus 5.5, was the strongest performer on its most rigorous internal safety tests to date, and was less likely than earlier models to take actions that could not be undone, or to act outside the limits it was given. In one new test, the model tried to break out of its testing environment about 85 percent less often than previous models, the company said. Anthropic also said it had walled off the model from hacking, biology, and AI research, automatically routing requests that are flagged for misuse to an older model with more restrictions. Outside evaluators had reviewed the model, the company added. “Opus 5.5 is our safest model on most alignment metrics,” the company said. “Alignment” is the science of teaching AI to do what is in line with human preferences, ethics, and judgment. The AI industry is in the middle of a very public bout of anxiety. Dario Amodei (left), Anthropic’s CEO, and other executives recently warned that the systems they were building could slip beyond human control, fueled by a string of incidents in which AI models from leading labs broke out of their testing environments and hacked companies. Anthropic has disclosed breaches involving its own models. — NEW YORK TIMES

MEDIA

BILLY BUSH JOINS FOX NEWS A DECADE AFTER ‘ACCESS HOLLYWOOD’ TAPE SCANDAL

Billy Bush (below right), whose television career unraveled a decade ago with the release of the so-called “Access Hollywood” tape, in which Donald Trump bantered with him about sexual assault, is joining Fox News as a contributor. The exchange with Trump, which was recorded in 2005, emerged in the closing weeks of the 2016 presidential election, which Trump won despite the political fallout from the clip. But the consequences for Bush, now 54, a nephew of former President George H.W. Bush and a cousin of former President George W. Bush, were severe. The scandal cost him his job as an anchor of the “Today” show on NBC just a few months after he had joined the flagship morning program and prompted Bush to issue an apology in which he said he was “embarrassed and ashamed” of his actions. In a statement Tuesday released through Fox News Media, Bush said he was excited for the opportunity to share “my perspective on the people, ideas, and moments shaping today’s culture ... as well as the ones trying to undo it!” Bush will make his debut at 8 p.m. on Tuesday on “Jesse Watters Primetime” and will appear across all Fox platforms, the company said. — NEW YORK TIMES



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Unions rally to get ahead of threat of AI

►UNIONS
Continued from Page B5

“It was the union trying to force the company’s hand about being more transparent when it comes to AI,” Suttiter said. “The sooner we can be part of that conversation and represent the members’ side of it, the better off we are.”

Unions are confronting AI as an existential danger to workers, not only because of the possibility of massive job losses but also because of its hand in the widening gap between wages and corporate profits. In April, Liz Shuler, the president of the AFL-CIO, called AI “the single biggest threat to working people of our lifetime.”

The threat has galvanized a labor movement that has been on its back foot for years. In terms of public opinion, unions are popular. AI is not. And yet union membership is at a low ebb — about 6 percent of American private-sector workers are represented by a union — and unions have been hobbled by state laws and a weakened National Labor Relations Board.

Putting AI at the top of the bargaining agenda is part of a strategy to overcome that disadvantage, using negotiations to establish boundaries and, labor leaders hope, direct AI from the ground up. As workers and employers try to make sense of the AI economy, these contracts could help shape policy.

“There is power, there is leverage right now,” said Moira Bulloch, a spokesperson for the Communications Workers of America, which represents journalists, flight attendants, and call center workers. AI policy is being set “contract by contract, employer by employer.”

The machinists union, which represents about 600,000 workers in the United States and Canada in industries including defense, aerospace, railroads, and aviation, has been particularly proactive. Recognizing that AI portends promises as well as threats, the machinists have crafted model contract language and pushed for early, open conversations with companies that employ their members.

“Unions can set the pace,” said David Sullivan, the general vice president for the union’s eastern territory, who encouraged Local S6 to put in the new language.

About a year and a half ago, Joseph Bonomo, a labor lawyer at Pitta, a law firm in New York, realized that while companies were incessantly talking about AI on earnings calls, the unions he represented were not. He set out to change that, starting at the bargaining table.

“AI is the hill to die on,” Bonomo tells union clients. “Because if you don’t have a job at the end of that contract, what good was the contract?”

Bonomo is working with the machinists’ air transport division as an adviser. Richie Johnsen, who runs the division, said he was fine with AI being used as a tool to improve corporate profits that can transfer to his members: “But it shouldn’t be replacing people.”

“We have to put in language into our contracts that addresses that,” he added. “Because that’s the only way that happens.” The machinists represent workers at nearly every US airline. The union is in negotiations with United Airlines and Alaska Airlines, and will begin negotiations with Southwest Airlines before the end of the year and with American Airlines early next year, Johnsen said.

When Bonomo spoke to Johnsen’s team in June, he began by talking about language. “Define the Function, Not the Marketing Label,” read one of his slides. Corporate speak about AI can be euphemistic, vague, and mind-numbing.

“Employers may not necessarily say, ‘Hey, there’s a new AI system,’” Bonomo said. “They’re going to label it, characterize it as a scheduling tool, a safety platform, a productivity system,

a camera upgrade, some routing software.”

He challenged the machinists to interrogate the jargon. What does the system do? Does it collect data? Make predictions? Is it influencing discipline, staffing, scheduling, pay rates? Did the vendor consult with the union before writing the code?

Bonomo also encouraged the machinists and other unions to leverage AI to their advantage. Unions could build their own large language models to harness decades of institutional knowledge and records. They could use AI to organize more shops.

“Unions have to be in that driver’s seat,” he said.

Like most Americans, the workers at Bath Iron Works primarily encounter artificial intelligence today in slop on social media, or web searches that spit out paragraphs instead of links. They may regard AI with distrust but fail to recognize that it’s already in use all around them.

This disconnect has made Devin Ragnar, who at 33 is one of the younger machinists at the shipyard, particularly nervous. Ragnar handles communications for Local S6 and has been pushing his colleagues, and the union, to be more aware of the reach of AI and more proactive about confronting it.

Last year, Huntington Ingalls Industries, a competitor to the shipyard, announced a partnership with Hyundai Heavy Industry that yielded a pilot program to bring AI-guided welding equipment to shipyards in Mississippi and Virginia.

“In construction, you hear a lot of ‘You can’t automate this!’,” Ragnar said. They think a robot can’t do the work, can’t climb a ship. But, he said “it’s very real — it’s happening.”

Ragnar served on the bargaining committee for the new contract at Bath Iron Works and pushed his fellow members to include language on AI. He and Suttiter said the company had seemed surprised by the request, as if they hadn’t put a lot of thought into the matter.

Recently, Bath Iron Works introduced a programmable arm that could weld — a co-bot, or collaborative robot, in modern parlance. “They didn’t exactly follow our contract language,” Ragnar said. The union filed a grievance, and is now working with the company to resolve it.

“A big part of our response was — imagine if this was a much more drastic, broad-reaching change?”

In the past, the company might have just said, “Hey, we bought this \$10 million machine,” according to Sullivan. In the future, the union would have warning. Ragnar said that since the contract was ratified, the company was coming to union leaders with questions about technology.

In response to questions, the company, General Dynamics Bath Iron Works, said it was “committed to being transparent with all its employees about future AI and new technology initiatives.”

Ragnar said he did everything he could to avoid using AI. “If we let AI do menial tasks for us, we are letting these machines think for us,” he said. If welders surrendered some of their work to a co-bot, their skills would erode.

“It’s one of the best things about being human — creating, thinking, and problem solving,” he said.

Sullivan is more optimistic about the constructive use of AI in shipbuilding. If an AI-guided machine can weld a seam in 15 seconds — a fraction of the time it takes a human, without the risk of injuries — it could mean more ships under construction, and, in turn, more jobs, with a healthier workforce.

“Maybe the new technology would be great,” Sullivan said. “It’s the unknown.”



LEGAL NOTICES

LEGAL NOTICES

NOTICE OF DISPOSITION OF COLLATERAL BY PUBLIC SALE UNDER DELAWARE UNIFORM COMMERCIAL CODE

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE that pursuant to Section 9-610 of the Delaware Uniform Commercial Code, the "Security Agreement" dated as of November 17, 2022 (as amended, restated, supplemented, or otherwise modified from time to time, the "Loan Agreement") between Southbridge Associates LLC ("Grantor") and X-Caliber Rural Capital, LLC ("Lender"), and that certain Security Agreement dated as of November 17, 2022 (as amended, restated, supplemented, or otherwise modified from time to time, the "Security Agreement") executed by Grantor in favor of Lender, Lender will sell some or all of Grantor's following assets (each capitalized term as defined in the Uniform Commercial Code) to the highest bidder, whether or not such assets are subject to Lender's lien thereon: Accounts, Chattel Paper, Deposit Accounts, Documents, Equipment (including motor vehicles and trailers), Electronic Chattel Paper, Fixtures, Generators, Intangibles, Instruments, Inventory, Investment Property, Letter-of-Credit Rights, money, cash or cash equivalents, other goods and personal property, whether tangible or intangible, Proceeds and Supporting Obligations of the Grantor, whether now owned or to be acquired in the future; provided, however, Collateral shall not include any Equipment owned by Grantor that is subject to a purchase money lien in favor of Lender under the Loan Agreement (as further defined and described in the Security Agreement as "Collateral" and hereinafter referred to as the "Assets"). The Assets secure the repayment of the indebtedness of Grantor to Lender under the Loan Agreement.

Subject to all the terms of this Notice, the Assets will be sold pursuant to public auction (the "Sale") to the highest bidder at **14 Mechanic Street, Southbridge, Massachusetts on October 7, 2026 at 11:00 a.m. ET.**

The Assets will be offered for sale, piecemeal or in bulk and sold to the highest bidder at the conclusion of the Sale, as determined by Lender in its sole and absolute discretion, on an "AS IS" basis, without any warranties, express or implied, and without any express or implied representations or warranties whatsoever, including, without limitation, condition, title, value, quality of the Assets, defects, liens, encumbrances, liabilities, financial condition or earnings of Grantor or any of its affiliates. WITHOUT LIMITING THE GENERALITY OF THE FOREGOING, ALL WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY, TITLE, POSSESSION, QUIET ENJOYMENT, OR THE LIKE IN THIS DISPOSITION ARE EXPRESSLY DISCLAIMED. Upon acceptance of a bid (the "Accepted Bid"), the successful bidder (other than Lender) shall pay Lender the full amount of the Accepted Bid, within five (5) days of the conclusion of the Sale. If the successful bidder fails to pay the Accepted Bid to Lender within the time specified, Lender shall have the right to offer the Assets to the next highest bidder. Lender reserves its right, on or prior to the Sale, to withdraw all or a portion of the Assets from the Sale for any reason whatsoever. Lender may, in its sole and absolute discretion, at any time of the Sale or impose any other terms or conditions on the Sale and, if Lender deems appropriate, to reject any or all bids or to continue the Sale to such time and place as Lender, in its sole and absolute discretion, may deem fit, or to cancel such Sale.

Additional or amended terms and conditions of the Sale may be announced at the Sale. Lender reserves its right to credit or otherwise bid at the Sale and to apply the expenses of the Sale and all or any part of the total amount of the bid received to the purchase price of the Assets, or in satisfaction of the purchase price. Lender reserves all of the rights accruing to it under the Loan Agreement and Security Agreement, including the right to seek a judgment of foreclosure on the account of its indebtedness after the conclusion of the Sale.

Persons interested in bidding on the Assets at the Sale shall contact **Brian Lensing at (314) 803-1103**.

NOTICE TO CONTRACTORS – M.G.L. C. 30, sec 39M CONSTRUCTION ADVERTISEMENT OF INVITATION FOR BIDS COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS DEPARTMENT OF CONSERVATION AND RECREATION 10 Park Plaza, Suite 6620, Boston, MA 02116 PH: 617-725-3656 www.mass.gov/dcr

Contract No. P27-3707-C1A
Title: Bellevue Pond Dam Rehabilitation
Location: Middlesex Fells Reservation, Medford, Massachusetts

GENERAL BID proposals shall be submitted on a form furnished by the Department and will be received by 12:00 PM on Thursday, October 29, through DCR's E-bid room at www.bidexpress.com/businesses/36765/home.

Individual sets of contract documents will only be available at DCR's E-bid room at www.bidexpress.com/businesses/36765/home.

If any addenda are issued throughout the open period for this project, DCR will distribute these addenda via bid Express, which will also email identified prospective at the time plans and specifications are issued.

A pre-bidding conference for prospective bidders will be held on site (80 South Border Road, Medford MA) on Wednesday, Sept 30, 2026, at 12:00 pm. Questions must be received no later than 12:00 pm on Wednesday, October 7th, 2026 to Christopher.DeTurk@mass.gov. Responses to questions / addendums will be issued on Wednesday, October 14, 2026.

The project consists of repairs to the existing weir, stoplog bay, spillway structure, culvert pipe, headwalls, and training walls that are in poor condition. The project will consist of its original function to maintain the pond elevation and control flow through the structure before exiting the culvert. The project will include the repair and replacement of the weir and culvert structure, which has been severely degraded due to erosion from storm events. The proposed work will improve the path to mitigate future erosion, which will result in safe, level, and defined walking paths and will provide a potential for sediment to travel from eroding paths to the pond.

The estimated project cost is **\$230,515.00**

The work is to be accomplished within 365 calendar days of a notice to proceed. Liquidated damages in the amount of \$ 2,000 per day will be assessed if the work is not completed in accordance with the provisions of the contract within the time specified (as extended by any authorized change order) or potential for sediment to travel from eroding paths to the pond.

Bidders must be pre-qualified by the Massachusetts Dept. of Transportation (MassDOT) Highway Division in Dam Construction to bid on the above project. An award will not be made to a Contractor who is not pre-qualified by MassDOT prior to the opening of Proposals.

The Proposed contract includes a requirement of **0% for MBTA** (Public Business Enterprise) and **0% for WBE** (Women Business Enterprise) and **0% VDBE** (Veteran-Owned Business Enterprise).

The applicable local minority workforce utilization percentage is a minimum goal of 15.3%. The applicable local women workforce utilization percentage is a minimum goal of 6.9%.

Each bid must be accompanied by a bid deposit, in the form of a bid bond, cash, certified check, or a treasurer's check, in the amount of \$25,000, payable to the Department of Conservation and Recreation in the amount of 5% of the bid.

Each bid must be submitted through DCR's E-Bid room at www.bidexpress.com/businesses/36765/home. Please ensure that your bid is complete and marked as responsive when submitting your bid through the E-bid room. Bids that are incomplete and/or marked unresponsive will be rejected by DCR and will not be considered when awarding the project.

Bids are subject to the provisions of M.G.L. Ch. 30, Sect. 39F, G, H and M inclusive. Wages are subject to minimum wage as set forth in M.G.L. Ch. 149, Section 26 to 27D inclusive. The Department reserves the right to waive any informalities in or to reject any and all bids if it be in the public interest to do so.

Commissioner, Nicole LaChapelle
Massachusetts Department of Conservation and Recreation

LEGAL NOTICES

LEGAL NOTICES

NOTICE OF MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain Mortgage, Fixture Filing, Security Agreement and Assignment of Leases and Rents given by Southbridge Associates LLC, a Delaware limited liability company, to X-Caliber Rural Capital, LLC, said mortgage being dated November 17, 2022, and recorded in the Worcester District Registry of Deeds as Document Number 123752 and recorded in Book 68502, Page 275, of which mortgage the undersigned is the present holder, for breach of the condition of said mortgage and for the purpose of enforcing the same will be sold at Public Auction at **11:00 A.M. on the 7th day of October at 14 Mechanic Street, Southbridge, Massachusetts**, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage.

To wit:

Two parcels of land with the buildings and improvements thereon, on Mechanic Street, Southbridge, Massachusetts being further bounded and described as follows:

Parcel 1 - 14 Mechanic Street, Southbridge, Massachusetts

The land with the buildings and improvements thereon, being shown as Lot 1 on a plan of land entitled "Plan of Lot in Southbridge, Massachusetts prepared for Southbridge Associates Limited Partnership (Owner)" prepared by Para Land Associates, Inc., dated June 6, 2013, and recorded in the Worcester District Registry of Deeds in Plan Book 750, Plan 125.

Being the same premises conveyed to the mortgagee by deed dated April 11, 2000 and recorded in Book 22484, Page 132.

Parcel 2 - Mechanic Street, Southbridge, Massachusetts

The land being shown as "Remaining Land of American Optical Corporation" on a plan of land entitled "Plan of Land in Southbridge, Massachusetts being conveyed by American Optical Corporation to Town of Southbridge," dated May 16, 1995 and recorded with the Worcester District Registry of Deeds in Plan Book 696, Plan 10.

Being the same premises conveyed to the mortgagee by deed dated April 11, 2000 and recorded in Book 22484, Page 136.

There is also included in the above described premises and fixtures situated on the premises to the extent the same are part of the realty.

Premises to be sold and conveyed subject to and with the benefit of all rights, claims, liens, encumbrances, covenants, liens or claims in the nature of liens, improvements, public assessments, any and all unpaid taxes, tax liens, tax liens, water and sewer liens and any other municipal liens, whether or not recorded, and any other encumbrances or claims in force and are applicable, having priority over said mortgage, whether or not reference to such encumbrances is made in the deed. No representations, express or implied, are made with respect to any matter concerning the mortgaged Premises which shall be sold "as is", "where-is", and "with all faults".

Terms of sale: A deposit of fifty thousand dollars (\$50,000.00) by cash, certified or bank check will be required to be paid by the purchaser at the time and place of sale. The balance is to be paid by certified or bank check at the office of Rubin and Rudman LLP, 53 State Street, 15th Floor, Boston, MA 02109 within five (5) days from the date of sale to be deposited in escrow with counsel for the mortgagee pending delivery of a foreclosure deed which shall be mortgagee's only further responsibility. The successful bidder shall be required to sign a Memorandum of Sale containing the above terms at the Auction sale. In the event that the successful bidder at the foreclosure sale shall default in purchasing the premises described property or properties according to the terms of this Notice of Sale and/or the terms of the Memorandum of Sale executed at the time of the foreclosure, the Mortgagee reserves the right to sell the property or properties by foreclosure deed to the next highest bidder on such property or properties that shall successfully deposit with mortgagee's attorneys, Rubin and Rudman, LLP, the amount of the required deposit set forth herein within three (3) business days after written notice of default of the previous highest bidder, the balance to be paid in or within five (5) days to be deposited, and deed to be transferred, as outlined hereinabove.

The deposit paid at the time of the sale shall be forfeited if the purchaser does not comply strictly with the terms of the sale. The purchaser will be responsible for all closing costs, state documentary stamps and recording fees. Deed will be provided to purchaser for recording upon receipt in full of the purchase price. In the event of an error in this publication, the publication of the premises contained in said mortgage shall control.

Other terms, if any, to be announced at the sale.

Date: September 9, 2026

X-Caliber Rural Capital, LLC
Present holder of said Mortgage
By its Counsel,

/s/Rion M. Vaughan, Esq.
Rion M. Vaughan, Esq.
Rubin and Rudman LLP
53 State Street, 15th Floor
Boston, Massachusetts 02109
(617) 330-7143

**Commonwealth of Massachusetts
Executive Office of Health and Human Services**

NOTICE OF PUBLIC HEARING

Under the authority of M.G.L. c. 118E and in accordance with M.G.L. c. 30A, the Executive Office of Health and Human Services (EOHHS) will hold a remote public hearing on Friday, September 24, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. on the emergency adoption of amendments to the following regulation.

101 CMR 206.00: Standard Payments to Nursing Facilities

The regulation will go into effect as an emergency on October 1, 2026. The proposed amendments implement fiscal year 2027 (FY27) budget requirements. The following adjustments are being made to the rates, consistent with the FY27 budget.

- Updating standard nursing, operating, capital, pediatric, and other facility-specific rates for rate year 2027. The amendments adopt a 0.4% cost adjustment factor to both nursing and operating standard payments and updates the patient-driven payment model (PDPM) nursing standard payment amounts accordingly. The operating cost standard payment increased to \$128.34 per day. The capital cost adjustment factor is also updated to 6.65%.
- Revising financial statement reporting requirements.
- Reducing the SUD add-on from \$300 to \$200 per member per day and clarifying its applicability with other add-ons.
- Reducing the psychiatric add-on from \$300 to \$200 per member per day and clarifying its applicability with other add-ons.
- Strengthening staffing incentives by establishing an 8% downward adjustment for facilities at or below 3.00 hours per patient day (HPPD), while exempting facilities maintaining at least 4.00 hours per patient day from the emergency (PCC-D) downward adjustment.
- Removing expired COVID-19 preparedness payments and the prior rate year's \$25 million statewide supplemental payment.
- Making annual conforming and technical updates to dates, reporting periods, quality measures, PDPM references, and other payment provisions.

The estimated annual fiscal impact of these amendments is \$29,670,000 for rate-related amendments.

Register to testify and get instructions on how to join the hearing online at mass.gov/info-details/executive-office-of-health-and-human-services-public-hearings. You can join by phone at (617) 847-3468. The meeting ID is 935 397 8200F.

You can submit written testimony instead of, or in addition to, live testimony. Submit written testimony to ehs-regulations@mass.gov as an attached Word or PDF file. The subject line of the body of the email must be the name of the regulation in the subject line. All written testimony must include the sender's full name, mailing address, and organization or affiliation, if any. You can also mail written testimony to: EHS Regulatory Services, Enterprise Drive, 4th Floor, Quincy, MA 02171. Written testimony will be accepted until 5:00 p.m. November 13, 2026. EOHHS specifically reserves the right to reject any amendments may affect beneficiary access to care.

You can review the emergency regulation at mass.gov/info-details/executive-office-of-health-and-human-services-public-hearings or request a copy in writing from MassHealth Publications, 1 Enterprise Drive, 4th Floor, Quincy, MA 02171.

Email the Disability Accommodations Ombudsman at ADAaccommodations@mass.gov to make special accommodation requests. You can also call (617) 847-3468 (TTY: (617) 847-3788). Please allow two weeks to schedule sign language interpreters.

EOHHS may adopt a revised version of the emergency regulation after considering relevant comments and any other practical alternatives that come to its attention.

In case of inclement weather or other emergency, hearing cancellation announcements will be posted on the Department's website at mass.gov/info-details/executive-office-of-health-and-human-services-public-hearings.

(SEAL)
**Commonwealth of Massachusetts
Land Court Department
Trial Court**

WORCESTER, SS. Court Case No. 26 MISC 000318(DRR)

TTK Real Estate, LLC

The Unknown Heirs of Robert A. Young, et al

ADD: Robert A. Young, deceased, formerly of Houston, Texas; Adrie Nason (a/k/a Ariadne B. Nason), deceased, formerly of Millville, Massachusetts and Woonsocket, Rhode Island; Sophia Anderson, deceased, formerly of San Diego, California; Candice M. Alder, deceased, formerly of Chula Vista, California; George L. Greene, deceased, formerly of Yanketown, Florida; Claude C. Sparkman, Jr., deceased, formerly of Ocala, Florida; Muriel E. Killian, deceased, formerly of Hopedale, Massachusetts; Daniel Earle Greene, Jr., aka Daniel E. Greene, deceased, formerly of Hyannis, Massachusetts; Ella L. Daniels, deceased, formerly of Westborough, Massachusetts; Muriel E. Killian, deceased, formerly of Brockton, Massachusetts; Richard N. Cronan, deceased, formerly of Englewood, Florida and their unknown heirs, assigns, devisees or legal representatives;

The Plaintiff(s) has/have filed a Complaint with the Land Court in Boston, Massachusetts in which you are named as an interested party. This Complaint may be examined at said Court or online at www.masscourts.org. The Complaint contains information regarding the property in question. The Plaintiff(s) is/are claiming that the property is owned by the Plaintiff(s) and is/are claiming that the property is owned by the Plaintiff(s). The Plaintiff(s) is/are claiming that the property is owned by the Plaintiff(s) and is/are claiming that the property is owned by the Plaintiff(s). The Plaintiff(s) is/are claiming that the property is owned by the Plaintiff(s) and is/are claiming that the property is owned by the Plaintiff(s).

If you intend to make a defense, you are required to file an answer with the Land Court or before the return day, November 2, 2026, and serve a copy upon the plaintiff's attorney, Henry J. Lane, Esq., Lane and Hamer, P.C., 100 Main Street, Suite 200, Boston, MA 02109. Failure to do so, judgment by default may be taken against you for relief demanded in the complaint.

It is ORDERED that notice be given by publishing a copy of this notice once in the Boston Globe, a newspaper published in Boston, Suffolk County, Massachusetts, at least thirty days before the return day, November 2, 2026.

Witness, Gordon H. Piper, Chief Justice of the Land Court, the 17th day of September, 2026.

Attest:

/s/ Deborah J. Patterson
Deborah J. Patterson Recorder

LEGAL NOTICES

LEGAL NOTICES

NOTICE OF MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF LEASEHOLD ESTATE

By virtue and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain Leasehold Mortgage with Absolute Assignment of Leases and Rents, Security Agreement and Fixture Filing given by SBC Energy, LLC, a Massachusetts limited liability company, to X-Caliber Rural Capital, LLC, as assignor of Webster Five Cents Savings Bank, said mortgage being dated November 16, 2023, and filed in the Worcester South District Registry of Deeds as Document Number 2023 00098089 and recorded in Book 69913, Page 16, of which mortgage the undersigned is the present holder, for breach of the conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing the same will be sold at Public Auction at **12:00 P.M. on the 7th day of October at 60 Optical Drive, Southbridge, Massachusetts**, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage.

To wit:

The leased premises is a portion of the property owned by Southbridge Associates II LLC located in Southbridge, Worcester County, Massachusetts being shown as Lot 2 on a plan entitled "Plan of Land in Southbridge, Massachusetts Surveyed for Southbridge Associates Limited Partnership and American Optical Corporation" by Richard D. Parra, dated May 15, 1991, recorded with the Worcester District Registry of Deeds ("Registry") in Plan Book 651, Plan 119 ("Landlord's Property").

The leased premises is described as follows:

The buildings and appurtenances (the "Leased Area") located within Landlord's Property shown on the progress print titled "Ground Lease Area 60 Optical Drive, Southbridge, MA," dated July 29, 2018 attached to the Notice of Lease by and between Southbridge Associates II, LLC and Southbridge Associates VI, LLC dated September 6, 2018 recorded with the Registry in Book 59372, Page 395, as affirmed by an Amended and Restated Notice of Lease by SBC Gupta LLC as landlord and SBC Energy LLC dated October 15, 2021 and recorded with the Registry in Book 66311, Page 52, together with all appurtenant rights.

The leased premises are subject to any activity and Use Limitation filed by Southbridge Associates II LLC dated November 23, 2004 and recorded with the Registry in Book 35193, Page 253.

There is also included in the sale all equipment and fixtures situated on the above-described premises to the extent they are part of the realty. The premises to be sold and conveyed subject to and with the benefit of all rights, claims, liens, encumbrances, covenants, liens or claims in the nature of liens, improvements, public assessments, any and all unpaid taxes, tax liens, tax liens, water and sewer liens and any other municipal assessments or liens or existing encumbrances of record which are in force and are applicable, having priority over said mortgage, whether or not reference to such encumbrances is made in the deed. No representations, express or implied, are made with respect to any matter concerning the mortgaged Premises which shall be sold "as is", "where-is", and "with all faults".

Terms of sale: A deposit of fifty thousand dollars (\$50,000.00) by cash, certified or bank check will be required to be paid by the purchaser at the time and place of sale. The balance is to be paid by certified or bank check at the office of Rubin and Rudman LLP, 53 State Street, 15th Floor, Boston, MA 02109 within five (5) days from the date of sale to be deposited in escrow with counsel for the mortgagee pending delivery of a foreclosure deed which shall be mortgagee's only further responsibility. The successful bidder shall be required to sign a Memorandum of Sale containing the above terms at the Auction sale. In the event that the successful bidder at the foreclosure sale shall default in purchasing the premises described property or properties according to the terms of this Notice of Sale and/or the terms of the Memorandum of Sale executed at the time of the foreclosure, the Mortgagee reserves the right to sell the property or properties by foreclosure deed to the next highest bidder on such property or properties that shall successfully deposit with mortgagee's attorneys, Rubin and Rudman, LLP, the amount of the required deposit set forth herein within three (3) business days after written notice of default of the previous highest bidder, the balance to be paid in or within five (5) days to be deposited, and deed to be transferred, as outlined hereinabove.

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Deed will be provided to purchaser for recording upon receipt in full of the purchase price. In the event of an error in this publication, the description of the premises contained in said mortgage shall control.

Other terms, if any, to be announced at the sale.

Date: September 9, 2026

X-Caliber Rural Bridge, LLC
Present holder of said Mortgage
By its Counsel,

/s/Rion M. Vaughan, Esq.
Rion M. Vaughan, Esq.
Rubin and Rudman LLP
53 State Street, 15th Floor
Boston, Massachusetts 02109
(617) 330-7143

**REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS
CONSTABLE SERVICES
BHA Project No.: 2378-01**

The Boston Housing Authority (the "BHA", "Local Public Agency," or "Authority") is seeking proposals for constable services with respect to the service of legal process and the service of process on behalf of the BHA. The BHA is seeking proposals from qualified individuals or entities to provide constable services on behalf of the BHA. The BHA is seeking proposals from qualified individuals or entities to provide constable services on behalf of the BHA. The BHA is seeking proposals from qualified individuals or entities to provide constable services on behalf of the BHA.

Proposers responding to this RFP are required to submit one (1) original and five (5) copies of their proposal and submit one (1) electronic copy of the non-fee portion of their proposal on CD-R or DVD-R media or USB flash stick. This submission should be in a single file Adobe PDF format, although Microsoft Office file formats (Word, Excel, Power Point, etc.) are also acceptable. Proposers shall submit their proposals to:

BHA Contract Office, Ben Liang, Director of Procurement, 60 Optical Drive, Southbridge, MA 01565, at 12:00 p.m. on Wednesday, September 30, 2026 (the "Inquiry Date") and hand delivery, each proposal must be in a sealed envelope marked with the Proposer's name, address, telephone number, and BHA Job Number.

For the RFP package, please look for 2378-01 on <https://www.bostonhousing.org/en/Bid-Opportunities/Current-Bid-Opportunities.aspx>.

Inquiries or requests for modifications regarding this RFP will be accepted in writing until 2:00 p.m. on Wednesday, September 30, 2026 (the "Inquiry Date") and shall be submitted to Ben Liang, Director of Procurement, Boston Housing Authority, by mail: 52 Chauncy Street, Boston, MA 02111 or email (preferred) bids@bostonhousing.org.

NOTICE TO CONTRACTOR
University of Massachusetts Boston

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts, University of Massachusetts Boston, will receive sealed bids for the Wheatley Hall Air Handling Unit Upgrades, Phase 1. Project consists of complete demolition/removal and replacement of three Air Handling Units and associated Ductwork, Piping, Electrical and other misc. scopes.

Site visit on September 28, 2026 at 10 AM Location: UMass Boston, 100 Morrissey Blvd, Boston, MA 02125. Meet at Wheatley Hall (Ground Floor Entrance Doors Plaza).

Estimate- \$2,035,000

General Bids are due no later than 2:00pm, 10/16/2026

Sub Bids (HVAC, Miscellaneous and Ornamental Metals, Electrical, Plumbing, Fire Protection, Mechanical, Painting, Damp-proofing / Caulking, Lathing and Plastering) due no later than 2pm on 10/8/2026

A 5% bid deposit that is no less than of the bid amount must accompany all bids. The bid deposit may be in the form of a certified, treasurer's or cashier check; or bid bond from a licensed surety M.G.L. c. 149, §44B(2).

Bids are subject to M.G.L. c. 149, and to the minimum wage rate as required by the M.G.L. c. 149, §26 to 27D inclusive. The University reserves the right to reject any bid or bids or to reject any and all bids if it were in the public interest to do so.

Bid documents will be available on 9/23/2026 and can be obtained by visiting: <https://www.biddocs.com/>

Legal Notice:

The Massachusetts Bay Transportation Authority (MBTA) is seeking bids for an Invitation to Bid for 25 Automated Teller Machine (ATM) locations within the Red, Orange, Green, Blue, and Silver Lines, the Commuter Rail and Commuter Boat Stations.

To obtain a copy of the Invitation to Bid and become a registered bidder, visit <https://www.mbtaareality.com/bid-docs/> or contact MBTA's designated representative.

Greystone Real Estate Advisory Group
Attn: MBTA ATM ITB
20 Park Plaza, Suite 1120
Boston, Massachusetts 02116
Email: Procurement@mbtaareality.com

Responses are due no later than **12:00 pm on October 7, 2026** at the following address:

Greystone Real Estate Advisory Group
Attn: MBTA ITB Bid
20 Park Plaza, Suite 1120
Boston, MA 02116

MBTA reserves the right to reject any and all responses.

LEGAL NOTICES

Legal Notice: Rt. 79, Davol Street Corridor Fall River, MA

The Massachusetts Department of Transportation (MassDOT) is seeking proposals for the construction of the Davol Street Corridor project. The project consists of the construction of a new road and the improvement of existing roads. The project is located in the town of Fall River, Massachusetts. The project is estimated to cost \$10 million. The project is expected to be completed by the end of 2026.

To obtain a copy of the Invitation to Bid and become a registered bidder, visit <https://www.massdot.state.ma.us/bid-docs/> or contact MassDOT's designated representative.

Greystone Real Estate Advisory Group
Attn: MBTA ATM ITB
20 Park Plaza, Suite 1120
Boston, Massachusetts 02116
Email: Procurement@mbtaareality.com

Responses are due no later than **12:00 pm on October 7, 2026** at the following address:

Office of Real Estate and Economic Development
Massachusetts Department of Transportation
State Transportation Building
Ten Park Plaza, Suite 2310
Boston, MA 02116
Attn: MassDOT Fall River Land Sale Bid

MassDOT reserves the right to reject any and all bids.



NICK OXFORD/NEW YORK TIMES

Kratom sellers have ramped up their spending on lobbyists.

Addiction clinics see rise in kratom use

►**STAY**
Continued from Page B5

physical dependence. But most of the Boulder patients report using newer, more potent products with highly concentrated levels of 7-hydroxymitragynine, or 7-OH, a compound that's found in the kratom leaf only in trace amounts. Unlike the more dominant alkaloid in the kratom leaf, 7-OH acts directly on the brain's opioid receptors, meaning it can have stronger, more opioid-like effects, including sedation and euphoria.

The Food and Drug Administration recently flagged 7-OH products as an emerging opioid threat, while the Drug Enforcement Administration proposed an effective ban on 7-OH above a certain threshold. That law has yet to be finalized, but numerous states have enacted similar restrictions. Appa theorized that laws revoking access to the products may be

TV HIGHLIGHTS

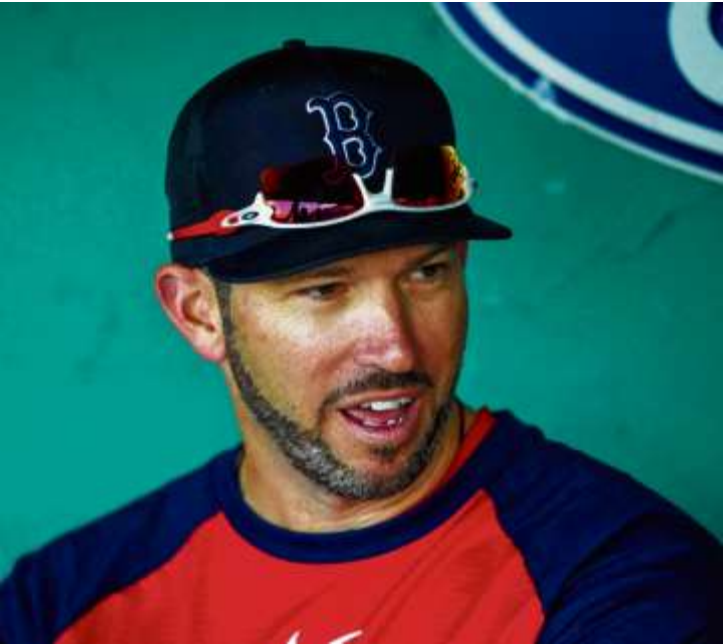
Baseball: Guardians-Red Sox, 7:10 p.m., ESPN
WNBA: Dream-Liberty, 8 p.m., USA
WNBA: Wings-Storm, 10 p.m., USA
Baseball: Astros-Mariners, 10:10 p.m., ESPN
Listings, C6

Sports

C

THE BOSTON GLOBE WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 23, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/SPORTS

Tracy’s sticking around as manager



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

The first big league call-up for Chad Tracy came in April and now the interim tag is gone from the Red Sox manager’s title.

ALEX SPEIER
ON BASEBALL

Breslow defied expectations with gambles that paid off

Even with the Red Sox having secured their second straight postseason berth, the magnitude of Craig Breslow’s gamble five months ago remains startling. There have been times when teams reacted to slow starts with a managerial or coaching staff change. But longtime members of the industry could not recall anything like the shakeup enacted by Breslow in April, when he fired manager Alex Cora and replaced six other members of the coaching staff. It was a move that departed from convention both for when it happened (barely a month into the season) and the extent of the change. It also pointed to an emerging theme of Breslow’s time as chief baseball officer: The willingness of the Sox to take significant in-season risks. The firing of Cora and the staff members (with replacements plucked from the minors with little big league clubhouse experience), the mid-June trade of Rafael Devers in 2025, and the acquisition of catcher Adley Rutschman in exchange for a package of young talent (four of the Sox’ top-10 prospects, as well as catcher Carlos Narváez) that exceeded any in-season move by the Sox this century all pointed to an organization making massive bets on in-season changes. The strategy paid off, not only in the form of a second straight playoff berth, but also in winning the trust of Breslow’s bosses. On Tuesday, the Sox picked up his team options for the 2029 and ’30 seasons, creating a likelihood that Breslow will become the first Sox head of baseball operations to complete four seasons since Theo Epstein. “I always try to be guided by what I believe to be right and best for the organization,” Breslow said of his in-season risk tolerance. “Oftentimes, most people in these jobs would say their initial read or inclination of a situation was largely a correct one, but friction and inertia and emotion prevented you from acting on that. Then, you look back and say I wish I would have done whatever it was you were thinking at the time more often than you say that was probably not the right decision, and I wish I hadn’t.” “When you evaluate decisions through that lens, I think I default to, when you reach a certain level of conviction, you have to act.” That sounds straightforward, but given baseball’s 162-game schedule, there’s often a willingness by heads of baseball operations to let situations play out over larger samples rather than intervene quickly. On both a person-
ON BASEBALL, Page C4

As reward for Red Sox’ turnaround, interim tag comes off with new deal

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF
Chad Tracy, a minor league lifer until the Red Sox called him up to serve as interim manager at a dire moment in April, isn’t going back. The Red Sox announced Tuesday morning that they selected Tracy as their permanent manager, removing the “interim” caveat, a reward after he led the team to perhaps the most dramatic in-season turnaround in franchise history. Tracy, 41, is the Red Sox’ 49th manager and the successor to Alex Cora, whom the club fired April 25. He received a three-year contract that runs through 2029, with a team option for 2030. Additionally, they exercised the club options on chief baseball officer Craig Breslow’s contract for 2029 and ’30. That means Breslow and Tracy will be linked for at least the next three seasons, providing what team president Sam Kennedy described as critical “continuity and stability” in the “sacred relationship” between a head of baseball operations and a manager. “This organization is on solid footing,” Kennedy said during a news conference at Fenway Park later Tuesday. “[The people in those two jobs] being on the same page, having that trust, that confidence in each other ...

► Crochet ‘definitely making progress’ in bid to return. C2.
Lord knows we’ve made mistakes in our time, and just ensuring that you have that relationship right is critical. And so it’s great to have that stability now. “And look, we haven’t achieved anything. We know that. But I think we’re set up for success going forward.” Kennedy spoke in the Red Sox’ interview room off the clubhouse, sitting on the dais next to Tracy and Breslow. Filling the back of the room were Red Sox executives and members of the ownership group, including principal owner John Henry, who also owns the Globe. Henry and Co. exercised Breslow’s options — turning a five-year pact into seven years — “over the summer,” Kennedy

said. They didn’t reveal so until now, pairing the news with Tracy’s new deal. Tracy and Breslow avoided disclosing the specifics of when and how quickly Tracy’s contract came together. Breslow recalled that conversations “grew naturally,” and he referenced drawing “a natural conclusion” by late August at the latest that Tracy would be the guy in 2027 and beyond. “There was a pretty mutual understanding when I first got here that we got a lot of work to do,” Tracy said. “Let’s focus on that. And the rest of the stuff we’ll worry about later as it goes along.” Continuity also was one of the reasons Tracy got his shot in the first place. On April 25, amid a 10-17
TRACY, Page C4



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Andruw Monasterio (0 for 3) drove in a run with a ground out, but the Red Sox were 0 for 9 with runners in scoring position Tuesday.

Downward trends continue in latest loss

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF
Guardians 3
Red Sox 2
In this purgatorial period for the Red Sox, after they clinched a playoff berth over the weekend and before they open the postseason next week, what matters? The result Tuesday, a 3-2 loss to the Guardians at Fenway Park, was not of major significance. Of greater note was the how — and what those trends may portend heading into the most important time of year: another ugly outing for reliever Erik Miller, and another night of minimal hitting for the lineup. The Red Sox (84-73) have dropped three games in a row and eight of their past 12. “We’ve still got five games to play, and you [have to] keep guys out there and engaged and ready to roll,” manager Chad Tracy said. “I told the guys before, we earned the right to be in position to be able to line things up. That being said, we still want to go out and win the games. We had a chance to tonight.” Miller inherited a tied game in the ninth inning and struggled again, allowing a game-deciding run and throwing 22 pitches (10 strikes). He hit his first batter, Chase DeLauter, with a pitch. DeLauter eventually scored on Nathaniel Lowe’s sacrifice fly. Altogether, Miller yielded two hits and a walk. In September, the Sox’ theoretical top lefthanded setup man has one clean inning in seven attempts, a 8.53 ERA, and a 2.37 WHIP.

Miller said his patience with himself — and a mechanical issue he is trying to fix — is “definitely running thin at this point.” “I’d be lying if I say otherwise,” he said. “I would like to have been through this by now, be over it. But . . . there’s no way I can feel better and work through it without throwing [in] a game. So that’s just how it’s going to have to be: keep throwing, get through it.” Tracy, noting that Miller will pitch in a couple more games before the regular season ends Sunday, added: “I thought today was even another step in the right direction.” Offensively, the Red Sox had few highlights. Mickey Gasper launched a pinch-hit tying home run off setup man Hunter Gaddis to lead
RED SOX, Page C2

Bruins bury Flyers in four-goal flurry

By Kevin Paul Dupont
GLOBE STAFF
Bruins 5
Flyers 1
Veteran winger Morgan Geekie and roster hopeful Brian Halonen each scored goals 2:24 apart early in the third period, pacing the Bruins to a 5-1 preseason win over the Flyers on Tuesday night at TD Garden. Lineup regulars Elias Lindholm and Mikey Eyssimont (two goals) also connected for their first goals of the pre-season, both markers coming as part of a four-goal third period. The victory, backed by 20 saves by Jeremy Swayman, improved the Bruins’ record to 2-0-0 in the exhibition season. They play their third of four
► Bruins owner Jacobs steps down from NHL board. C5
preseason tuneups Thursday night in Philadelphia, then wrap up the exhibition schedule Friday in Washington as the lead up to the regular-season opener Tuesday night vs. the Rangers on Causeway Street. Eyssimont, who scored eight goals with the Bruins last season, opened the scoring, redirecting in a Frederic Brunet slapper with 6:29 remaining in the first period. The Flyers squared it, 1-1, with 1:54 to go before the break, with fourth-liner Jacob Gaucher burning by backline
BRUINS, Page C5



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

David Pastrnak, who reportedly has been awarded the “C” on his jersey, gave the Bruins his “A” game vs. the Flyers.

Ponder, Doubts among those Patriots on rise

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF
FOXBOROUGH — After the Patriots evened their record at 1-1, let’s take a look at who’s up, who’s down, and whom to watch against the Jaguars in Week 3:
Three up
Edge rusher Elijah Ponder: Ponder was all over the stat sheet and the field against the Steelers, contributing as a run stuffer and pass rusher. He finished with five tackles, including three for loss, and a fumble recovery for a touchdown. Late in the fourth quarter, when the Steelers were on the Patriots’ 4-yard line, Ponder worked his way around left tackle Troy Fautanu to sack Aaron Rodgers for a loss of 13 yards. Edge rusher was an area of concern for the Patriots, dating to the offseason, but the team felt confident about Ponder’s potential. After playing just 21.1 percent of the defense’s snaps as a rookie last season, he has stepped up into a starting role. Ponder could be tested further if Dre’Mont Jones misses time
PATRIOTS, Page C5



NFL WEEK 3
PATRIOTS AT JAGUARS
Sunday, 1 p.m., CBS

SportsLog

ASU workout not reported to university

Arizona State hockey coaches were present when **Matthew Mayich** collapsed during an outdoor workout, but plans for the training session were not submitted to the school, according to a preliminary report issued by the university Tuesday. Mayich collapsed during an Aug. 20 workout and remains hospitalized with what family attorney **Rob Carey** said was exertional heat stroke that reduced flow of oxygen to his brain. The 21-year-old, a Blues draft pick, is unlikely to recover, Carey said. The coaching staff, according to the report, only asked permission for **Timothy Ziesel**, a former Green Beret, to speak with the team during a three-day, team-building event. The workout included a series of calisthenic circuits and body weight exercise; Carey said it “was a punishment workout. Miss a count, your group runs again. The head coach set it up, stood there and watched it, and didn’t stop it when the signs were there.” The Arizona State police department is investigating the incident.

Colorado cuts not finalized

Although **Deion Sanders** said he dismissed a few players on the heels of Colorado’s 41-7 loss at Northwestern, the process has not been finalized, the school said in a statement. The football coach of the Buffaloes didn’t specify which players were no longer with the program but indicated it was for a pattern of behavior. “It’s never one thing,” Sanders said. “Those guys will tell you: I’m the most loving, giving, and forgiving man you can ever meet. But when you start [with] conduct detrimental to the team that will set us back in things that you’re doing . . . I have a problem with that.” . . . The NCAA moved the men’s ice hockey regional scheduled to be held in Bridgeport, Conn., from March 25-28 to Hartford due to renovations at Bridgeport’s Total Mortgage Arena.

BASKETBALL

Sun lose penultimate game

Shakira Austin had 25 points and 13 rebounds to help the Mystics beat the Sun, 79-69, in Washington for their franchise-record 27th win of the season. The Mystics stretched their lead over Dallas and New York (tied for seventh) to one game with two days remaining in the regular season. **Diamond Miller** led Connecticut (10-33) with 19 points; **Leila Lacan** and **Raegan Beers** scored 11 apiece. The Sun’s final game before next season’s move to Houston is Thursday, when they host Toronto (11-32) . . . **Caitlin Clark** had 27 points, 9 assists, and 7 rebounds, and **Kelsey Mitchell** added 20 points to her WNBA single-season scoring record as the Fever beat the Lynx, 96-77. Indiana (28-15) prevented Minnesota (32-11) from clinching the No. 1 seed without help from Golden State (31-11), which played later Tuesday . . . **Kawhi Leonard** and the Raptors have agreed on a two-year contract extension that could be worth \$115 million if he plays both seasons, a person with knowledge of the negotiations said. The 35-year-old led Toronto to the 2019 NBA title and is coming off the highest-scoring season of his career, averaging 27.9 points for the Clippers in 65 games . . . The Hawks are trading guards **Buddy Hield** and **Ryan Nembhard** and cash to the Hornets for forward **Dorian Finney-Smith**, according to a person familiar with the situation.

HOCKEY

Granlund gets Ducks’ ‘C’

Mikael Granlund is the Ducks’ new captain, the 34-year-old Finn named to replace defenseman **Radko Gudas**, who was traded to Florida during the summer. Anaheim also named four alternate captains, with rising stars **Leo Carlsson** and **Jackson LaCombe** joining **Troy Terry** and **Alex Killorn** . . . The PWHL hired **Alison Izzi** as general manager of the Vancouver Goldeneyes based on her experience as an attorney specializing in hockey matters. Former GM **Cara Gardner Morey** took over as Goldeneyes’ head coach in July.

SOCCER

Oliveira gets US U-19 call

Revolution midfielder **Cristiano Oliveira** is one of 20 players called up to the United States under-19 men’s national team for upcoming friendlies against Wales (Sept. 29), England (Oct. 2), and Norway (Oct. 5). Oliveira, born in Cambridge and a Somerville resident, previously represented the United States at the U-18, U-17, U-16, and U-15 levels.



Kawhi Leonard, shown in April, returns to Toronto after his best scoring season.

Baseball



Mickey Gasper was feted by his Red Sox teammates in the dugout after his solo home run in the eighth inning tied the game, 2-2.

RED SOX NOTEBOOK

Crochet throws off Fenway mound

By **Tim Healey**
GLOBE STAFF

Garrett Crochet took another significant step forward Tuesday afternoon, facing a hitter for the first time since May, keeping possible a return this weekend or in the playoffs.

What happens next, the lefthander said after throwing off the mound at Fenway Park, is up to Red Sox decision-makers.

And they haven’t decided.

“He’s definitely making progress,” no-longer-interim manager **Chad Tracy** said prior to Tuesday night’s 3-2 loss to the Guardians. “Again, it’s ‘See how he feels tomorrow.’ I know that there’s a lot of conversation around that because we’re only a week away from the postseason now. So determining how does he feel coming out of that [and] what does this weekend look like is going to be the next step.

“What that looks like now, I don’t know. I just know that whatever it is, it’s going to be done with Garrett’s best interest in mind, making sure that we’re doing it right.”

Crochet, out since late April with a left shoulder injury, threw 16 pitches of live batting practice to center fielder **Ceddanne Rafaela**, who is working his way back from a right quad strain. The total was supposed to be 15 pitches, Crochet explained, but the would-be last one was a changeup that went “about 47 feet,” so he threw one more to end on a better note. His fastball sat in range of 94-96 miles per hour, he said, a continued steady increase in velocity as he has upped throwing intensity.

Rafaela’s assessment: “Nasty. As always.”

“The way that . . . just went, I could go get outs,” Crochet said. “It depends obviously what role they want me in. It’s not really for me to say. I know myself and I know my body, and the biggest thing was that I felt good out there. Felt like I was able to ramp up intensity to a place that I haven’t gone yet. Tomorrow is going to be a big deal, seeing how I recover.”

Asked if he could pitch in a regular-season game this week, as another step forward before the yet-greater intensity of the postseason next week, Crochet said: “For me to take a spot on the roster, someone would have to lose one, and I would feel bad doing that because this team’s pitched their [expletive] off the whole season. Ultimately, that’s something that’s up to the front office. Whenever they gauge that I’m ready, then I’ll accept that. In the meantime, I’m just going to keep working my butt off.”

In saying so, Crochet struck a different tone compared with the recent past. In early September, regarding his unusual comeback bid, he said: “I’m not Joe Schmoe. I’ve done impressive things.” In late July, he insisted on endeavoring to “reverse engineer” a schedule that would have him back on the mound in the playoffs, because it was now or never.

Going from live batting practice to Yankee Stadium in the playoffs would be a huge jump. Would the Red Sox, who have been extremely mindful of giving Crochet very small jumps, be comfortable doing that?

“You’re considering all those things,” Tracy said. “We have to consider it and just be very, very mindful of, again, what are we potentially exposing him to and what can he give us really?”

Weather watch

Major League Baseball has no plans to move Cubs-Red Sox out of Boston this weekend, a league source said. But all parties want to make every effort to get all three games in amid a potential nor’easter arriving Friday.

Team officials met with the league Tuesday to discuss contingency plans. It’s not clear if, say, a doubleheader Friday would be among the options.

Although the series likely won’t mean anything to the Red Sox with regard to the standings, the Cubs are competing for the top National

AL wild card

	W	L	Pct.	GB
p-New York.....	90	67	.573	—
p-Boston	84	73	.535	—
Chicago.....	81	76	.516	—
*Houston.....	77	79	.494	3½
Toronto.....	77	80	.490	4
Baltimore.....	76	81	.484	5

* — late game; p — clinched berth

League wild-card spot.

“Everybody is well aware that the weather could get bad. I know it also could miss and not be bad,” Tracy said. “It’s very much on everybody’s radar through each organization plus Major League Baseball.”

Surgery for White

Outfielder **Eli White** had right foot surgery, a Lisfranc repair, according to the Red Sox. The procedure was performed by **Dr. Martin O’Malley** at the Hospital for Special Surgery in New York . . . The Sox plan to activate Rafaela from the injured list Wednesday, Tracy said . . . First baseman **Willson Contreras** (bruised hand) is “much better,” Tracy said. Contreras took batting practice both on the field and in the cage. He said the on-field session, which lasted upward of 20 minutes, went “OK” . . . Closer **Aroldis Chapman** (tight lat) should be cleared in the next day or two, per Tracy . . . Veteran catcher **Tomas Nido** joined the Sox on the taxi squad. He had spent the last couple of weeks with Triple-A Worcester, whose season ended Sunday . . . A perhaps incomplete list of Red Sox backups going to Fort Myers, Fla., to stay ready in case the big league team needs them, via Tracy: **Tanner Houck, Johan Oviedo, Jedixson Paez, Franklin Arias, Tsung-Che Cheng, Tyler Samaniego, Romy Gonzalez, Braiden Ward, and Wyatt Olds** . . . On Harvard Night, former NFL quarterback **Ryan Fitzpatrick** threw out a ceremonial first pitch.

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Guardians 3, Red Sox 2

At Fenway Park, Boston												
	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.					
CLEVELAND												
Kwan cf-lf	4	0	1	0	1	2	.280					
Ramirez 3b	5	0	1	0	0	1	.236					
DeLauter rf	4	1	2	0	0	0	.292					
Adell dh	4	0	1	0	1	1	.241					
Martinez lf	4	1	3	0	0	0	.259					
Lowe 1b	0	0	0	1	0	0	.228					
Fry 1b	3	1	1	1	0	0	.192					
a-Halpin pr-cf	1	0	1	0	0	0	.222					
Bazzana 2b	4	0	1	0	0	3	.246					
Genao 2b	1	0	0	0	0	0	.213					
Hedges c	3	0	0	0	2	1	.248					
Rocchio ss	5	0	1	0	0	1	.250					
Totals	38	3	12	2	4	9						
BOSTON	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.					
Anthony lf	5	0	0	0	0	2	.235					
Sogard 1b	5	0	2	0	0	2	.253					
Jones dh	3	0	0	0	0	1	.205					
b-Gasper ph-dh	1	1	1	1	0	0	.259					
Abreu rf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.251					
Rutschman c	4	1	3	0	0	0	.240					
Durbin 3b	3	0	0	0	1	1	.253					
Monasterio 2b	3	0	0	1	1	2	.237					
Kiner-Falefa ss	3	0	0	0	1	2	.242					
Eaton cf	3	0	1	0	0	1	.146					
c-Duran ph	0	0	0	0	0	1	.204					
Totals	34	2	8	2	4	12						

Cleveland.....	.020	000	001	—	3	12	0	
Boston.....	.010	000	010	—	2	8	1	
a-ran for Fry in 7th, b-homered for Jones in 8th, c-walked for Eaton in 9th. E—Sogard (4), LOB—Cleveland 15, Boston 9. 2B—DeLauter (29), Martinez (23), Sogard (14), Abreu (37), Rutschman 2 (26). HR—Gasper (10), off Gaddis. SB—Durbin (20). SF—Lowe. Runners left in scoring position—Cleveland 6 (Ramirez, Bazzana 3, Rocchio 2), Boston 6 (Sogard, Jones, Monasterio 3, Kiner-Falefa). RISP—Cleveland 1 for 12, Boston 0 for 9. Runners moved up—Martinez, Anthony, Rutschman, Durbin 2, Monasterio, GIDP—Rocchio, Anthony. DP—Cleveland 1 (Rocchio, Fry); Boston 1 (Monasterio, Kiner-Falefa, Sogard).								
Cleveland	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA
Messick	5	5	1	1	1	5	96	2.55
Herrin	½	1	0	0	0	0	14	2.95
Yoho	½	0	0	0	1	1	13	6.00
Sabrowski	1	0	0	0	1	3	19	2.72
Gaddis B55; W5-3	1	2	1	1	0	2	18	2.78
Smith S 40	1	0	0	0	1	1	16	1.99
Cleveland	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA
Tolle	5½	8	2	2	2	5	91	3.03
Miller L 2-2	1½	1	1	1	0	1	16	3.18
Gambro	1	2	1	1	0	0	22	3.57

Inherited runners scored—Yoho 1-0, Gamboa 1-0. **HBP**—by Tolle (Fry), by Miller (DeLauter). **Umpires**—Home, Ramon De Jesus; First, Paul Clemens; Second, Quinn Wolcott; Third, Adrian Johnson. T—2:56. A—37,416 (37,755).

HOW THE RUNS SCORED												
SECOND INNING												
GUARDIANS — Martinez doubled to left. Fry singled to center, Martinez scored. Bazzana singled to right, Fry to second. Hedges walked on four pitches. Fry to third, Bazzana to second. Rocchio grounded into a double play, second baseman Monasterio to shortstop Kiner-Falefa to first baseman Sogard, Fry scored. Bazzana to third, Hedges out. Kwan walked. Ramirez grounded into fielder’s choice, shortstop Kiner-Falefa to second baseman Monasterio, Kwan out.												
RED SOX — Rutschman doubled to left. Durbin grounded out, second baseman Bazzana to first baseman Fry, Rutschman to third. Monasterio grounded out, shortstop Rocchio to first baseman Fry, Rutschman scored. Kiner-Falefa struck out.												
EIGHTH INNING												
RED SOX — Gaddis pitching. Genao in as second baseman. Gasper pinch-hitting for Jones. Gasper homered to right on the first pitch. Abreu struck out, Rutschman singled to right. Durbin was out bunting, pitcher Gaddis to first baseman Lowe, Rutschman to second. Monasterio struck out.												
NINTH INNING												
GUARDIANS — Gasper in as designated hitter. Miller pitching. DeLauter was hit by a pitch. Adell singled to right, DeLauter to third. Lowe hit a sacrifice fly to left fielder Anthony. DeLauter scored. Halpin singled to right, Adell to second. Genao popped out to first baseman Sogard. Hedges walked. Adell to third, Halpin to second. Rocchio flied out to center fielder Eaton.												

Two downward trends continue in latest loss

► **RED SOX**
Continued from Page C1

off the eighth, but the Sox totaled nine runners stranded on base and went 0 for 9 with men in scoring position.

In the positives column: Adley Rutschman finished 3 for 4, with two doubles (and a line out to deep center) coming against lefthanders.

Entering the game, Rutschman was 2 for 26 with no extra-base hits against lefties as a member of the Red Sox.

“Being a switch-hitter has a lot that goes into it, and you go through phases where you’re hitting good [from] one side and not the other and it flip-flops sometimes and then goes back,” Rutschman said. “I want to be in a good spot, especially with the playoffs coming up.”

In a matchup between perhaps the top two rookie pitchers this year, Payton Tolle (5½ innings, two runs) was almost equal to fellow lefthander Parker Messick (five inn-

ings, one run) of the Guardians.

Tolle slogged through a 22-pitch second frame, during which he allowed three hits and two walks, but managed to hold the AL Central-leading Guardians (82-75) to the two runs.

When Tracy pulled him in the sixth, Tolle walked off the Fenway mound — for potentially the last time this year — to a standing ovation from the fans behind the home dugout. He waved back to them.

“I think he’s won them over pret-

ty significantly,” Tracy said.

Tolle finished his rookie season with a 3.03 ERA and 171 strikeouts in 148½ innings (26 starts).

Up next: a start in the AL Wild Card Series.

“It’s the postseason. This is what we play for,” Tolle said. “But it is what it is. We go on, and we have a job to do.”

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Baseball



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Players greeted manager Chad Tracy (left) on the field at Fenway Park after his interim status ended.

No more interim tag for Tracy

►TRACY
Continued from Page C1

start to the season, Breslow, Henry, and Kennedy flew to Baltimore, where the Red Sox were playing a weekend series against the Orioles, to inform Cora and six of his coaches that they had been replaced.

Tracy, in his fifth season managing Triple-A Worcester, began as interim manager April 26, taking over a clubhouse featuring veterans angry that Cora and much of his staff had been dumped. Breslow chose Tracy as the initial replacement in part because of his familiarity with the organization, including with many of the Sox’ big leaguers who had played for him. The Red Sox beat the Orioles, 5-3, in his first game.

At the time, Breslow declined to commit to Tracy guiding the club for even the rest of the season, never mind beyond it. For two months, the Sox toiled, bottoming out at 14 games under .500 — 32-46 — on June 24.

“We all remember that it wasn’t always smooth, and it wasn’t always comfortable, and it wasn’t always easy,” Breslow said. “But even working through underperformance and injuries and roster challenges, Chad demonstrated an ability to be open-minded and curious and engaged, but also to challenge and question and push back. And that’s exactly what I think we should be looking for when we think about the manager of the Red Sox.”

On June 25, virtually out of nowhere, the Red Sox began their turnaround with the first of four consecutive wins over the Yankees. Their 15-game win streak — matching the organization’s longest ever — began July 3, part of a larger 27-3 stretch that thrust them from the bottom of the American League solidly into the playoff chase.

Over the course of the torrid summer, Tracy getting the full-time gig began to feel inevitable. Still, he remained the interim, consistently deflecting questions on the topic. He said he would discuss it with Breslow when, or if, Breslow felt it was worth discussing.

“We did our best to make sure that any conversations that took place



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Chad Tracy’s first season in the majors will extend into the postseason after the Red Sox’ remarkable turnaround on the manager’s watch.

about his future or our future together [weren’t] a distraction,” Breslow said. “We both just operated pretty straightforwardly, in good faith. Recognized that this was a fit that we wanted to preserve. Our relationship has grown over time and was pretty easy to get across the finish line.”

For Breslow, this is the second managerial selection in his three years running the Red Sox. The first was Cora, whom he inherited, then signed to a three-year contract extension in July 2024. He fired Cora one season and one month into that deal, which runs through 2027.

Tracy’s chance was a long time coming. He grew up around the game as one of three sons of Jim Tracy, who spent 11 seasons as manager of the Dodgers (2001-05), Pirates (2006-07), and Rockies (2009-12).

Chad Tracy, a catcher-turned-first baseman, played in the minors from 2006-14 with the Rangers, Rockies, and Royals, and in independent ball, then transitioned to coaching. He worked for the Angels as a lower-minors manager and field coordinator for seven seasons.

Heading into 2022, the Red Sox, led then by chief baseball officer Chaim Bloom, hired him to manage Worcester, their top minor league affiliate.

Altogether, Tracy spent parts of 21 seasons in the minor leagues before

reaching the majors.

“Loved every minute of it,” Tracy said. “I was pretty committed to trying to achieve this as a player and was committed to it from high school. . . . Different obstacles got in the way that didn’t allow it. And then made the choice that I’m going to go start all over at the very lowest level and do it all as a coach because I love the game of baseball and I love sharing knowledge with players, and I love being a part of a locker room, and I love being around baseball players.”

Getting this job brings “a large sense of relief and validation,” Tracy said, though it won’t change how he goes about it.

In speaking to Red Sox players a couple of hours after the announcement, he choked up in acknowledging he didn’t think in April that all this would happen.

“I still pinch myself. I can’t believe it,” he said. “What you guys did, I’ll never forget it. But I’m grateful to all of you. I can’t wait . . . to put my uniform on and get this back to being what you guys have accomplished. And going to the postseason and trying to win a fricking World Series. The fact that I just said that is incredible to me.”

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Expectations were defied with gambles that paid off

►ON BASEBALL
Continued from Page C1

al and organizational level, a major in-season shakeup is uncomfortable.

“I certainly don’t sleep well [after a major change] for a few reasons, mostly because these are people that you have relationships with,” said Breslow. “These decisions are incredibly difficult. We’re talking about people’s lives, their families, children . . . there are a lot of implications to making these changes. So, it is wildly uncomfortable.”

Still, in a view perhaps informed by his playing career, Breslow has learned to remain open to uncomfortable in-season change — not for its own sake, but instead as a course correction when he sees a path to improving the club.

“I try to balance my [playing] experiences with what more information is telling me,” Breslow said. “I don’t think if I were only looking through things as I had experienced them that that would necessarily position us to make better decisions. But I think ignoring them would be ignoring valuable insights that I’ve learned.

“I was a lefthanded reliever that bounced around, who didn’t find success early on, pretty consistently evaluated the information that my performance was telling me, and tried to make adjustments as quickly as possible. I didn’t have the luxury of infinite runway in front of me to figure things out over time. If that’s an attitude or approach that I take to this job, then I think that’s OK.”

Breslow’s playing career may also inform his approach to in-season risks in another way: The way he values the chance to contend for a title.

It certainly would have been understandable if the Sox had decided by mid-June — around their 32-46 nadir — that they were open for business in a sell-off. Indeed, the Sox were at least starting to prepare for such an eventuality, with some of their pro scouts assigned to organizations who might be interested in short-term veterans, particularly Sonny Gray (who will be a free agent after 2026).

That said, Breslow had experience as a player of a long-shot team emerging as a champion. And so, even though there were few precedents for a team such as the Sox to overcome their long odds, based on his belief in the talent of the group, Breslow wanted to give the team as much time as possible to compete, respecting what he referred to as “the sanctity of a season.”

“Maybe that is born out of my playing career and the fact that the Red Sox won the World Series in 2013 as an improbable group going into the season,” he said. “Fundamentally, my confidence and belief in the players that we had on our roster [in 2026] had not changed. Players didn’t become meaningfully less talented. My belief in the roster was consistent.”

“But it’s interesting. Everybody who sits in my seat is going to talk about sustainability and the ability to compete for championships every single year. I think

it’s very important to balance that with acknowledging the importance of every individual season. Otherwise, you talk about windows and about how maybe this isn’t the year, but that’s OK because next year we’ll still have the core of a really good team.

“I have learned that sometimes really good teams don’t have the seasons that they want. Sometimes teams that you don’t have maybe the highest expectations far outperform them for a season’s length. So you don’t want to dismiss what is immediately in front of you in exchange for this idea of lumping seasons together and just kind of thinking about being in the midst of a window.”

And so, the Sox ended up doing the opposite of what everyone forecast. A team for whom a veteran sell-off seemed almost inevitable instead ended up — thanks to one of the great runs in franchise history from late June to mid-August — taking big swings for deadline upgrades with moves to add infielder Curtis Mead and Rutschman.

In different ways, both moves stunned the industry given what the Sox gave up. But from afar, Rangers president of baseball operations Chris Young — like Breslow, a former player — could appreciate what his colleague did.

“In general, careers are short, and I want every player that puts on our uniform to have a chance to compete for a World Series. That should be our goal as an organization,” said Young, whose Texas team finished 2023 as champion. “When you have a team that’s in a win cycle, you need to be bold at times to go for it.

“It doesn’t mean necessarily you’re going to sustain success, but the goal is not to just make the playoffs. The goal is to win championships. [And] there’s no doubt the player in me is influenced by the opportunity to win.”

Breslow’s deadline deals were motivated by a similar hunger. Now that the Red Sox have qualified for the playoffs, the ultimate impact of the bets made by Breslow in what he repeatedly described as a “difficult” season will gain greater definition in the postseason tournament.

But regardless of what happens, the path to get to the playoffs represented a fascinating shift in how the Red Sox conducted business, in a fashion that defied expectations at numerous turns on and off the field.

“We knew this was a guy who was not going to be afraid to do hard things and make really hard, bold calls in a city, in an organization that needed that type of toughness, that conviction in decision-making. . . . That’s really hard to do in this environment,” said CEO/president Sam Kennedy. “We couldn’t be more pleased with the trajectory of the organization under [Breslow’s] leadership.”

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FILE/WINSLOW TOWNSON/GETTY IMAGES

Craig Breslow (above) gambled by firing Alex Cora and six members of his staff.

Sun’s first coach reflects on how it all started in Connecticut

By Julian Benbow
GLOBE STAFF

When **Mike Thibault** was introduced as the Connecticut Sun’s first head coach in 2003, after the Mohegan Tribe bought the Orlando Miracle and moved them to Uncasville, he won the room over.

He had a coaching mind fit for the NBA — and references to vouch for him: **Jeff Van Gundy**, **Ernie Grunfeld**, **Terry Stotts**, and **Jerry West**.

But 23 years later, Thibault remembered sitting alone in the stands after the news conference that night, asking himself, “OK, what the hell did I just do?”

He had no equipment. No basketballs. Just the rights to players.

The Sun also had no template. No other small-market, independently owned operation as a road map. Just three months to have a team ready.

They won 18 games his first year, the first of six straight winning seasons.

Over Thibault’s 10 years in Connecticut, they won 206 games in the regular season and 20 more in the playoffs.

“It got to be about six or seven years into it, there were newer teams that came to us for advice,” he said.

Thibault returned Sunday as a “Sun Legend” honoree in the team’s game against the Minnesota Lynx, a 101-89 loss. The Sun lost again to the host Washington Mystics, 79-69, on Tuesday and will host Toronto Tempo on hursday in their finale.

After exploring a move to Boston or remaining in Connecticut under new ownership, the Mohegan Tribe sold the franchise to Houston Rockets owner Tilman Fertitta, who will revive the Comets in 2027 after an 19-season absence. In an era of growth and expansion, Thibault understands the direction the league is headed, but he hoped the Sun could remain in the region.

“I was hoping that at worst case it would go to Boston,” he said. “That was my own personal hope, but that didn’t

happen.”

Thibault retired as a WNBA coach in 2022 after 10 seasons with the Mystics, then left his general manager position in 2024.

Asked if there was still room for small-market teams to survive, he was uncertain.

“I think it’s possible, but as the league has tried to go through this process of expansion and sales, to make sure you pick markets that you know will succeed,” he said. “I think the league has changed in this regard, and I don’t mean this as a knock on the situation here, but as the league has changed and grown, bigger cities can support it differently.”

Blueprint for expansion

The Golden State Valkyries have been the exception to the expectations for expansion teams in both of their seasons.

Golden State, the first expansion team to reach the playoffs in its inaugu-

ral season last year, has won 31 games this year, and are again leading the league in attendance.

“For everyone who comes to our games, we want to win this for you guys,” coach **Natalie Nakase** said. “You guys are committed to us and we want to make that commitment back. And when you have that type of purpose, when it’s beyond ourselves, I think that drives us even more.”

But Golden State’s blueprint isn’t easy to follow — as this year’s expansion teams found out. The Portland Fire opened 6-4 and had the fifth-best record, but they’ve lost 13 of their last 18 games, going into Tuesday’s late game. The Tempo were 8-8 on June 19, tied for eighth, but have lost 24 of 27.

Toronto had the league’s worst defensive rating and net rating over that span. The Fire had the second-worst defensive rating and fifth-worst net rating over those 18 games.

Still, Portland has supported the Fire, to the tune of the league’s fourth-

highest average attendance (14,452). Toronto sold out all 17 home games at Coca-Cola Coliseum and set a WNBA regular-season attendance record in July with 20,996 fans at Bell Centre in Montreal against the Dallas Wings.

Winning usually takes longer. The only other expansion team with a winning first season was the Detroit Shock in 1998, and it took five years for them to produce another.

Only two expansion franchises have swung from a losing season to a winning season in their first two years. The Atlanta Dream went 18-16 in 2009 after a 4-30 debut in 2008. The Miami Sol went 20-12 in 2001 after going 13-19 in Year 1.

Golden State has shown how quickly an expansion team can win. History suggests Cleveland (2028), Detroit (2029), and Philadelphia (2030) may need more patience.

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CAROLINE BREHMAN/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Giants quarterback Jaxon Dart injured his left knee in Monday night’s game vs. the Rams.

NFL NOTEBOOK

Dart’s status still uncertain

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Jaxon Dart’s injured left knee is being evaluated and no decisions have been made, Giants coach **John Harbaugh** said after the starting quarterback exited Monday night’s game at the Rams.

Harbaugh on Tuesday refused to confirm an ESPN report that Dart’s injury is worse than the initial diagnosis of a sprained medial collateral ligament. Harbaugh said the team would reveal details and a time-frame in due time after the evaluation is complete. Harbaugh expressed confidence in backup **Jameis Winston’s** ability to step in for however long Dart is out.

Dart was 3 of 5 passing before being injured on the first drive at LA. He threw for three touchdowns, had 230 yards passing, and 54 rushing in a season-opening win against Dallas.

“We’ve learned a lot more,” Harbaugh said on a video call with reporters. “When we know what direction we’re going to have to go or whatever it might be, we’ll announce that. But we don’t have that yet, so I don’t want to get out over our skis on that.”

After the 28-6 loss to the Rams, Harbaugh said it was “in the neighborhood” and that an MRI would lead to more information.

Jets sign ex-Titans QB

The Jets signed former Titans quarterback **Will Levis**, a second-round draft pick in 2023, to their practice squad, a person familiar with the move told the Associated Press.

The Jets released quarterback **Bailey Zappe** from the practice squad to make room for Levis, the person told the AP on condition of anonymity because

the team hadn’t announced the signing.

The 27-year-old Levis worked out for the Jets earlier this month. He was released by the Titans last month as part of their final roster cuts.

The Jets have starter **Geno Smith** and rookie **Cade Kubnik**, a fourth-rounder, on their active roster, so Levis would be the third-stringer and inactive on game day unless he’s promoted from the practice squad.

Levis, who missed last season after having shoulder surgery, said in August he thought he was still capable of being a starting quarterback.

Penix excited to start

Michael Penix Jr. said he finally began feeling healthy enough to play in a game last week and had his rising confidence confirmed when his surgically repaired left knee reacted well to a strenuous workout Saturday. The Falcons announced Monday that Penix will start on Thursday night at Green Bay. The decision came one day after **Cooper Rush** again struggled as the fill-in starter in Sunday’s 34-3 loss to the NFC South rival Panthers.

“I’m very excited, you know, obviously excited to be able to be out there,” Penix said following practice. “You know, I’m going to war with my brothers, so it’s very exciting when you make the final decision.”

Bears hurting at QB

Bears quarterback **Tyson Bagent** was placed in concussion protocol, according to a person familiar with the situation, adding to the uncertainty surrounding the team’s plans for Monday night’s game against Philadelphia.

Bagent was expected to take most of the first-team reps in practice after **Caleb Williams** left Sunday’s 9-3 loss to Minnesota with a right hamstring injury. Coach **Ben Johnson** said Monday that Williams is “week to week,” and he left open the possibility that the No. 1 pick in the 2024 draft could play against the Eagles.

If Williams and Bagent are unable to play, the Bears likely would turn to 38-year-old **Case Keenum**, who hasn’t thrown a pass in a regular-season game since Dec. 24, 2023.

Colts add veteran WR

The Colts signed veteran receiver **Darius Slayton**, two days after **Alec Pierce** hopped off the field with an injured left heel during their 33-30 overtime loss at Kansas City. Colts coach **Shane Steichen** said Pierce aggravated an injury that put him on last week’s injury report. Steichen was unsure how much time, if any, the Colts’ top receiver would miss, but the NFL Network reported Pierce, who signed a four-year, \$116 million contract in March, could miss multiple weeks . . . With **Ricky Pearsall** out for the year, rookie **De’Zhaun Stribling** out at least two months, and **Demarcus Robinson** out with a high ankle injury from Sunday’s win over the Dolphins, the 49ers added help for their wide receiver room when former Patriot **Brandin Cooks** agreed to a practice-squad deal. Cooks, who turns 33 on Friday, spent last season with New Orleans and Buffalo, making 24 catches for 279 yards in 15 games . . . Packers offensive tackle **Zach Bakobewe** has a torn patellar tendon and is expected to miss the rest of the season.

Three to watch

Team health: The Patriots will have to monitor the availability of several players this week. Cornerback Carlton Davis (neck) missed Sunday’s game, while Jones (shoulder), safeties Craig Woodson (shoulder) and Dell Pettus (ankle), and rookie tight end Eli Raridon (thigh) left with injuries.

Options at right guard: Onwenu is going to miss significant time with his broken right ankle, so the Patriots will need to decide on a starter at right guard. Greg Van Roten took Onwenu’s place Sunday, but the Patriots could also consider Ben Brown and even rookie right tackle Caleb Lomu. The 36-year-old Van Roten has plenty of experience but struggled in run-blocking and pass protection when thrust into action. Said Vrabel, “We just have to make sure we have the best five available.”

Practice-squad movement: Each week, the Patriots are able to temporarily elevate two players from the practice squad to the game-day roster. They used a spot on punter Mitch Wishnowsky the past two weeks with Bryce Baringer injured, but ended up signing Wishnowsky to the 53-man roster Tuesday. Vrabel indicated the Patriots will turn to the practice squad to aid with their depth concerns. Possibilities include edge rusher Xavier Holmes or safety Mike Brown.

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Bruins’ Jacobs steps down as board chair

By Kevin Paul Dupont
GLOBE STAFF

The National Hockey League announced early Tuesday afternoon that Jeremy Jacobs, who purchased the Bruins in 1975, has stepped down after a 19-year tenure as chairman of the league’s Board of Governors.

Jacobs, 86, has been replaced by Capitals owner Ted Leonsis, 69, a 1973 Lowell High School graduate and onetime communications director of Lowell-based Wang Laboratories.

Flames governor Murray Edwards will move into the position of vice chairman of the board.

“It has been one of the great privileges of my career to work alongside Jeremy Jacobs for the last 19 years as he led the Board of Governors with a rare combination of steadiness and vision,” said NHL commissioner Gary Bettman. “His wisdom and unwavering commitment to this league have helped guide us through a period of unprecedented growth, both on and off



2018 FILE/JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE

Jeremy Jacobs led Board of Governors for 19 years.

the ice. On behalf of the Board of Governors, our clubs and our fans, I want to express my deepest gratitude for his extraordinary service and his enduring legacy as one of the great leaders in the history of our game.”

Jacobs, who has long kept residences in suburban Buffalo and Wellington, Fla., was among the lead ownership voices behind the league negotiating a salary cap with the players that was adopted for the 2005-

06 season

The cap, which began with a \$39 million ceiling for each team, remains in place and this season has been set at \$104 million. It calls for owners and players to share equally in all hockey-related revenue.

The fight over the cap came during a season-long lockout in 2004-05.

Jacobs, a frequent visitor to TD Garden for decades, has rarely visited Causeway Street in recent years. His son, Charlie, has been the family’s main representative with the team for some 25 years and is the club’s chief executive officer and alternative governor.

The Bruins and the Garden are part of the Jacobs’s family-owned Delaware North, a multibillion-dollar enterprise built on the concessions business.

Leonsis also owns the NBA’s Washington Wizards as part of his Monumental Sports & Entertainment company.

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DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Jeremy Swayman snuffed out this Cole Knuble bid and stopped 20 Flyers shots overall.

Bruins bury Flyers in late flurry

► **BRUINS**
Continued from Page C1

hopeful Max Guenette and shoveling a doorstep forehander by Swayman.

Geekie broke the 1-1 tie early in the third, connecting on a David Pastrnak slap pass with Geekie stationed in the bumper position on the power play.

“Spotter believes Morgan can be one of the best bumpers in the league,” said Bruins coach Marco Sturm, referring to assistant coach Steve Spott, the power play’s architect and engineer.

All five of the Bruins’ goals came from shots delivered low in the offensive zone, from high-danger spots — threats that they could not develop in Round 1 of the playoffs in the spring vs. the Sabres.

Sturm said postgame he addressed on Day 1 of training camp the need to be in high-danger shooting areas.

“We want to spend more time in the O-zone — hold more pucks, protect pucks, hunt pucks,” he said.

Brunet, inching closer to a varsity roster spot, also picked up the primary assist on Halonen’s goal.

Halonen signed with the Bruins over the summer after spending five seasons in the Devils organization, turning pro as a free agent after four seasons at Michigan Tech.

Eyssimont closed the scoring with 1:13 to go in the third, connecting on a quick release in the slot off a Dans Loemelis feed.

• • •

By late Friday night, following their fourth and final exhibition game, the Bruins will have their roster shaped for next Tuesday’s season opener at TD Garden against the Rangers.

Sturm, still deciphering how the parts will fit together for his 23-man roster said “all the young kids” have im-

pressed him for their year-over-year development.

“They were just kids last year, not ready for the big jump,” he said. “They look more and more like men. Hopefully, they’re closer to making the team.”

Among the lead contenders:

■ **Frederic Brunet (D)** — He paired in Sunday’s exhibition opener with franchise defenseman Charlie McAvoy and made it through the night without any significant boos (ice time: 21:45).

Brunet picked up a pair of primary assists in the win over the Fyers, first firing a one-timer from 58 feet that Eyssimont redirected for the 1-0 lead. He then sent in another slapper in the third that led to Halonen’s goal for a 3-1 lead in the third.

Brunet, 23, is among 10 candidates for the seven or eight blue liners to make the roster.

■ **Dans Loemelis (C/F)** — The former UMass pivot played against the Flyers, following his strong showing at the recent rookie tournament in Buffalo, where the 22-year-old showed his shoulder, which required late-season surgery for a torn labrum, was fully healed. He landed two shots on net vs. the Flyers and had the primary assist on Eyssimont’s second goal of the night for the closer.

■ **James Hagens (C/W)** — Not in the lineup vs. the Flyers but he looked comfortable in Sunday’s 3-2 win over the Capitals, which he clinched with a nifty backhandler through the five-hole in the shootout.

■ **Matt Poitras (C/W)** — Age 22 and entering his fourth pro season. Easy to forget, because of his prior twirls with the varsity, he is still just a kid. Picked up an assist Sunday and his game looked calmer, smarter.

“Last year, he wasn’t ready,” mused Sturm. “But another

good year in the minors helped him. Now I can feel he is getting closer.”

■ **Michael DiPietro (G)** — Age 27 and in his ninth pro season, his time finally has arrived. He is a lock to stay on the varsity for 2026-27. Last season’s MVP in the AHL, he logged 30 saves in the 65-minute win Sunday.

“All of a sudden,” noted Sturm, “I’ve got more options.”

English Premier League laggards Tottenham Hotspur may have inadvertently revealed the Bruins’ choice for their captain on Tuesday.

In a since-deleted post from the soccer club’s official account on X, Spurs highlighted midfielder Xavi Simons and his work “on the recovery trail” in Boston. It included time at the Bruins’ training facility where, the post read, Simons “exchanged jerseys with captain David Pastrnak and met with Celtics star Jayson Tatum.”

Said post included a photo of Simons and Pastrnak, which had Pastrnak holding a traditional black Bruins sweater fronted by the spoked-B, but without a captain’s “C.”

The post quickly disappeared from the internet with no explanation offered by Simons or Tottenham.

“I had a couple of texts from the net (sic) obviously,” said Pastrnak, who wore an alternate captain’s “A” for Tuesday’s exhibition game vs. the Flyers. “You know, it’s a football team, so I don’t think you guys should worry about the football team. It was great to have Xavi around and meet up with him.”

The Bruins only have said that they’ll name their “C” prior to the opener.

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JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE GLOBE

Brianna Driscoll is in her first season coaching St. Mary's, despite dealing with effects of the brain aneurysm she suffered in 2023.

HIGH SCHOOL FIELD HOCKEY NOTEBOOK

Driscoll is back on track at St. Mary's

By Kat Cornetta
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

On the outfield grass at Fraser Field in Lynn, the St. Mary's field hockey team carved out a place to practice. With a pickup kickball game on the infield, and a soccer practice on the left field side, there was a lot going on.

The St. Mary's players did not let the hubbub be a distraction, listening intently to every word from first-year coach **Brianna Driscoll**. When she instructed them to pick up the intensity during drills, they did so without complaint.

At the end of practice, Driscoll asked the players to roll the nets off the field and pick up equipment. She called out to the kickball game that they might want to wrap up because a baseball team was scheduled next. She raced a visiting young boy along the baselines.

Just three years ago, all this activity would have been far-fetched for the 33-year-old Driscoll. Her recovery from a brain aneurysm was not certain.

“My motivation to get through my recovery was field hockey,” said Driscoll. “I had to relearn how to walk, read, and write again, and once those things started to come to me, field hockey did as well.”

Driscoll was a coach on the rise. She started at Austin Prep, then an MIAA member of the Catholic Central League, with a club program that met Thursdays at 6 a.m. and Sundays at noon. Not ideal times, but the players showed up for Driscoll. By 2021, Austin Prep's first full season, the program had grown from 20 players to 60 across varsity and junior varsity.

In November 2023, her personal and professional life were flying high. Her team was taking off and she had recently married **Mike Driscoll**, a teacher and coach at St. John's Prep. But preparing to board a bus for Austin Prep's game at Tilton, she had a headache and nausea. A colleague saw her struggling and immediately called an ambulance.

Driscoll had suffered an aneurysm. After brain surgery and a weeklong medically-induced coma, it appeared her coaching days were over. Driscoll did not know the names of loved ones, struggled to move, and faced a second brain surgery.

A month later, Driscoll returned home and worked through months of rehabilitation and therapy. Her long-term memory returned, but she still has short-term memory loss and aphasia, a speech and communication disorder.

In the fall of 2024, Driscoll received the all clear to volunteer coach. North Reading provided an ideal fit: she could walk there (key because she couldn't drive) and she had relatives on the team.

After a two-year stint at North Reading, she felt ready to step back into coaching full time. Driscoll accepted the varsity position at St. Mary's, which had started its program at the same time she was at Austin Prep.

“Obviously our programs had a lot of similarities,” said Driscoll. “We were rivals.”

She brought in **Lydia Rice**, a former Providence College goalie and club field hockey coach, to assist.

“She has been a fantastic partner-in-crime,” said Rice of Driscoll. “She's so knowledgeable. I'm more on the defensive level, so seeing her analytical eye of the field is so great. She's just really inspiring to the kids.”

St. Mary's started 0-2, but has rattled off three straight wins, including Monday's shutout of previously unbeaten Beverly.

“We are so fortunate that Bri-

Globe Top 20

No.		Rec.	Last
1.	Walpole	3-0	1
2.	Franklin	5-0	3
3.	Sandwich	4-0	2
4.	Belmont	5-0	4
5.	Watertown	4-1	5
6.	Somerset Berkley	4-1	6
7.	Andover	4-0	11
8.	Dover-Sherborn	2-0	8
9.	Lincoln-Sudbury	3-0	12
10.	Canton	4-0	13
11.	Dennis-Yarmouth	4-0	14
12.	King Philip	4-1	16
13.	Winchester	2-1	10
14.	Wellesley	2-2	7
15.	Medfield	3-1	18
16.	Concord-Carlisle	2-1	15
17.	Attleboro	3-1	20
18.	Hingham	2-1-1	9
19.	Duxbury	3-1-2	19
20.	Monomoy	1-1	17

anna chose St. Mary's to be part of her tremendous comeback journey,” said St. Mary's athletic director **Jeff Newhall**. “The team is doing so well with her as the head coach both on and off the field.”

The team captains love “Coach Bri” and point to her tenacity as motivation.

“We all have our challenges to work through,” said senior captain **Emma Gustin**. “That she has gone through her own and used her faith to get through them is definitely a motivation for us.”

Driscoll asks for a bit of grace from her team.

“The girls are very patient with me if I call them the wrong name,” said Driscoll. “They will say, ‘Oh, did you mean this person?’ When I start showing a drill [and say the wrong name of it], they'll say, ‘I think this was the name, Coach.’ They are so respectful. That's the benefit of having my long-term memory, the field hockey knowledge is somehow still in there.”

If returning to head coaching for Driscoll, she reached an even bigger one this past spring: she and Mike welcomed their first child, **William**.

Driscoll is living her life similar to one of the refrains she has for the Spartans this season.

“Obstacles don't define our program,” said Driscoll.

Corner hits

■ Top-ranked Walpole (3-0) recorded its second straight one-goal win, slipping by host Bishop Feehan, 2-1, Monday. Sophomore **Ainsley Kelleher** and senior captain **Caroline Handwerk** tallied goals, but coach **Jen Quinn** singled out the defensive play of senior **Ella Dacey** in the back.

“I think in the second half we did a much better job of opening things up, spreading out, and trying to use our speed and our athleticism to create that quick fast offense,” said Quinn. “Ella Dacey was fantastic. We really struggled the first half, we didn't play the greatest and if she wasn't back there I don't know what would have happened.”

■ In her 41st season, Watertown coach **Eileen Donahue** earned her 800th win Tuesday, 4-0, over visiting Stoneham. She is the fifth coach nationally to hit the mark, joining **Susan Butz-Stavin** (Emmaus, Pa., 1,027), **Laurie Berger** (Morse/Serra, Calif., 879), **Linda Kreiser** (Lower Dauphin, Pa., 876), and **Nancy Williams** (Shore Regional, N.J., 839).

Inaaya Omer contributed.

Schools

CROSS-COUNTRY		SOCCER	
BOYS		COMMONWEALTH	
CATHOLIC CENTRAL		Lynn Tech 0.....Shawsheen 0	
Abp. Williams 15.....Arlington Cath. 40		Mystic Valley 6.....Lowell Cath. 3	
Bp. Fenwick 20.....Card. Spellman 41		Northeast 3.....Gr. Lawrence 0	
Bp. Fenwick 17.....St. Mary's 45		Concord-Carlisle 4.....Boston Latin 0	
Card. Spellman 20.....St. Mary's 43		Lincoln-Sudbury 2.....Bedford 1	
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE		Newton South 6.....Acton-Boxboro 1	
St. John's Prep 16.....BC High 44		Waltham 2.....Weston 1	
Xaverian 26.....Cath. Memorial 31		GREATER BOSTON	
CMAC		Chelsea 1.....Lynn English 0	
Adv. Math & Sci. 15.....Assabet 48		Malden 3.....Medford 2	
Adv. Math & Sci. 25.....Keefe Tech 32		Revere 5.....Everett 3	
Keefe Tech 18.....Assabet 40		Somerville 1.....Lynn Classical 0	
HOCKOMOCK		HOCKOMOCK	
Canton 33.....King Philip 36		Attleboro 3.....Stoughton 1	
Groton-Dunstable 21.....Oakmont 34		Foxboro 2.....King Philip 1	
MIDDLESEX		Milford 5.....Taunton 2	
Reading 17.....Woburn 15		Sharon 3.....Franklin 1	
PATRIOT		MAYFLOWER	
Hingham 25.....Duxbury 32		Cape Cod Tech 3.....Old Colony 1	
N. Quincy/Quincy 15.....Hanover 50		Southeastern 8.....Blue Hills 3	
Pembroke 26.....Plymouth South 29		Wareham 6.....Avon 0	
Quincy/N. Quincy 15.....Hanover 44		Westport 5.....Holbrook 0	
SOUTH COAST		MERRIMACK VALLEY	
Seekonk 18.....Old Rochester 44		Central Cath. 4.....Lawrence 0	
SOUTH SHORE		Dracut 2.....Chelmsford 0	
Norwell 25.....Carver 35		N. Andover 4.....Tewksbury 1	
VALLEY LEAGUE		MID-WACH	
Northampton 20.....Springfield Cntrl 38		Algonquin 2.....Leominster 0	
CATHOLIC CENTRAL		Grafton 1.....Wachusett 1	
Abp. Williams 25.....Arlington Cath. 30		Nashoba 3.....Groton-Dunstable 0	
Bp. Fenwick 15.....Card. Spellman 50		Shepherd Hill 2.....N. Middlesex 1	
Bp. Fenwick 26.....St. Mary's 31		Shrewsbury 4.....Westboro 1	
St. Mary's 15.....Card. Spellman 50		MORIARTY	
CMAC		Wahconah 2.....Easthampton 1	
Adv. Math & Sci. 15.....Assabet 50		PATRIOT	
Adv. Math & Sci. 15.....Keefe Tech 50		Duxbury 10.....N. Quincy 1	
HOCKOMOCK		Hanover 2.....Whit-Hanson 0	
Canton 23.....King Philip 36		Hingham 3.....Quincy 1	
MID-WACH		Marshfield 3.....Plymouth South 2	
Oakmont 16.....Groton-Dunstable 39		Pembroke 3.....Silver Lake 2	
MIDDLESEX		Scituate 0.....Plymouth North 0	
Reading 16.....Woburn 47		SCHMID	
Wilmington 27.....Stoneham 28		Hopkins 2.....Pioneer Valley 1	
PATRIOT		SOUTH SHORE	
Duxbury 19.....Hingham 40		Cohasset 6.....Wachusett 0	
Plymouth South 26.....Pembroke 29		E. Bridgewater 2.....Mashpee 0	
Quincy/N. Quincy 18.....Hanover 41		Middleboro 3.....Carver 2	
Silver Lake 17.....Whit-Hanson 46		Norwell 2.....Abington 1	
SOUTH COAST		Rockland 1.....Hull 0	
Old Rochester 20.....Seekonk 35		TRI-COUNTY	
SOUTH SHORE		Pathfinder 10.....Ware 0	
Norwell 15.....Carver 40		NONLEAGUE	
TRI-VALLEY		BC High 2.....Brookton 0	
Westwood 18.....Medfield 37		Braintree 1.....Dover-Sherborn 0	
VALLEY LEAGUE		Bridge-Raynham 2.....Dunfee 0	
Northampton 15.....Holyoke 50		Cambridge 1.....Wellesley 0	
Northampton 19.....Sprngfld Central 44		Dartmouth 1.....New Bedford 1	
Springfield Central 15.....Holyoke 50		Framingham 1.....St. John's Prep 1	
FIELD HOCKEY		Granby 4.....Mahar 0	
CMAC		Lunenburg 2.....Bromfield 2	
B Path/D Prouty 7.....Worc Tech/North 1		Madison Park 5.....Boston Collegiate 1	
Hopdale 3.....Sutton 2		Marlborough 2.....Oakmont 0	
ND Academy-Worcester 6.....Uxbridge 0		Maynard 4.....Hudson 2	
Oxford 4.....Leicester 0		McCann Tech 3.....Mt. Everett 1	
St. Bernard's 3.....St. Paul 1		Monson 3.....Smith Academy 0	
HOCKOMOCK		Northampton 3.....W. Springfield 0	
Canton 6.....North Attleboro 0		Northbridge 2.....Nipmuc 1	
Franklin 8.....Attleboro 0		Putnam Christian 5.....Renaissance 2	
King Philip 7.....Oliver Ames 1		P.V. Catholic 5.....St. Mary (Westfield) 0	
Mansfield 2.....Foxboro 1		Salem 3.....Whittier 0	
MIDDLESEX		Upper Cape 5.....Tri-County 0	
Belmont 8.....Woburn 1		CAPE & ISLANDS	
Reading 1.....Arlington 0		Falmouth 5.....St. John Paul II 0	
Wakefield 1.....Burlington 1		Falmouth Acad. 2.....Dennis-Yarmouth 2	
Watertown 4.....Stoneham 0		Sandwich 2.....Nauset 0	
Winchester 3.....Lexington 1		CAPE ANN	
NORTHEASTERN		Georgetown 2.....Essex Tech 1	
Saugus 7.....Peabody 0		Lynnfield 0.....Ham-Wenham 0	
SOUTH COAST		N. Reading 1.....Manchester 0	
Apponequet 2.....Seekonk 2		Pentucket 4.....Rockport 1	
Old Rochester 2.....Fairhaven 0		CMAC	
W. Bridgewater 8.....Joseph Case 0		Adv. Math & Sci. 4.....Oxford 1	
TRI-VALLEY		Hopdale 7.....ND Academy-Worc 1	
Ashland 3.....Norwood 2		COOMBS	
Dover-Sherborn 4.....Medway 1		Minnechaug 3.....Belchertown 2	
Hopkinton 3.....Medfield 2		DUAL COUNTY	
Westwood 3.....Holliston 0		Newton South 1.....Acton-Boxboro 1	
VALLEY LEAGUE		Waltham 4.....Weston 0	
Westfield 1.....Southwick 0		GREATER BOSTON	
NONLEAGUE		Chelsea 1.....Lynn English 0	
Amherst-Pelham 1.....Smith Academy 0		Medford 4.....Malden 0	
Arlington Cath. 10.....Malden 0		Somerville 10.....Lynn Classical 0	
Bellingham 6.....Stoughton 2		HOCKOMOCK	
Bp. Fenwick 4.....Marblehead 2		Foxboro 2.....King Philip 2	
BB&N 6.....Winsor 3		Franklin 3.....Sharon 1	
Concord-Carlisle 1.....Wellesley 1		Mansfield 1.....Canton 1	
Doherty 2.....Tantasqua 0		Milford 4.....Taunton 1	
Frontier 8.....Auburn 0		Stoughton 0.....Attleboro 0	
Gloucester 7.....Malden Cath. 2		MAYFLOWER	
Phillips Andover 6.....Brooks 0		Blue Hills 1.....Southeastern 2	
St. John Paul II 1.....Bp. Stang 1		Bristol-Plymouth 4.....Diman 0	
Sandwich 3.....Notre Dame (H) 0		Old Colony 6.....Cape Cod Tech 1	
S. Hadley 4.....Northampton 0		Wareham 3.....Avon 0	
Worcester South 4.....Monty Tech 3		Westport 5.....Holbrook 0	
GOLF		MERRIMACK VALLEY	
BOYS		Andover 4.....Methuen 1	
BAY STATE		Central Cath. 8.....Lawrence 0	
Natick 212.....Framingham 236		Chelmsford 3.....Dracut 1	
Walpole 166.....Burlington 223		Haverhill 6.....Lowell 2	
BERKSHIRE		Tewksbury 2.....N. Andover 1	
Lenox 152.....Hoosac Valley/Drury 198		MID-WACH	
BI-COUNTY		Leominster 2.....Groton-Dunstable 0	
Franklin City. Tech 156.....Mo. Trail 208		Littleton 1.....Tyngsboro 1	
Westfield Tech 172.....Pioneer Valley 180		Narransett 4.....Ayer Shirley 1	
CAPE & ISLANDS		Concord-Carlisle 4.....Algonquin 0	
Dennis-Yarmouth 259Cape Cod Acad. 328		Shepherd Hill 1.....N. Middlesex 1	
St. John Paul II 234Martha's Vnyd. 246		Shrewsbury 3.....Westboro 0	
Stang 218.....Rising Tide Chtr 241		Wachusett 0.....Grafton 0	
Ham-Wenham 160.....Ipswich 133		PATRIOT	
CATHOLIC CENTRAL		Duxbury 6.....N. Quincy 0	
Abp. Williams 212.....St. Mary's 168		Hanover 5.....Whit-Hanson 0	
Bc Stang 233.....Card. Spellman 172		Hingham 11.....Quincy 0	
BC High 226.....Cath. Memorial 240		Marshfield 3.....Plymouth South 0	
St. John's (S) 236.....St. John's Prep 241		Plymouth North 1.....Scituate 0	
Xaverian 223.....Malden Cath. 259		SOUTH SHORE	
CMAC		Cohasset 6.....Randolph 0	
Auburn 166.....Douglas 176		Middleboro 3.....Carver 0	
Hopdale 164.....Blackstone Valley 174		Norwell 8.....Abington 1	
Monty Tech 160.....Doherty 190		Rockland 4.....Hull 1	
Oxford 206.....Bartlett 235		TRI-VALLEY	
Quaboag 183.....Leicester 167		Ashland 2.....Norwood 1	
St. Bernard's 170.....Worcester Tech 181		NONLEAGUE	
Oakmont 157.....Assabet 205		Amherst-Pelham 4.....Southwick 2	
Sutton 153.....Millbury 205		Altshier Charter 1.....Roxbury Prep 1	
DUAL COUNTY		Bay Path 3.....Quaboag 0	
Newton South 228.....Cambridge 275		Brooke Charter 5.....Brighton 1	
Weston 250.....Greater Boston 262		Brookline 1.....Boston Latin 0	
LYNN		E. Longmeadow 1.....Longmeadow 1	
Lynn Classical 44.....Everett 27		Fitchburg 4.....W. Boylston 1	
Lyndford 371/2.....Lynn English 341/2		Hampden Charter East 1.....Commerce 0	
HOCKOMOCK		Hampshire 3.....Frontier 1	
Attleboro 175.....Stoughton 189		Hudson 6.....Maynard 1	
Canton 160.....Brookfield 164		Lee 4.....Pathfinder 0	
Mansfield 142.....King Philip 143		Lincoln-Sudbury 4.....Bedford 1	
North Attleboro 155.....Taunton 177		Ludlow 4.....Chicopee Comp. 0	
MAYFLOWER		Lunenburg 5.....Bromfield 1	
Blue Hills 51/2.....Old Colony 31/2		Marlborough 2.....Oakmont 1	
Cape Cod Tech 6.....Bristol-Plymouth 3		Methuen 2.....Bridge-Randolph 0	
Tri-County 8.....Norfolk Aggie 1		Mt. Greylock 5.....Lenox 1	
MERRIMACK VALLEY		Northampton 6.....Agawam 1	
Andover 233.....Dracut 261		Northbridge 0.....Nipmuc (susp.) 0	
Andover 233.....Haverhill 260		Pope Francis 3.....Westfield 1	
Haverhill 260.....Dracut 261		Quabbin 3.....Gardner 2	
MID-WACH		St. Bernard's 9.....Muniz 0	
Algonquin 187.....Shrewsbury 200		Sutton 5.....Doherty 0	
Ayer Shirley 157.....Maynard 174		Tri-County 6.....Upper Cape 1	
Bronfield 170.....Quabbin 191		Walpole 4.....O'Byrant 0	
Nashoba 192.....Westboro 204		Wahconah 3.....Drury 0	
Oakmont 151.....Marlborough 188		W. Springfield 1.....S. Hadley 1	
Tyngsboro 157.....Clinton 160		SWIMMING	
MIDDLESEX		COED	
Wakefield 44.....Stoneham 28		Methuen/Tewks 101.....Central Cath. 72	
Watertown 38.....Burlington 34		VOLLEYBALL	
NORTHEASTERN		GIRLS	
Beverly 611/2.....Peabody 101/2		BOSTON CITY	
Marblehead 45.....Danvers 27		Brighton 3.....English High 1	
Winthrop 44.....Danvers 27		New Mission 3.....Madison Park 0	
PATRIOT		O'Byrant 3.....Latin Acad. 0	
Hingham 23.....V. Hanson 20		Tech/Bos/Henderson 3.....Bos United 0	
Marshfield 23.....Silver Lake 245		Falmouth 3.....CAPE & ISLANDS	
Plymouth South 248.....Quincy 255		Pentucket 3.....Norwood 1	
Scituate 233.....Pembroke 249		CATHOLIC CENTRAL	
SOUTH COAST		Abp. Williams 3.....Bp. Stang 2	
Old Rochester 228.....Apponequet 271		St. Mary's 3.....Arlington Cath. 3	
Somerset Bedford 270Joseph Case 278		CATHOLIC CONFERENCE	
SOUTH SHORE		Notre Dame (H) 3.....Ursuline 2	
Carver 103.....Rockland 95		COMMONWEALTH	
Mashpee 130.....Middleboro 121		Gr. Lowell 3.....Lowell Cath. 0	
Norwell 144.....Cohasset 136		Whittier 3.....Innovation Academy 0	
SUBURBAN		EASTERN	
Hampshire 167.....Frothingham 180		Longmeadow 3.....Amherst-Pelham 1	
TRI-VALLEY		GREATER BOSTON	
Bellingham 234.....Westham 269		Lynn Classical 3.....Medford 0	
Dover-Sherborn 244.....Dedham 252		HOCKOMOCK	
North 216.....Norwood 245		Canton 3.....North Attleboro 0	
VALLEY LEAGUE		Franklin 3.....Attleboro 0	
Longmeadow 149.....Agawam 169		Mansfield 3.....Foxboro 0	
Westfield 169.....E. Longmeadow 166		Milford 3.....Stoughton 0	
CONLEAGUE		Miford 5.....King Philip 2	
Bp. Feehan 131.....Bridge-Raynham 119		Taunton 3.....Sharon 1	
Concord-Carlisle 241.....Hopkinton 269		MERRIMACK VALLEY	
E. Longmeadow 164Springfield Cntrl 240		Central Cath. 3.....Andover 2	
Manchester 118.....Salem 86		Chelmsford 3.....Haverhill 0	
M. N. 227.....Needham 238		Dracut 3.....Lowell 0	
Melrose 4.....Arlington 31		N. Andover 3.....Lawrence 0	
St. Middlesex 167.....Leominster 172		MIDDLESEX	
Pope Francis 168.....S. Hadley 176		Belmont 3.....Woburn 0	
Reading 36.....Central Cath. 36		Burlington 3.....Wakefield 2	
Smith 174.....Wilmington 182		E. Boston 3.....Muniz 0	
Tahito Rev. 163.....Hopkins 197		Reading 3.....Arlington 0	
Santo 228.....Fitchburg 229		Watertown 3.....Stoneham 0	
Tewksbury 243.....Bedford 250		Winchester 3.....Lexington 0	
W. Springfield 166.....Belchertown 176		SOUTH SHORE	
CARVER		Carver 3.....Mashpee 0	
Norwell 3.....Middleboro 2		Norwell 3.....Middleboro 2	
Rockland 3.....Randolph 0		NONLEAGUE	
Bp. Fenwick 3.....Ham-Wenham 0		Bp. Fenwick 3.....Ham-Wenham 0	
Cambridge 3.....Gr. Lawrence 1		Cambridge 3.....Gr. Lawrence 1	
E. Boston 3.....S. Lancaster 1		Fitchburg 3.....S. Lancaster 1	
Hilbrook 3.....Boston Collegiate 0		Hilbrook 3.....Boston Collegiate 0	
Keefe Tech 3.....Nashoba Tech 0		Keefe Tech 3.....Nashoba Tech 0	
Medway 3.....Nashoba 0		Medway 3.....Nashoba 0	
Natick 3.....Foxboro Charter 0		Natick 3.....Foxboro Charter 0	
Northeast 3.....Minuteman 1		Northeast 3.....Minuteman 1	
Norwood 3.....Walpole 0		Norwood 3.....Walpole 0	
Shrewsbury 3.....Ashland 1		Shrewsbury 3.....Ashland 1	
Westford 3.....Tewksbury 0		Westford 3.....Tewksbury 0	
For updated scores and highlights, go to bostonglobe.com/sports/high-schools .			

The Boston Globe

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Remembered

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BY CITY AND TOWN

ALLSTON TOBIN, James J.	READING CONWAY, John J. “Jack”
BARNSTABLE CONWAY, John J. “Jack” ROBICHAUD, Carolyn S.	REVERE BONFIGLIO, Wilhelmina (Saccardo)
BRIGHTON TOBIN, James J.	SOMERVILLE DeGUGLIELMO, Francesco
BROOKLINE DUGGAN, Robert Francis	STOUGHTON ROBICHAUD, Carolyn S.
CAMBRIDGE CONWAY, John J. “Jack”	WAREHAM ROBICHAUD, Carolyn S.
FITCHBURG CONWAY, John J. “Jack”	WEST ROXBURY BONFIGLIO, Wilhelmina (Saccardo)
HINGHAM DUGGAN, Robert Francis	WESTWOOD BONFIGLIO, Wilhelmina (Saccardo)
MALDEN BONFIGLIO, Wilhelmina (Saccardo)	WEYMOUTH DUGGAN, Robert Francis
NORTH END BONFIGLIO, Wilhelmina (Saccardo)	WOLLASTON DUGGAN, Robert Francis
QUINCY DUGGAN, Robert Francis	

BONFIGLIO, Wilhelmina “Nina” (Saccardo)

Age 96, of Revere, passed away peacefully on September 12, 2026, surrounded by her family. Beloved wife of the late Nicholas, devoted sister of the late Anthony Saccardo, Mary Kennedy, and Helen Solimine. Loving and cherished aunt and great aunt to many nieces and nephews. Lifelong resident of the North End of Boston before moving to Malden, Revere, and Sacramento, CA. She was a devoted sister, aunt, and friend who brought joy to everyone around her. Retired after many years as an Executive Assistant in the Financial Industry. Relatives and friends are invited to pay their respects from 9:30AM to 10:30AM on Friday, September 25, 2026, at St. Leonard Church, 320 Hanover St., Boston, MA 02113 followed by a Funeral Mass at 10:30AM. In lieu of flowers, donations can be made in Nina's memory to the St Jude Children's Research Hospital.

**617-536-4110**

DeGUGLIELMO, Francesco “Frankie”

It is with deep love and sorrow that we announce the passing of Francesco DeGuglielmo, who departed this life peacefully, on September 19, 2026, at the age of 92. Son of the late Pacifico DeGuglielmo and Giuseppina (Ippolito) DeGuglielmo. Former husband and close friend of Josephine DeGuglielmo. Brother of the late Pellegrino and his wife, the late Giovanna, Antonietta Petruzzello and her late husband, Lorenzo, Enrichetta Marotta and her late husband, Enrico, Charles DeGuglielmo and his wife, Jeanette, Sr. Evelina DeGuglielmo FMM, Rita Paci and husband, Andrea. Francesco is also survived by many cousins, nieces, nephews, relatives and friends. For full obituary, please see Rogers Funeral Home website: www.rogersfuneralhome.net

Rogers & Hutchins Funeral Homes
Cambridge & Arlington
rogersfuneralhome.net

DUGGAN, Robert Francis “Bob”





Age 90, of Weymouth, formerly of Quincy, died peacefully, September 18, 2026, at the South Shore Hospital, Weymouth.

Born in Boston, on February 26, 1936, son of the late Henry and Lucy (Battles) Duggan. Husband of Marianne E. (Ahern) Duggan of Weymouth and the late Mary E. (Logue) Duggan, who died in 2022. Father of Robert F. Duggan, Jr. of Brookline and Kevin M. Duggan and his wife, Cristina of Hingham. Stepfather of Ellen Murphy of Dennis. Grandfather of Leila and Jack Duggan, both of Hingham. Step-grandfather of Lindsey George and her husband, Adam of Rockland and Jessica Barrus of Weymouth. Step-great-grandfather of Audrey George of Rockland. Brother of the late Marie Keefe and Harry Duggan and his surviving wife, Pat of Quincy. Also survived by many nieces and nephews.

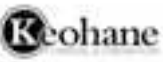
Relatives and friends are respectfully invited to greet the family during the Visiting Hours on Thursday, September 24, 2026, from 4-7 PM, in the McDonald Keohane Funeral Home, SOUTH WEYMOUTH, at 809 Main Street (Route 18, opposite of South Shore Hospital).

A Celebration of Life Service will be held in the funeral home, at 9:30 AM, on Friday, September 25, 2026, prior to the Funeral Mass in Sacred Heart Church, Weymouth, at 10:30 AM.

Services conclude with interment and Army Military Honors in Old North Cemetery, Weymouth.

In lieu of flowers, donations in Bob's name may be sent to the charitable organization of one's choice.

See complete obituary, at www.Keohane.com



Announcements

PIPEFITTERS' LOCAL UNION 537

We regret to announce the death of Brother William J. Wedgwood, who passed away on September 16, 2026.

Services will be private.

Daniel T. O'Brien, Business Manager/FST
Henry V. DiNino, President

ROBICHAUD, Carolyn S. (Sampson)



Age 88, of Centerville, passed away on September 20, 2026, at Tobey Hospital, Wareham.

She was the wife of the late John Nelson Robichaud; and the daughter of the late Joseph and Marion (Hartil) Sampson. She was born in Fall River and lived in Stoughton and Centerville. She summered in Onset for most of her life. She also lived in Germany while her husband was stationed there, while serving in the Air Force.

She graduated from Durfee High School in Fall River and Becker Junior College in Worcester. She owned and operated Christmas Carols in Easton.

Survivors include her children, Holy R. Webster and her husband, Daniel of Lakeville and Scott N. Robichaud and his wife, Nicole of West Bridgewater; her grandchildren, Abigail, Jack and Brooke. She loved crafting, painting, knitting and all things Christmas. Most of all she was an accomplished conversationalist.

Visiting Hours are from 11:00 a.m. to 12:00 p.m., on Thursday, September 24, 2026, at Chapman Funerals & Cremations, WAREHAM. A Funeral service will follow at 12:00 p.m., at the funeral home. Burial will be private.

TOBIN, James J.





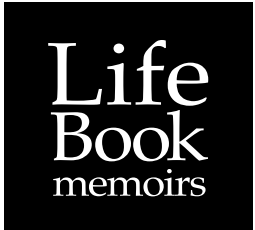
James, J. Tobin Esq. of Brighton, formally of Allston, passed peacefully at home, surrounded by his loving family, on September 21, 2026, at the age of 91. A Navy veteran and legal council at Boston Gas for over 40 years. A devote Catholic and Red Sox fan. Above all, and most importantly, he was a beloved husband of the late Helena M. (Lennon) Tobin. Devoted father of Jeff and wife, Patricia of Dorchester, Paul of Brighton, Catherine of Brighton, Elizabeth Tobin Esq. and husband, Matt Harris of Wayland, the late Matthew Esq. of Scituate, Sheila Cronin and husband, Micheal of Quincy, the late Theresa of Brighton, Mark of Dorchester, the late Michael of Weymouth, Eileen of Brighton, Maureen and husband, Jim Tziavas of Ashland and Amy Kubilis of Brighton. Brother of William Tobin of Florida, Richard Tobin of Bellingham, the late Eileen Martin of Chestnut Hill, Mary Pagano of West Roxbury, John Tobin of West Roxbury and Rita Tobin of Chestnut Hill. Also survived by 18 grandchildren, one great-grandson and too many nieces and nephews to mention. Funeral from the Lehman Reen & McNamara Funeral Home, 63 Chestnut Hill Ave., BRIGHTON, on Friday, September 25, at 9:30am. Followed by a Funeral Mass at St. Columbkille's Church, 321 Market St., Brighton, at 10:30 AM. Relatives and friends are kindly invited to attend. Interment at St. Josephs Cemetery in West Roxbury, MA. Visiting Hours on Thursday, September 24, from 4-7pm, in the funeral home. In lieu of flowers, donations can be made to the St. Columbkille Partnership School, 25 Arlington St., Brighton, MA 02135. For directions and guest book, please see www.lehmanreen.com

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Obituaries

Timothy Pigford, 74, who fought bias against Black farmers

By Adam Nossiter
NEW YORK TIMES

Timothy Pigford, a North Carolina farmer whose lawsuit against the Department of Agriculture for systemically denying loans to Black farmers resulted in the largest civil rights settlement in US history, died on Aug. 23 in Washington, N.C. He was 74.

His death, in a hospital, was confirmed by his wife, Janice Pigford, who said the cause was cancer.

Mr. Pigford was an embattled corn and soybean tenant farmer in southeastern North Carolina, tired of years of being turned down for loans by local white Agriculture Department officials, when he signed on with several other Black farmers to the landmark lawsuit Pigford v. Glickman in August 1997. The defendant was Dan Glickman, the US secretary of agriculture.

The suit was an attempt to redress the department's long history of racism, which the historian Evan Bennett said in an interview was “baked in from the beginning.” By some measures, Pigford v. Glickman was a big success for the farmers.

The department had “willfully discriminated” in processing loan applications from 1983 to 1996, the suit said, though racism had festered for decades, particularly in the rural South, where agriculture officials were white, Jim Crow was the order of the day, and Black farmers were losing their land at an alarming rate.

More than \$2 billion was eventually doled out to tens of thousands of Black claimants, many in increments of \$50,000, and Mr. Pigford and his wife got a handsome piece of it themselves in 2000, “one-point-something,” she recalled in an interview.

It seemed the end of a long struggle for Mr. Pigford and his

wife, who had seen their electricity cut off, their house foreclosed on, their furniture thrown out in the yard, and their crops destroyed by droughts and hurricanes.

Above all, he had triumphed over all the hostile white Agriculture Department officials in North Carolina who had told him for 25 years that he “didn’t have enough sense” to make it as a farmer, as he said to one interviewer in 1998, and had systematically denied him the loans he wanted to buy land.

But by the early 2010s, mostly what remained of the settlement was his name attached to the lawsuit. The settlement money was largely gone, siphoned away by back taxes, fines, and loans gone bad. He was jobless and driving a car with 382,000 miles on it. His wife’s schoolteacher salary had been garnished.

“We were worse off than when we filed the lawsuit,” Janice Pigford said in the interview, adding that they were still, at her husband’s death, in debt for about \$151,000. About the settlement, the IRS “never told us how much of it was taxable,” she said.

The decline in the Pigfords’ fortunes coincided with a tarnishing of the lawsuit’s legacy, as the money went out and fraud claims surrounding the suit’s thousands of claimants piled up.

A 2013 New York Times investigation found, among other aspects, that in 16 ZIP codes in Alabama, Arkansas, Mississippi, and North Carolina, “the number of successful claimants exceeded the total number of farms operated by people of any race in 1997, the year the lawsuit was filed.”

In Little Rock, the Times investigation found, “10 members of one extended family collected a total of \$500,000.”

There were other abuses and, for years, critics, and not

just on the right, have faulted the government for its haste and sloppiness. Settlement negotiations in Pigford v. Glickman began a mere five months after the suit was filed, and little documentation for the discrimination claims was either available or produced.

The government agreed to settle after less than two years and, by 1999, it had paid more than \$1 billion on nearly 16,000 claims, topped by another \$1.25 billion in 2010 and 2011 for farmers who had filed claims too late the first time.

And yet Mr. Pigford’s stubbornness and his insistence — along with several other plaintiffs — that the agriculture agency be held accountable for its history of racism and discrimination transcend the fraud findings, Bennett, the historian, suggested.

“His greatest legacy,” he wrote in an email, “was taking on an entrenched bureaucracy that refused to acknowledge its long history of denying Black farmers the same benefits it extended to white farmers.”

Other historians who specialize in the history of Black agriculture said they agree. “Mr. Pigford’s legacy is one of fighting for the USDA to treat Black farmers equally, at great sacrifice to him and his family,” Adrienne Petty, a professor at the College of William and Mary, wrote in an email.

Timothy Charles Pigford was born in Willard, N.C., on Nov. 15, 1951, the son of Timothy Wright Pigford, a longshoreman, and May (Newkirk) Pigford. He was 4 when his father died and was raised on his grandfather’s farm, where he was farming by the time he was 8.

In 1969, the year he graduated from Penderlea High School, his wife said, he was president of the Future Farmers of America chapter (now National FFA Organization). He

attended the University of North Carolina Wilmington but did not graduate until coming back for his degree in 2013.

He began working at a local chemical plant and rented 25 acres to farm. In 1973, he began a long series of confrontations with the Farmers Home Administration, the Agriculture Department’s now-defunct local agency.

He had asked for a loan of \$47,000 to buy 100 acres of farmland but was turned down when he couldn’t come up with a required 10 percent downpayment, according to the 2021 book “Just Harvest: The Story of How Black Farmers Won the Largest Civil Rights Case Against the U.S. Government,” by Greg Francis.

For several years, Mr. Pigford was able to obtain loans to rent land but never to buy it, according to Francis. In 1976, tired of being a tenant, Mr. Pigford again asked Farmers Home for a loan of \$110,000 to buy 170 acres. “I had my heart set on buying that farm,” he later told the magazine Business North Carolina. He was turned down.

In September 1984, Mr. Pigford, who had increasingly become a steadfast advocate for North Carolina’s Black farmers, described to a congressional subcommittee on civil and constitutional rights the plight of Black farmers and their lack of access to credit.

“President Lincoln gave to Blacks after the Civil War 40 acres and a mule,” Mr. Pigford told the congressmen, “and at the present rate that Blacks are losing land today, we have lost the mule and almost lost the 40 acres.”

After his testimony, “all hell broke loose,” his wife recalled, and the county supervisor in Bladen County told him he wouldn’t get another loan “unless Jesse Helms himself,” the powerful senior senator from



PIGFORD FAMILY VIA NEW YORK TIMES

Mr. Pigford with the sign he carried during marches in D.C.

North Carolina, requested it. He filed his first discrimination complaint with the Agriculture Department shortly after.

Serious problems for the Pigford household ensued — indebtedness, foreclosure, eviction, dispossession.

By the 1990s, Mr. Pigford was well acquainted with the staff of Representative Charlie Rose of North Carolina; one staffer connected him with a growing band of lawyers and Black farmer activists.

The atmosphere was ripe: In December 1996, Black farmers demonstrated outside the White House demanding equal treatment. In response, Glickman established what he called

a “civil rights action team” to listen to complaints across the country in the new year. There were marches in Washington, Atlanta, and elsewhere.

The allegations of discrimination that echoed forth were all familiar to Mr. Pigford, who soon lent his name to the lawsuit.

In addition to his wife, he leaves two sons, Timothy Jr. and Cornelius.

For MR. Pigford, the lawsuit was never just about his own struggle, Janice Pigford said.

“He had found out about all the other, similar stories,” she said. “It was injustice. He didn’t want other people to suffer what we had went through.”

Patricio Guzmán, filmmaker whose trilogies documented Chile’s struggles; at 85

By Clay Risen
NEW YORK TIMES

Patricio Guzmán, a Chilean documentarian whose two trilogies about his home country — the first about the events surrounding the 1973 Pinochet coup, the second about the nation’s struggles with the memory of the regime that followed — earned him a place among the highest ranks of Latin American filmmakers, died on Sept. 15 in Paris. He was 85.

His daughter, Andrea Guzmán Urzúa, announced the death, at a hospital, on social media. He had lived in Paris for more than three decades.

After studying filmmaking in Madrid, Mr. Guzmán returned to Chile in 1971, soon after the Marxist government of Salvador Allende took power. It was an exciting time, full of promises of progress for the country’s working class but also tensions with the professional and wealthy tranches of Chilean society.

His first film, “The First Year” (“El Primer Año,” 1972), about the early days of the Allende administration, attracted the attention of Chris Marker, the experimental French filmmaker. Marker met Mr. Guzmán in Santiago, the Chilean capital, and helped him get the film screened in Europe.

Following a tumultuous parliamentary election in 1973, in which Allende’s party came from behind to improve its standing in the National Assembly, the country’s military leaders instigated a coup, led by General Augusto Pinochet and supported by the United States.

Mr. Guzmán had been working on a film about the election, so he was ready when tanks and bombers attacked Santiago. He recalled the advice that Marker had given him: “When you want to film a fire, you must be ready at the place where the first flame will appear.”



PHOTOS COURTESY OF ICARUS FILMS

precautions. A friend who had secreted Mr. Guzmán’s reels in a hidden compartment of a car took them to the Swedish Embassy, which sent them out of the country in a diplomatic pouch.

After winning his freedom, Mr. Guzmán fled to Cuba, where he was reunited with his reels and could edit his film.

The result was “The Battle of Chile,” a three-part masterpiece of documentary filmmaking: “The Insurrection of the Bourgeoisie” (1975), “The Coup d’État” (1976), and “Popular Power” (1979).

Methodically paced, the films lay out Mr. Guzmán’s contention that the Pinochet coup was at its core a counterrevolution against Chilean workers by the country’s professional and middle classes.

The scenes from the coup, in which tanks open fire on Santiago streets and bombs fall on residential buildings, are some of the most horrifyingly violent footage ever caught on film.

In one instance, a cameraperson on Mr. Guzmán’s crew, Leonardo Henrichsen, is shot and killed while his camera is rolling, a shocking event that Mr. Guzmán insisted on including in the film.

“It’s not enough for ‘The Battle of Chile’ to run for a couple of weekends at the Film Forum,” Pauline Kael wrote in The New Yorker in 1978. “It needs to be

seen on public television, with those government officials who formed our policy toward Allende explaining what interests they believed they were furthering.”

The trilogy established Mr. Guzmán as a leading Latin American documentarian and a strong voice against the violently repressive Pinochet regime. The magazine Cineaste later called the trilogy one of the 10 best political films ever made.

But his films also meant that Mr. Guzmán could not return home. He lived in Spain and then France, and began to visit Chile only two years after the end of Pinochet’s rule in 1990.

When he did, he found a country at odds with itself over the legacy and memory of the dictatorship. Who was to blame? Who had collaborated? Who had resisted? And what did it mean for someone like Mr. Guzmán to return — could he still love his birthplace?

He grappled with these questions in another powerful trilogy, released in the 2010s: “Nostalgia for the Light” (“Nostalgia de la Luz,” 2010), “The Pearl Button” (“El Botón de Nácar,” 2015) and “The Cordillera of Dreams” (“La Cordillera de los Sueños,” 2019).

The films are impressionistic and personal, in stark contrast to the blunt realism of his early work, though he insisted that there was a continuity through



KINO LORBER

all of his projects.

“Politics is always present in everything, not only in my movies,” Mr. Guzmán said in a 2011 interview with Documentary Magazine. “It’s an element like the atmosphere, like poetry. Poetry is always present everywhere.”

Patricio Guzmán Lozanes was born Aug. 11, 1941, in Santiago and grew up there and in Viña del Mar, a city on Chile’s central coast. His father was an architect.

He studied theater, history, and philosophy at the University of Chile, in Santiago, but left before graduating for financial reasons.

While working at an advertising agency, he started making

amateur films. After one caught the attention of a Chilean director, Rafael Sánchez, Mr. Guzmán was invited to study at the Film Institute at the Pontifical Catholic University in Santiago.

In 1966, he traveled to Spain to study film at the Complutense University of Madrid, and received his diploma from its school of cinematography in 1970.

Mr. Guzmán’s first marriage ended in divorce. Along with his daughter, with whom he collaborated on his later films, he leaves his wife, Renate Sachse, who worked with him as a producer.

Mr. Guzmán made several films while living in Spain and

France, and he became a regular awardee at European film festivals. In 2019, “The Cordillera of Dreams” shared the Golden Eye prize for best documentary at the Cannes Film Festival (with the Syrian film “For Sama”).

He never returned to live in Chile, but all of his later films focused on his homeland, including his final work, “My Imaginary Country” (“Mi País Imaginario,” 2022), about the popular uprising in Chile in 1919.

“I believe that there will be another revolution, but it will take a long time,” he told Film Comment in 2023. “There are a lot of young people in Chile with good hearts. They are prepared and they are the most enthusiastic. But they are young.”

Footage from “The Battle of Chile” (above) shows socialist leader Salvador Allende making a speech and army arrests during the Pinochet coup. Mr. Guzmán (left, undated) could not return home after the films’ release.

LivingArts

By Matt Juul
GLOBE STAFF

From Richard Hatch to “Boston Rob” Mariano, New England contestants have performed pretty well on “Survivor” over the years. Now, a new set of locals will vie for the \$1 million prize when the long-running CBS reality series returns for its 51st season on Wednesday night.

Among the 21 castaways absconding to the beaches of Fiji is a trio of New Englanders with Ocean State ties, including Rob Antonson, a 40-year-old airline gate agent who works at Logan Airport. Originally from Johnston, R.I., but currently residing in Cumberland, R.I., Antonson is also a podcaster who wears his love for Boston sports on his sleeve — literally.

“Over here, I got the Green Monster. Here, I got the Bruins, Red Sox, Celtics, and Pats, all the logos,” Antonson told the Globe during a recent Zoom interview while showing off the Boston sports tattoos on his arms. “That was fun on ‘Survivor.’ They loved having the trademark logos all over my body.”

Here’s what Antonson had to say about his “Survivor” experience, representing New England on the show, and more.

Q. You’re a big reality TV guy, but what inspired you to try out for “Survivor”?

A. I’m a huge reality TV junkie. I’ve been watching shows like MTV’s “The Challenge” since its first season. I don’t know if that’s something to be proud of, but I even watch the “Housewives.” I just like seeing people’s lives on camera, you know? I was an OG “Survivor” guy watching the first season, Richard Hatch from Rhode Island running around naked. I always wanted to go on “Survivor,” one of the “Big Brother” kind of the reality shows. In my early 20s, I put in for “Survivor,” I think “Big Brother” too. I didn’t get it, and I was like 21, 22 years old. I was cocky. I was a kid that burned bridges with everybody and all my jobs. It’s probably not the time.

So I had three kids. I’m 40 years old now. I said, “Hey, let me just put in for it. Let me just see what happens,” and then I started moving through the process, and I got on. It’s always been a dream of mine.

Q. What was it like meeting host Jeff

‘It’s like hitting the lottery’: R.I. castaway talks representing New England on new season of ‘Survivor’



ROBERT VOETS/CBS

Rob Antonson (foreground), a Johnston, R.I., native who now resides in Cumberland, R.I., competes on the latest season of “Survivor.”

Probst?

A. Always been a big fan of Jeff. He’s an icon. I graduated college with a

broadcast journalism degree, so I always wanted to be a host on TV or a host anywhere. Seeing Jeff just grow-

ing up, and then seeing the guy in person ... it’s mind blowing. The guy’s a legend. He’s got like the greatest job

in the world. He gets to go to whatever, Fiji, and just hang out and do a show for his life. It’s great. Jeff’s awesome.

Q. Do you feel like living in New England and working at Logan helped prepare you a bit for this experience?

A. The big New England part of us is we’re go go go. The West Coast is kind of laid back. I see it all the time at the airport. They’re more chill, and the people from JFK or Boston are like, “All right, let’s go, we gotta go.” So I think that prepares you big time for a game like “Survivor” because “Survivor” just changes all the time. One episode or one day is different from the next. That’s just like the airport life, and that’s also how it is on the East Coast. You got to just go with everything.

Q. As a big Boston sports guy, what survival advice do you have for the Red Sox to make it through the playoffs?

A. Listen, [Garrett] Crochet’s got to be able to pitch at least six innings. [Payton] Tolle’s a beast. Tolle should be pitching every damn game. He’s unbelievable.

Q. What about Drake Maye, how are you feeling about him this year?

A. I was at the Seattle game, so when he threw that pick at the end, I ran out so quick with my cousin because I felt like they were all gonna just rag on me for wearing Patriot jerseys. But he’s gonna be fine. Everything’s gonna work out. Pats will be in the playoffs. Pats Super Bowl against the Rams. Get ready.

Q. What else do you want folks to know about your “Survivor” experience?

A. I see that tons of people have been putting in for this show for years, and I just [want to say] don’t give up. If you want to be on the show, just keep putting in for it. I’m 40 years old. I put in for it what, 20 years later, and I got on. You just don’t know. Even if you have kids or if you’re going through a tough time in life, just put it out there.

Being on this show is just a great experience, I feel like for me or for anyone. It’s like hitting the lottery.

“Survivor” premieres Wednesday at 8 p.m. on CBS.

Interview was edited and condensed. Matt Juul can be reached at matthew.juul@globe.com.

BSO opening night: portrait of an orchestra on fire



HILARY SCOTT/BSO

Andris Nelsons led the Boston Symphony Orchestra in an opening night concert of music by Arturs Maskats, Elgar, and Brahms.

By A.Z. Madonna
GLOBE STAFF

Opening nights tend to go hand in hand with speeches, and the Boston Symphony Orchestra’s opening night was no exception.

After the orchestra entered the Symphony Hall stage en masse, there was Boston Mayor Michelle Wu, who has played the piano on that very stage with both the orchestra and its opening night soloist, cellist Yo-Yo Ma. Then there was Chad Smith, the orchestra’s embattled president and CEO, reading from prepared remarks and thanking a list of cultural leaders and BSO affiliates, including board chair Barbara Hostetter, whom he called “the model of integrity, compassion, and strength.”

Finally, there was BSO music director Andris Nelsons, stumbling through a seemingly impromptu explanation of why many of the BSO musicians are still wearing red flowers with their tuxes and concert blacks. “It’s a sign of love,” he said. “If you give a rose to someone, it’s a sign of adoration, love, respect. We love you, our wonderful community. I love this orchestra from the bottom of my heart.”

Whether those remarks were intended to be inspiring or inciting will depend on who you ask. Either way, there was fire under them, and the BSO right now is already an orchestra on fire, in many senses of the word. Fire can renew and energize; it can also harm and destroy, and the opening night concert of music by Arturs Maskats, Elgar, and Brahms was a sonic testament to the volatile atmosphere that continues to heat Symphony Hall.

MUSIC REVIEW

BOSTON SYMPHONY ORCHESTRA
At Symphony Hall Sept. 17. 617-266-1200, www.bso.org

Maskats, a friend of Nelsons’s from their shared homeland of Latvia, was present — and sporting a rose on his lapel — for the BSO’s third-ever performance of his “Tango.” According to the program notes, the composer wanted to do for tango what Ravel did for the Viennese waltz in “La Valse.” Though it hardly has the sweep or the biting social commentary of the Ravel, it was a fine listen nonetheless. The lushly textured piece balanced thrumming and swirling orchestral passages with exquisitely contoured and frustratingly brief solos from Julien Labro on bandoneon, a box-shaped relative of the concertina and the signature instrument of tango music.

Yo-Yo Ma has performed Elgar’s Cello Concerto with the BSO at least once every decade since the 1980s, and when you play a piece that many times, you either settle into an invariable trajectory or knowingly become unpredictable. Ma plus Elgar equals the latter. Fortunately, Nelsons and the BSO know their way around a mercurial soloist, and Ma has performed with the BSO enough times that the players know most of his tricks. During the first movement, Ma sounded pale and diluted, and the sound was at odds with the throes of agony and ecstasy that his countenance conveyed. The

following three movements, from the pixieish whimsy of the Allegro molto to the striding finale, featured Ma at his best. Nelsons was keyed into the cellist’s caprices in the finale, and Ma in turn locked eyes with the orchestra’s cellists, grinning at them as they took hold of the striding melody.

Someone handed Ma a bouquet of flowers (of various colors) during the standing ovation, and he immediately passed it to one of the orchestra’s section violinists. A few rounds of applause later, he took a seat in the back of the cello section for a cello-ensemble arrangement of “The Song of the Birds,” a Catalan Christmas song that was a calling-card piece of the great Casals, albeit as a solo. The BSO cellists gamely but stiffly traded off the melody.

The BSO last played Brahms’s Symphony No. 4 not too long ago. To be precise, it was this past March for three concerts under the baton of Herbert Blomstedt. Minutes after the players finished the Friday afternoon performance of that program, they learned, along with the rest of the world, that Nelsons’s contract would be ending. I won’t go so far as to say that playing the same piece again now, on Nelsons’s final opening night, had some kind of effect on the musicians — but the symphony, already melancholy on the page, rang with the raw pain of an open wound. Subtlety crumbled under the force of passion. Entrances were big and messy, ragged around the edges. In the past, the BSO playing sloppily has almost always correlated with a performance that sounded phoned in; this was absolutely not phoned in, but it wasn’t the quality the BSO is capable of, either. Still my eyes stung. Even raw and scorched, Brahms’s 4th packs an emotional wallop.

How to manage this fire so it drives the orchestra rather than destroys it? Maybe a less-charged environment at Symphony Hall, but that’s easier said than done. Even with the musicians’ new contract in place, trust is unsurprisingly in tatters between many musicians and management, not to mention how the audience has been drawn into the conflict, willingly or not. Only time and dedicated effort will repair it.

However, the last thing it needs is someone to blame, whether you’re thinking of someone sitting in an executive chair or someone who tried to hand you a red flower before the concert. But for many, I fear someone to blame will be the easiest thing to find.

A.Z. Madonna can be reached at az.madonna@globe.com. Follow her @knitandlisten.



HERITAGE AUCTIONS

A model of the Starship Enterprise, known by Trekkies as the “3-footer” or “pilot model,” will be exhibited at the MIT Museum Sept. 30-March 28.

To boldly go ... on display at the MIT Museum

By Mark Feeney
GLOBE STAFF

Trekkies know it as the “3-footer” or “pilot model.” To the rest of us, it’s the 33-inch original of the Starship Enterprise. It’s what viewers saw whooshing through outer space during the opening title sequence for each episode of “Star Trek” during the series’ three seasons on NBC (1966-69).

The model will be exhibited at the MIT Museum Sept. 30-March 28, with its unveiling helping kick off the MIT Future Fest festival, which runs through Oct. 4.

“We are thrilled to have the opportunity to show this unique model,” MIT Museum director Michael John Gorman said in a statement. The model, Gorman said, “is not merely a prop; it’s a time capsule of human aspiration.”

Prop or time capsule, the model is striking in appearance. The spacecraft’s distinctive and beautiful shape is at once massive and refined. Up front, there’s the swooping curve of the main hull of the Enterprise. In the middle, there’s the cigar-shaped secondary hull. Bringing up the rear are the ship’s pair of engines, their cylindrical shape

secured at an angle that all but dares Captain Kirk to ask Scotty for warp speed.

Working off of designs from “Star Trek” production designer Matt Jefferies, model maker Richard C. Datin Jr. created a three-dimensional rendering of the spacecraft in 1964. “Star Trek” creator Gene Roddenberry kept the model on his desk for many years. He loaned it to Paramount Pictures during the production of “Star Trek: The Motion Picture” (1979). It disappeared — only to turn up 45 years later, in an eBay listing.

In 1976, Roddenberry gave a talk at MIT’s Kresge Auditorium, thanking the MIT community for its support when NBC first tried to cancel the series. On Oct. 3, his son, Eugene “Rod” Roddenberry Jr., will participate in a Future Fest panel on “The Next 250 Years.”

“We can’t think of a more fitting place for the restored model’s East Coast debut than the MIT Museum,” Rod Roddenberry said in a statement, “on a campus dedicated to exploring the frontiers of human possibility.”

Mark Feeney can be reached at mark.feeney@globe.com.

Underfished for decades, flounder gets a new PR campaign

By Celina Colby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

One of northern New England's most plentiful fish is getting a PR boost. In response to years of low flounder sales, and low profits for fishermen pulling in this flatfish (flounder belongs to a broad category of flat-bodied, ocean bottom-dwelling fish), the Massachusetts Division of Marine Fisheries launched a promotional campaign to get Bostonians craving delicate, flaky flounder again.

The campaign, called "Flat Is Back," includes the formation of the Massachusetts Flounder Chef Council and brings together 10 chefs from around the state to create flounder dishes for their menus. The chefs' highly personal takes, available at their restaurants through Sept. 30, showcase unique preparations and flavor combinations that demonstrate flounder's versatility and appeal.

Massachusetts fishermen have been lodging complaints about the poor economics of flounder for the last decade, says Dan McKiernan, director of DMF. The National Marine Fisheries Service, an office of the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration that works to protect ocean life and marine habitats, mandates quotas for certain species to ensure that they aren't overfished and to

FLOUNDER, Page G5

Inside

GETTING SALTY

"RESTAURANTS EMBODY THE AMERICAN DREAM"

Restaurateur Seth Gerber dishes on the hospitality industry.

G3



THE CONFIDENT COOK
APPLE PANCAKE, À LA FRANÇAIS

A quick batter plus shingled apples equals an easy, elegant dessert.

G5

WHAT SHE'S HAVING

Stuffed vegetables make a delicious, budget-friendly meal

By Sheryl Julian
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

MANCHESTER, Vt. — In her backyard garden, Nancy Diaferio grows green squash, a variety called kousa that's paler and less watery than zucchini. She stuffs it with a mixture of hot sausage and rice, sprinkles it with cheese, and bakes it in a pool of marinara that she keeps on hand for this and other dishes she's cooking.

Diaferio, who owned Al Ducci's Italian Pantry in Manchester with Al Schepps for 25 years, is preparing a dish her Italian American mother made, she says, "as a special treat for her family in the summer."

The technique of stuffing vegetables is old, though it doesn't seem to have been a feature of ancient cuisines. It's likely an innovation from cooks at the medieval Ottoman court in Constantinople (today's Istanbul). Tomatoes, peppers, and squashes — all especially well-suited to stuffing — are New World ingredients, so they wouldn't have been available to cooks before early explorers brought them to Europe in the 16th century.

Other dishes from that era do resemble stuffed vegetables. Rolled-up cabbage leaves with meat

WHAT SHE'S HAVING, Page G2

THIS FALL'S



PHOTO ILLUSTRATION BY LUIS G. RENDON/GLOBE STAFF; PHOTOS: STAN GROSSELD/GLOBE STAFF, VIRGINIA NASH AND JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE, GLAIA PAVLOUNI

NEW RESTAURANTS

10 additions that will help write the next chapter in Boston's dining scene.

By Devra First
GLOBE STAFF

This season, there are plenty of new restaurants on the scene (or soon to be): Kimbap specialist **Bap Street** and **Namu Distilling Company**, which serves drinking food and cocktails made with its own soju and gin, both illustrate the blossoming Korean culinary scene. **Ci Siamo**, coming in late fall, brings us more Italian food, and more from Danny Meyer's New York-based Union Square Hospitality Group, also behind bakery-cafe Daily Provisions. In Nubian Square, the long-awaited **Jazz Urbane Cafe** showcases live performances alongside a jazzy menu from chef Guara Pimenta.

Viewed collectively, a season's openings offer a snapshot of the local dining scene. Here are 10 more enticing new restaurants that also tell us something about where we are as a city that loves to eat out — and where we might be heading.

AGOSTO

Chef George Mendes (pictured) celebrated his Portuguese culinary heritage at New York's Michelin-starred Aldea, which closed in 2020. When he came to Boston three years later, he picked up the thread at Amar at the Raffles hotel. His new project, Agosto in the South End, offers a more holistic vision, reflecting all of his life's influences. "My Portuguese heritage is still fundamental to who I am and how I cook, but it's so deeply embedded, I don't need any dish to announce it," he says. For Agosto, slated to open in November, he will draw as much from his time working with mentor David Bouley, and at restaurants such as Arpège in France and El Bulli in Spain. But his main inspiration may be where he is right now: New England. Tasting menus (starting at five courses for \$150) are at the heart of the experience, driven by seasonal ingredients and Mendes's relationships with local fishermen,



JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

farmers, and producers. There will also be a la carte options. Agosto is so personal, it is named after both the month he and wife/business partner Suzanne met and their son; an adjacent bakery-cafe, to follow early next year, will be called Little Sister, a family nickname for their daughter.

1673 Washington St., South End, Boston, www.agostoboston.com

FALL PREVIEW, Page G4

To my former favorite restaurant: I think we should see other people.

By Kara Baskin
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Dear Restaurant,
I'm not sure how to say this, so I'll just be honest: We can't keep seeing each other. I don't see a future here. I can't continue to pretend like nothing is wrong, even though that's the path of least resistance.
I really did love you once, but the magic is gone. I've stayed in dead-end relationships long enough to know when to walk away, and it's time.
Oh, I tried to fake it for a while. I kept returning to you — out of habit, inertia, nostalgia, who knows — but I'm realizing that lying to myself isn't doing either of us any favors. Sticking around only hurts both of us.
This breakup is a positive thing, really: We can go our separate ways and each be happier. My leaving will make room for new customers who will appreciate you. You deserve people who love you for who you are, who don't wish that you'd change. And I deserve to spend money someplace where I won't walk away feeling disappointed, resentful, or

BREAKUP, Page G5



LUIS G. RENDON/GLOBE STAFF; ADOBE

Cheese bread won his heart; it might win yours, too

Pão de queijo, Brazil’s cheese bread, is particularly beloved in the southeastern state of Minas Gerais. It’s where both queijo Minas, the region’s mild cow’s milk cheese, and the stretchy, nutty-rich bread itself originate.

It’s also where Heli Silva was born, and the bread is how his wife, Kelly Unda, captured his heart. Not long after they started dating, Unda surprised Silva by teaching herself to make the palm-size cheese rolls that he grew up eating.

The couple, with combined decades in the food and beverage industry, fiddled with the recipe until they nailed the formula and launched Galley Provisions. Now they work out of Commonwealth Kitchen in Dorchester, producing roughly 500 bags of cheese bread each week.

Instead of using traditional Minas cheese, the couple settled on a mix of Parmigiano Reggiano and Vermont cheddar. But similar to authentic pão de queijo, they use fermented (also referred to as sour) cassava starch, which makes their product naturally gluten-free. The unbaked rolls are sold frozen so you can bake them whenever you want.

“It’s bread that was made to be eaten fresh out of the oven,” says Heli.

Bake time is about 16 minutes in a hot oven or a little less in an air-fryer. (Bags are 17.6 ounces, about 20-24 rolls, for \$16.) In Brazil, he says, it’s very common to eat cheese bread with your morning coffee as well as at the dinner table.

“They work great for sliders too,” adds Kelly.

Available at Tilly & Salvy’s Bacon Street Farm, 100 Bacon St., Natick, 508-653-4851; Sweet Teez Bakery, 1211 Dorchester Ave. (Suite #1), Boston, 617-299-3090;



Art’s Specialties, 369 Trapelo Road, Belmont, 617-484-0435; and area farmers markets, including Arlington, Brighton, Boston SoWa Market, Framingham, Hingham, Natick, and Watertown. Check their schedule at www.galley-provisions.com.

LISA ZWIRN

Next-level nut butters from Nutchio



NUTCHIO

Peanut and almond butters are supermarket staples, but spreads made with pistachios, walnuts, hazelnuts, and pecans can be harder to come by.

Sahar Shady and Ehab Morad know this firsthand. After searching unsuccessfully for the kind of rich, roasty nut butters they grew up eating in Egypt, the young couple started making their own. Their weekend passion project quickly evolved into a business they named Nutchio.

“We saw a gap in the market,” says Morad, a former marketing director for coffee shops in Egypt.

These days, they operate out of Dorchester’s Commonwealth Kitchen, where they churn out a collection of creamy nut butters made from nut varieties that are overlooked by most commercial brands. Pistachio (their favorite), walnut, hazelnut, and pecan butters are available as 100 percent ground nuts and also as lightly sweetened spreads flavored with

warm spices, cacao, or vanilla.

Pistachio tastes earthy and mildly sweet; walnut, dark and woody with a pleasant bitter edge. Spread them on toast, swirl them into yogurt or smoothies, swipe them up with apple slices, or eat them straight from a spoon. Spread the pistachio or pecan butter with fruit preserves, and the classic PB&J becomes something new.

Nutchio also makes tahini and halva, the latter cutting the bitter edge of the sesame seeds with powdered sugar and Himalayan pink salt. Each jar is stamped with the date it was made so you know it’s fresh. Eight-ounce jars are \$14.99 to \$20.

Available at Curio Spice Co. at Boston Public Market, 100 Hanover St., Boston; The Wine & Cheese Cask, 407 Washington St., Somerville, 617-623-8656; Christina’s Spice & Specialty Foods, 1297 Cambridge St., Cambridge, 617-576-2090, and at nutchio.com.

ANN TRIEGER KURLAND

Art imitates farm life at this New Bedford exhibition



NEW BEDFORD ART MUSEUM

A cow gazing with dreamy eyes painted in monochromatic tones. A mixed-media sculpture fashioned with the help of honey bees. A single rake draped in white linen, evoking the spirit of Regionalist painter Grant Wood’s “American Gothic.”

These are just a few of the treasures on display at agriCultural: A Biennial Exhibition, now on view at the New Bedford Art Museum until Nov. 29. Organized by the Southeastern Massachusetts Agricultural Partnership, this juried show brings together voices from artists who farm, farmers who are also artists, and artists who take inspiration from agriculture.

“Instead of just publishing where to buy local food, we wanted to use arts and culture to tell a story so people will look at agriculture in a deeper way,” says museum executive director Suzanne de Vegh.

The South Coast of Massachusetts has deep roots in both agriculture and art. Wampanoag farmers cultivated the land for thousands of years, passing their know-how to Colonial settlers, while money from the whaling industry later helped fuel a thriving art scene.

For the exhibit, SEMAP and the art museum put out a call to artists to submit their work, says Brad Fesmire, SEMAP’s community engagement and program director. More than two dozen works were se-

lected that in some way relayed a complex or untold story, including Susan Medyn’s sculpture, “Shared Architecture.” The Rhode Island–based watercolorist and master beekeeper incorporates caning and embroidery materials into her hives, allowing the bees to transform them and reveal their own ingenuity.

Dartmouth artist JP Powell’s “Panic Grasses” creates the illusion of marsh grasses moving in the breeze. And in “Rake 1,” sculptor and photographer Stephen Althouse, who grew up on a Pennsylvania farm, turned his lens on the familiar farm tool, inviting many interpretations.

“More often than not, this farmer who also makes art has a lot more to say about farming and the world than just growing a tomato,” says Fesmire. “Not that there’s anything wrong with only growing tomatoes.”

New Bedford Art Museum, 608 Pleasant St., New Bedford, 508- 961-3072. Open Thu.-Sun., 9 a.m.-5 p.m.

ANN TRIEGER KURLAND

Budget-friendly stuffed veggies

►WHAT SHE’S HAVING

Continued from Page G1

and rice is one. In fact, dolma, the name used for this technique and dishes made with it, can refer, in Turkish, to anything stuffed (including grape leaves).

“We Turks have had a love affair with dolma (stuffed vegetables) for centuries,” writes Ozlem Warren in her new book “Istanbul: Delicious Recipes from the Heart of the City.” “The Ottomans used a variety of vegetables, as well as fruit such as apples and melons, to make dolma,” she continues, “stuffing them with meat, rice, dried fruit, and nuts.

Warren packs small peppers with ground beef or lamb mixed with rice, red pepper paste, and a lot of parsley. She mixes tomato paste, olive oil, and boiling water into a sauce that surrounds the peppers while they simmer on a burner for an hour.

She uses a similar recipe for tomatoes. For both, after cutting the tops off the vegetables, she replaces them, like caps, before baking. They’re served with thick plain yogurt.

Another popular candidate for this treatment is eggplant, an Old World workhorse vegetable in the Middle East, North Africa, and Far East. Early eggplants were probably more like current Japanese varieties, rather than the big purple Globe varieties in our markets.

Eggplant filled with walnuts, pomegranate, and feta with fresh mint and cilantro looks inviting on the cover of “Sabzi: Vibrant Vegetarian Recipes,” by London-based Yasmin Khan. Her recipe includes pomegranate molasses, an intense elixir that enlivens any dish, and the

citrusy Persian spice golpar.

Diaferio makes and sells fruit preserves under the label Legit Jams (in flavors such as Feisty White Peach and Lemon Basil Jelly) at pop-up markets in Manchester. She learned to cook from her mother, Irene, who came as a teenager to Flushing, Queens, from Puglia, the heel of Italy’s boot.

It’s hard to find the kousa for Diaferio’s recipe, so I substituted zucchini, salting them and leaving them for about half an hour to release some of their moisture, as she instructed.

After you scrape the flesh and seeds from the zucchini to make shells, chop it and add it to browned hot sausage crumbles in a skillet. Stir in any white rice (short or long-grain) and simmer the mixture until the rice is partially cooked through.

Then add cheese and basil and when it cools, spoon it into the zucchini shells. Ladle marinara sauce around the zucchini and top with shredded mozzarella before sending it into the oven.

This delicious, economical dish is labor-intensive. When she was a girl in Istanbul and it was time to stuff vegetables, writes the Turkish author Warren, “whoever was around would join in, some preparing the filling, others the vegetables, whilst us kids waited excitedly in the kitchen for the dolma to be ready.”

It’s a ritual from Warren’s childhood that she holds dear, as it is for Diaferio, whose mother lived in another country at another time and made the same dish.

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SHERYL JULIAN FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Sausage-Stuffed Zucchini with Marinara Sauce

Serves 4

In Manchester, Vt., Nancy Diaferio stuffs her own homegrown kousa, a green squash similar to zucchini, with sausage and rice and bakes the dish with marinara she makes and keeps on hand for other Italian American specialties. Diaferio, who owned Al Ducci’s Italian Pantry in Manchester with Al Scheps for 25 years, learned the dish from her mother, Irene, who made it, says Diaferio, “as a special treat for her family in the summer.” Stuffed vegetables are labor-intensive, but you can stretch one pound of ground pork to feed four generously. First hollow the zucchini halves (use kousa if you can find it at a farm stand), then chop the flesh. Diaferio salts the vegetable shells to release some of the excess moisture. She browns hot Italian sausage, mixes it with rice and the flesh from the zucchini, and simmers the mixture until the rice is partially cooked. Let it cool, stir in cheese, and fill the zucchini shells. Pour marinara around the dish and bake. It’s hearty and economical and a perfectly wonderful dish.

4 medium zucchini
Salt, to taste
1 tablespoon olive oil

- 1 pound loose hot Italian pork sausage (removed from casings, if needed)**
 - 1 medium onion, finely chopped**
 - 1 clove garlic, finely chopped**
 - ¼ cup white wine or chicken stock**
 - ¼ cup short-grain or long-grain white rice**
 - 1½ cups marinara sauce**
 - ½ cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese**
 - 1 cup shredded mozzarella (½ cup for filling, ½ cup for topping)**
 - 2 tablespoons chopped fresh basil**
 - Extra chopped basil (for sprinkling)**
1. Line a rimmed sheet pan with parchment paper. Have on hand a 9-by-13-inch baking dish.
2. Halve the zucchini lengthwise. Use the tip of a knife to make a small cut inside the zucchini all around to within ¼ inch of the edge. With a small spoon scoop out the flesh and seeds (reserve them). Sprinkle the cut sides with salt. Set the shells cut sides down on the sheet pan. Set aside while you prepare the filling.
3. Chop the zucchini flesh and seeds coarsely.
4. In a skillet over medium heat, heat the olive oil. Add the onion and sausage and cook, breaking up the sausage with the side of a kitchen spoon, for 6 to 8 minutes, or until the sausage browns and the onion softens. Add the garlic and cook, stirring, 1 minute more.
5. Add the zucchini flesh to the pan. Stir well.

- Continue cooking, stirring, for 2 minutes.
6. Add the wine or stock to the pan with the rice. Bring to a boil, lower the heat, and simmer for 10 minutes, or until the rice is partially cooked (it will cook more later). Stir in 2 tablespoons of the marinara sauce. Let the mixture cool.
7. Set the oven at 350 degrees.
8. Use paper towels to pat the zucchini shells dry. Ladle half the remaining marinara in the baking dish. Set the zucchini in the dish, alternating stem ends to the left and stem ends to the right, so they fit tightly.
9. Stir the Parmesan and ½ cup of the shredded mozzarella into the filling. Add the basil.
10. Use a teaspoon to fill the shells, mounding the mixture in each shell so you pack in as much as possible. Spoon the remaining marinara over the filling. Sprinkle with the remaining ½ cup shredded mozzarella. (If there’s any leftover filling, bake it separately in a small dish.)
11. Cover the dish with foil, tenting it if necessary so the foil doesn’t touch the cheese. Bake for 35 minutes. Uncover and continue baking for 5 minutes. (Total baking time is 40 minutes.)
12. Serve two zucchini halves per person with sauce spooned around them.
- Sheryl Julian. Adapted from Nancy Diaferio*

SEASONAL RECIPES

WHAT TO COOK THIS WEEK



KAROLINE BOEHM GOODNICK FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Late-Season Vegetable Soup

Serves 4

We're officially in shoulder season, and this late-season vegetable soup filled with summer produce is an ideal dinner for warm days and cool nights. Add three varieties of tomato to the pot: tomato paste, grape or cherry tomatoes, and diced fresh tomatoes (ideally plucked from the backyard garden or a farm stand). To round out the other vegetables — carrot, celery, zucchini, summer squash, and kale or spinach — choose an extra small pasta shape that will fit neatly on the spoon after cooking. The Italian category for these is called *pastina* and includes stars, orzo, or miniature bow ties called *farfalline*. At the table, garnish with Parmesan and basil leaves.

- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 onion, coarsely chopped
- 1 large carrot, coarsely chopped
- 2 ribs celery, coarsely chopped
- Salt and pepper, to taste
- 2 cloves garlic, chopped
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste
- 1 tablespoon chopped fresh thyme
- 6 cherry tomatoes, halved
- 2 quarts vegetables or chicken stock
- 1 cup *pastina*, such as stars, orzo or *farfalline*
- 1 small zucchini, coarsely chopped

- 1 summer squash, coarsely chopped
- 2 tomatoes, cored, and coarsely chopped
- 2 large handfuls stemmed kale or spinach leaves, thinly sliced
- 1 cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese (for garnish)
- Handful fresh basil leaves, coarsely chopped (for garnish)

1. In a large Dutch oven or soup pot over medium heat, heat the olive oil. Add the onion, carrot, celery, and a generous pinch each of salt and pepper. Cook, stirring often, for 8 to 10 minutes, or until the onions are translucent.
2. Add the garlic, tomato paste, and thyme. Cook, stirring, for 3 to 4 minutes, or until the tomato paste is lightly browned and the garlic is aromatic.
3. Add the cherry tomatoes and stock. Bring to a boil. Add the *pastina*, zucchini, and summer squash. Return the liquid to a boil. Lower the heat and simmer for 5 minutes, or until the pasta just begins to soften.
4. Add the diced tomatoes and kale or spinach. Continue simmering for 2 to 5 minutes, or until the pasta is tender and the greens are wilted. Taste for seasoning and add more salt and pepper, if you like.
5. Ladle into bowls. Garnish with Parmesan and basil.

Karoline Boehm Goodnick



SALLY PASLEY VARGAS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Sheet Pan Chicken Thighs with Lemon and Orzo

Serves 4

Sheet pan suppers are a busy cook's answer to the 6 o'clock scramble. Spread shallots, canned artichoke hearts, olives, and chickpeas on a baking sheet. Set chicken thighs painted with lemon, oregano, and olive oil on top. While the chicken roasts, the vegetables soak up all the poultry juices and lemon flavors. Meanwhile, cook orzo and frozen peas on top of the stove, then stir them into the sheet pan veggies and supper is done. Minimal effort, maximum results.

- Olive oil (for the pan)
- 8 skin-on, bone-in chicken thighs (about 3½ pounds)
- Salt and pepper, to taste
- Juice of 1 large lemon
- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- 3 large shallots, halved and thinly sliced
- 1 jar or can (15 ounces) artichoke hearts, drained
- ½ cup green or black olives, or a combination
- 1 can (15 ounces) chickpeas, drained
- ½ cup white wine or chicken stock
- 8 ounces orzo
- 1 cup frozen peas
- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh parsley
- 1 lemon, cut into wedges (for serving)

1. Set the oven at 425 degrees. Brush a large rimmed baking sheet with olive oil.
2. Pat the chicken dry with paper towels. Trim off any excess skin and fat with scissors. Sprinkle the chicken on both sides with salt and pepper.
3. In a small bowl, whisk the lemon juice, olive oil, and oregano.
4. Spread the shallots, artichokes, olives, and chickpeas on the baking sheet. Arrange the chicken thighs, skin side up, on the vegetables. Pour the wine or stock around the chicken. Spoon the lemon mixture on top of the chicken pieces.
5. Roast for 35 to 40 minutes, or until the chicken is browned and a meat thermometer inserted into the thickest part of a thigh registers 165 to 185 degrees. If chicken has not browned, slide it under the broiler for 1 to 2 minutes to crisp the skin.
6. Meanwhile, bring a large saucepan of salted water to a boil. Add the orzo and cook, stirring occasionally, for 6 minutes or according to package directions, or until it is tender. Stir the frozen peas into the saucepan. Remove the saucepan from the heat and drain the orzo and peas into a colander.
7. Remove the baking sheet from the oven. With tongs, transfer the chicken to a warm plate.
8. Stir the orzo and peas into the vegetables on the baking sheet. Spoon them onto a deep serving platter and top with the chicken thighs. Sprinkle with parsley and serve with lemon.

Sally Pasley Vargas

By Kara Baskin

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Lynn's Seth Gerber, 36, didn't love mainstream academics. When his Connecticut high school guidance counselor suggested that he parlay his wrestling talent to go to an elite college, he pushed back: He wanted to study hospitality instead.

Today, Gerber is an adjunct professor at his alma mater, Boston University School of Hospitality Administration, where he was recently named Distinguished Alumni of the Year. He co-owns MIDA locations in Boston and Newton, La Tavernetta by MIDA in East Boston, and The Babe in Salem.

You're teaching a class at BU that inspired you when you were starting out. Tell me about that.

I'm teaching food and beverage management, which has been a longstanding class offered at the undergraduate level — the basic fundamentals of how to operate a restaurant. It's a fun course. I think people take it because it piques their curiosity.

It's always funny to me trying to teach a restaurant class inside of a classroom rather than in a restaurant because it's something that's very tactile, that you really need to experience. I've moved the class into a format where you're basically building a restaurant in [the first] half of the semester, and then you're running your restaurant in the second half of the semester.

Who are the next generation of Boston hospitality professionals? Who's going to school for this?

Hospitality is a big industry. A lot of students look at hotels, they look at asset management, real estate, marketing, PR.

Some of them are interested in restaurants, and I try to really spark a curiosity, a passion for that, and feed that to them as an exciting career path. Restaurants have always been a wide open net, whether or not you studied hospitality or business. Anybody can get involved in restaurants. That's always been the case. I think that'll always continue to be the case.

At the same time, I do think that there's a big opportunity, especially the way that the industry is evolving, for people who have come through a more traditional academic pathway to apply those skills to the restaurant industry in a meaningful and beneficial way. I think being good operators and being able to speak the language of business as well as having that creative, independent spirit that restaurants have always embodied — marrying that with traditional business knowledge and fundamental understanding of how businesses operate is a very good thing for the industry.

How do you make a living doing it? Is it a viable career in a city like Boston that's so expensive?

Restaurants certainly aren't known as being extremely high-paying. But, if you're serving or bartending, you can make very good money in a high-end restaurant. If you're managing, you can certainly do very well.

There's often a difficulty where, to get to those positions, the starting point is more challenging, and you're often in a situation where you have to take on roommates or live a little farther away. But, if you put in the time and effort, you can get into those roles that are paying higher salaries and provide more opportunity.

Restaurants are an amazing vehicle for entrepreneurship, where theoretically your income is limitless if you're able to start a restaurant, build a business, and open multiple locations. I think 8 out of 10 owners started in entry-level positions. To me, restaurants embody the American dream, and I still think that that's the case.

What types of restaurants? Let's talk about the Boston food scene specifically. What do we need more of, and what do we have too much of? Are there too many Italian restaurants and steakhouses?

I wouldn't look at it that way, in terms of what we have too much of. I think that, respectfully, that's a little bit of a slant that has injected some very negative and unnecessary pessimism and down talk about the Boston restaurant scene. People open what the market responds to. You know, there are a lot of Italian restaurants. There's a lot of Italian people and Italian culture that's rooted in Boston and the Northeast. That's how our cuisine has evolved. So having a lot of those things doesn't mean there's an oversaturation.

If people want more variety, they should continue to support and make it known that they crave that variety. I think there are a lot of operators who are responding to that. A lot of Southeast Asian cuisine has popped up over the years. I think you see a lot more Central and South American restaurants opening. You see a lot of Haitian cuisine, Caribbean-influenced food, so there is a lot of variety.

I just think in the downtown Boston market, there is this constant discussion around what's appropriate and how do you open a place given the capital investment that's required? If we want to see more variety in the immediate downtown area, the truth is it needs to be cheaper to open a restaurant.

GETTING SALTY

A prolific restaurateur shares how to make it in Boston hospitality



EMILY KAN

Restaurateur and hospitality professor Seth Gerber.

Who do you see taking real risks? Who do you admire?

I admire anybody who goes out and decides to open a restaurant. I mean, you're putting it all on the line, often personally guaranteeing a lease. So whether you're opening a burger restaurant or you're going for a more challenging concept with a cuisine that people aren't as familiar with, I respect anybody who puts themselves out there to take risks and be a business owner. It's extremely challenging, especially in Massachusetts, given the rent levels, what's required of you often as a renter, and how much risk you take in terms of exposure.

There's a lot that can go right, but there's a lot that can go wrong. I think we should make it less about, "Oh wow; you're doing such an amazing challenging concept!" It's easy to be a Monday morning quarterback and degrade somebody else's investment and business.

What restaurants, though, do you really admire? Can you name some specific people or specific places that you love?

I love what Jamie Bissonette has done. I still love Ken Oringer's restaurants, but I think Jamie and that group have broken out, and they focused on a smart strategy. Often their places have a smaller footprint; my assumption is, probably, the rent obligation is a little lower, and they've been able to bring in some really varied cuisine and put out some really great food. I think Zurito is killer. The restaurants that he's put together are really impressive.

Did you grow up working in restaurants? What was the beginning?

I grew up in southern Connecticut. I didn't grow up in the business, but my grandfather was a short-order cook in a diner. His hands were so tough he could pick up French fries directly from the fry-olator, and I had his grilled cheese press that we would use at home.

I just always had this legend of the short-order cook grandpa. A lot of my early childhood memories were around Jewish holidays but also around Italian food. My parents loved Italian food and traveling to Italy, so I was lucky to have some exposure there. I'd go home from school, and instead of watching cartoons, I would watch Emeril and Ming Tsai, and those were the people that I looked up to.

I was a pretty rebellious teenager. I didn't like the traditional academic path. I went to a private high school that was very competitive. I felt like I didn't fit in.

I had an opportunity to work in a really nice restaurant in New Haven, Connecticut, called Union League Cafe. The owners were best friends with Jacques Pepin, and Jacques would come in, and they would all drink wine and hang out.

I would cut bread and make coffee. I wasn't allowed in the dining room, but I loved the energy of the restaurant and the chaos. It became part of my identity. I liked the discipline and the intensity of it.

When it was time to apply for college, the guidance counselor was pressuring me to leverage athletics. I was the captain of my wrestling team. They wanted me to leverage that to try to get into the best possible school that I could, but I decided I really just wanted to focus on hospitality. I saw that BU had a hospitality school, and I decided to just go for it, and that was it. I never really looked back.

Why do you think some restaurants succeed and some don't? What do successful restaurants all have in common?

I think there are two parts. One is the product market fit, right? This is the conceptual component: Is what you're selling what the market wants, and do you deliver it in a cohesive way that's consistent with your branding and menu structure and style of service?

If what you're offering is not a good fit for the location and the marketplace and your target customers, you will not be successful. I've made that mistake. MIDA was that when we first opened. Our menu actually was different when we first started, and we changed it about six months in, and it saved the concept and led us to where we are today.

The second part is what happens before you open. If you sign the wrong lease and you mismanage the initial financial investment, where you overinvest in what you do to get the doors open, you will never be successful. Period. And those two things have to both happen. There have been lots of very well-regarded, well-executed restaurants that made the mistake of signing the wrong lease, paying too much for rent, or putting too much money into the initial buildout. It's very easy to overspend.

It's so hard to get the concept right because sometimes you just can't really know until you open the doors, but that's why it ties back into the initial investment. Often people spend 100 percent of their budget early on, and then they just don't have enough to weather the storm.

Where do you eat when you're spending your own money?

There's a taqueria in downtown Lynn called Tacos Lupita, which I think is really good. Pho Minh Ky is an insanely delicious pho restaurant. If I'm feeling summery in the North Shore, I go up to Essex. I love doing a day trip to Woodman's. If I want to grab a burger and a beer, I love the Indo in Beverly. That's a really cozy pub.

I truthfully love to find dive bars and places that are very off the beaten path that nobody would recommend in a million years. There's a ridiculously fun one called Cafe Buchanan, which is literally a trailer that's on the end of Eastern Ave. It's a true, proper, townie dive.

Interview was edited and condensed.

Kara Baskin can be reached at kara.baskin@globe.com. Follow her @kcbaskin.

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A fresh batch of restaurants to try this fall

►FALL PREVIEW
Continued from Page G1

BROOKLINE LUNCH SOUTHIE



BROOKLINE LUNCH

Beloved for its baklava pancakes and welcoming spirit, Brookline Lunch has been open for forever in Cambridge, run since 1988 by Jamal and Mawal Abu-Rubieh (above) with their seven children. Now the restaurant spreads its wings to South Boston, newly opened at the former L Street Diner space. The Cambridge menu folds diner favorites and the family’s Palestinian heritage together in a warm embrace. The still-evolving South Boston menu looks similar (yes, baklava pancakes are here). But there are some new dishes, too, including banana Biscoff pancakes, “Southie’s biggest” breakfast burrito, and labneh toast with Palestinian salad. The same family is bringing Brookline’s Busy Bee back to life. Affordable dining spots with delicious, singular, personal food and a friendly touch: Every neighborhood is hungry for this.

108 L St., South Boston, 617-315-7273, Instagram @blinesouthie



FWA CREATIVE

JUNI

In recent years, omakase restaurants have opened apace, serving chefs’ tasting menus of sushi, sashimi, and other Japanese-inspired fare. These meals are refined, pristine, and often attached to staggering price tags. As I sit at the latest counter, I wonder at the diners

around me: How can so many afford to spend this much on a meal, regularly enough to keep these restaurants open? Now, in Quincy, there is a new omakase arrival: Juni, a partnership between chef Chris Chung of Momi Nonmi and Kenny Leung of Tori Jiro. It makes omakase make sense. The tasting menu features 12 different seafood bites for \$69

per person. Eat at the casual restaurant (which doesn’t take reservations, but does offer add-ons like uni and wagyu for an extra charge), or get it to go in a beautiful box with separate compartments for each preparation. Anyone who has followed Chung from Uni to AKA Bistro to Momi Nonmi is familiar with his skill and knowledge. Juni puts that for-

ward in a package that recognizes the constrained budgets and desire to eat on the couch in PJs that are also very 2026, in tandem with our go-out-and-spend, eating-is-entertainment culture.

1211 Hancock St., Quincy, 617-516-3801, Instagram @juni-restaurant

PHAENG & PHIU



DANIELLE FARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Chef Veo Robert, who has worked at restaurants such as Radius, Menton, Myers + Chang, Bar Mezzana, and Foxglove Terrace, launched the pop-up Phaeng & Phiu last year. Named for his parents, it showcases the food of his native Laos. To eat it, one had to be in the right place at the right time: Phaeng & Phiu has popped up at restaurants such as Merai, Rubato, and Vee Vee. Now it is much easier to catch, in residence at Shore Leave in the South End until the end of the year, when the tiki bar will close. Come for a menu of goi pa (kingfish crudo), krapow gai dumplings, green papaya salad, grilled prawns, and more — and hope this is a prelude to a permanent space for Phaeng & Phiu. Boston’s Asian food scene grows ever richer, often through pop-ups like this one that give diners access to chef-driven food from Laos, the Philippines, Thailand, and beyond.

11 William E. Mullins Way, South End, Boston, www.phaengandphiu.com



JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

HAWKSMOOR

Boston loves a steakhouse, and now Boston has a new one to love. Hawksmoor opened this month. The buzzy British export serves up luxe cuts of beef, but also fish and chips, sticky toffee pudding, and Sunday roasts. The local twist: a crumpet, that quintessential teatime

griddle cake, piled high with lobster, drawn butter poured over it tableside. (Stay tuned, too, for the Lyons Group’s English alehouse-inspired Harry Hare’s, in the former Beacon Hill Pub space.) Support local, independent restaurants always. But Boston has become an attractive market for outside operators looking to expand, and expand they will continue to do.

So when one arrives with something of substance to offer in return — say, a well-run, well-conceived restaurant that’s more than just a clone, with enjoyable food and drink, that puts workers’ well-being toward the top of its manifesto — it’s worth recognizing.

15 Necco St., Fort Point, Boston, 781-208-8300, www.the-hawksmoor.com/us

CELINE

Portland, Maine, who? Montreal is Boston’s best dining suburb. Alas, we can’t always get there to explore the city’s restaurants. But a taste of Montreal is coming to us, in the form of Celine, a French Canadian-inspired restaurant opening Sept. 28 in Fort Point. It’s from the Coda Restaurant Group, behind Gufo, The Salty Pig, SRV, and the aforementioned Baleia. It’s been a while since the Boston area had a restaurant that paid explicit homage to cuisine from north of the border: Café du Pays, run by the Mamaleh’s team in Cambridge and closed by the pandemic, might have been the last. And it’s been a while since a restaurant occupied the space that was Ming Tsai’s Blue Dragon. It’s time: Come for salmon rillettes; chicken with chantrelles, gravy, and fries; cassoulet; and, of course, poutine, from one of the area’s most reliable restaurant groups.

324 A St., Fort Point, Boston, 617-936-4397, www.celineboston.com

KRI KRI GRILL



VIRGINIA NASH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Welcome to Chelmsford, a magnet for Boston’s top chefs, said no one yet. But Merrimack Valley, with its (very) relative affordability, is increasingly attractive to new real estate buyers and business owners. See: Kri Kri Grill, from chef (and Chelmsford native) Brendan Pelley, who opened the casual Greek restaurant after winning accolades at Xenia Hospitality Group properties including Bar Vlaho and Kaia. Add it to the likes of Big Al’s Pizza in Billerica, from chef Tim Maslow (Ribelle, Strip-T’s); Damgeuda, the Haverhill Korean restaurant from former Tasting Counter chefs; and Joanie’s Pizza, also in Chelmsford, from Craigie on Main alums — with more to come, I’ll wager. At Kri Kri Grill, the menu includes avgolemono, spiced lamb meatballs, gyros, and “Papou’s world famous spinach pie,” along with other classics. For dessert: Greek coffee ice cream, sour cherry-thyme sorbet, and Chelmsford ginger ale floats.

18 Boston Road, Suite 200, Chelmsford, 978-941-4884, www.krikrigrill.com

LIARS

It’s good to see Somervillains keep on Somervillaining, and here is Liars, from the people behind Davis Square’s longtime Spoke Wine Bar. In Teele Square, where True Bistro formerly operated, Liars is bigger than Spoke but preserves a similar spirit of extra-cleverness with influences from around the world. There is something interesting about each dish on the menu: fiddlehead fern chips and pecans, Coca Cola-braised chicken wing terrine, cold sesame-cashew broth somen, beef tongue with peppers and cheese (a tribute to the steak bomb), and more. The drink list follows suit. It’s always a sincere delight to see a new, independent, risk-taking restaurant open its doors. These days, I take it for granted exactly never.

1153 Broadway, Teele Square, Somerville, 617-718-0231, www.restaurantliars.com



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

RUBATO

This modern take on a traditional Hong Kong cafe has gained a serious following since opening four years ago in Quincy — and chef-owner Laurence Louie’s recent success as a “Top Chef” finalist only turned up the volume. It’s always a pleasure to come here for fried chicken bolo baos, rice rolls, and specials re-creating Louie’s TV meals. But it’s not always easy to slip in a visit before the spot closes at 4 p.m. Occasional Rubato @ Night events have been a hit, and they are about to become a way of life. Starting Oct. 9, Rubato will be open Wednesday through Sunday from 9 a.m. to 9 p.m. The menu is growing, too (and with greater attention to dietary restrictions). It will offer several variations on clay pot rice (“on a selfish level, I just want to be able to eat it all the time,” Louie says), buttery and with a crispy bottom, with toppings like cha siu, egg yolk, and Chinese greens. There will also be mapo tofu, a fried fish sandwich on a steamed chile crisp bao (McRubato, we’re here for it), black sesame custard HK French toast, and more.

412 Hancock St., Quincy, 617-481-2

MARZAE CELLAR + PROVISIONS

Inside Boston Public Market, this wine bar and retail shop proves Massachusetts can be a viable force in the world of natural wine. Owners Eliot Martin and Katie Luczai started their winery, Marzae, in Acton in 2023, using sustainable methods and Northeast grapes. Now we have a place to sample their handiwork, along with local, seasonal dishes from chef Jonathon Kirk. As I’ve said before and will probably say again: A strong local wine scene can inspire a strong local food scene, and vice versa. It’s good to see this symbiosis in action on the East Coast.

100 Hanover St., Downtown, Boston, www.marzaewine.com

Devra First can be reached at devra.first@globe.com. Follow her on Instagram @devra_first.

Local chefs show off flounders’ appeal

►**FLOUNDER**
Continued from Page G1
maintain an ecologically balanced population.

But oftentimes, McKiernan said, the harvest numbers for flounder don’t even come close to meeting the quota. It’s a self-perpetuating cycle: Consumer demand is low, so restaurants don’t buy flounder and its value drops. As a result, fishermen don’t fish a lot of it because they don’t make a profit — in fact, they can even lose money. That makes flounder’s availability inconsistent for restaurants, creating yet another reason why it rarely reaches their menus.

“A lot of times, when seafood has deep declines in availability, you can lose market share,” McKiernan said about flounder.

It’s a pendulum swing from flounder’s heyday around the 1990s. According to NOAA, stocks of summer flounder, a species that’s fished from Maine to the Carolinas, plummeted to record lows during that time. Populations have since rebounded substantially, thanks to improved reproduction rates and careful monitoring.

“I think some of these species, especially in the late ’90s and early 2000s, the stocks were considered overfished, and some of the quotas were dropped to low levels,” McKiernan said “I’m guessing at that time, the consumers and chefs moved on to put things on the menu that are more reliably sourced.”

That’s still evident today. Flounder regularly gets beat out by high-demand fish like haddock and cod, and by reliably available fish like farmed salmon. According to data from NOAA, only 27 percent and 32 percent of the yellowtail flounder and winter flounder quotas, respectively, were met in 2025, whereas 93 percent of the white hake quota was met and 183 percent of the Atlantic halibut quota was fished.

“When I first started fishing, which was early 1962, the predominant component of our catch was different species of flat-fish, generically known as flounder” says Frank Mirarchi, a long-time commercial fisherman based in Scituate. “Sixty years later, thereabouts, flounder has lost 50 percent of its value.”

He estimates (and McKiernan agrees) that nowadays flounder might not even account for 10 percent of what’s fished in this region.

Mirarchi also notes that, because of flounder’s anatomy and skeletal structure, it takes more time and effort to produce a saleable fillet compared to that for non-flatfish like haddock or cod. And that the labor pool to do that



DAVIO’S

Davio’s crab-stuffed local flounder with panko, creamy corn, and lemon butter sauce.



NAT AVENDANO GUARIN

kind of menial work is smaller, reducing the cost-benefit of fishing and processing flounder.

One more knock against flounder may be branding confusion. There are many different species including yellowtail flounder (also sold as yellowtail sole), winter flounder (also known as black-back flounder or lemon sole), witch flounder (also called gray sole), American plaice (also called dab), and summer flounder (also sold as fluke).

It all adds up to a much-needed reintroduction of flounder to consumers, says McKiernan, who’s launched similar seafood-boosting campaigns in the past.

“When I started back in the ’80s at DMF, it was a program to get people to consider eating squid by calling it calamari,” says McKiernan. The program was specifically promoting longfin squid, the type now often used in the popular fried appetizer.

On the restaurant side, local chefs are doing their part to show off its appeal.

“It’s a flavorful fish, I like that it’s super delicate,” says Sasha Coleman, executive chef at Comfort Kitchen in Dorchester.

Coleman recalls her uncle fishing flounder on Cape Cod when she was young and using them for fish fries. Here, she features it

in a crispy croquette, nodding to both her family’s cooking and the common preparation in Afro-diasporic cuisines. The fish is poached in dashi, rolled in cassava and fried, and dipped in a shi-to, a Ghanaian hot sauce with a fish oil base.

“A lot of cultures, especially in the Comfort Kitchen neighborhood, have a fish croquette or some type of fried fish fritter,” says Coleman. “I combined flavors from a few different cultures.”

In other restaurants, the fish will be served as a crudo, in lettuce wraps with tangy pickles, stuffed with crab, or plated over lobster mash and grilled vegetables.

The other participating chefs include Kevin Burselson (Straight Wharf Fish, Nantucket), Andrew Chadwick (The Chatham Bars Inn, Chatham), Andrea Pang (Sloane’s Tavern and the Miraval Berkshires Resort and Spa, Lenox), Josh Riazzi (The Black Whale, New Bedford), Rodney Murillo (Davio’s Northern Italian Restaurant, multiple locations), Robert Sisca (Bistro du Midi, Boston), Jeremy Sewall (Row 34, Boston), Will Gilson (Puritan Oyster Bar, Cambridge), and William Kovel (Catalyst Restaurant, Cambridge).

Though the flounder specials run only through the end of the month, the DMF hopes this will encourage restaurants and diners to indulge in more flounder year-round.

“The ideal outcome would be for many consumers, whether they be home chefs or restaurant goers, to opt for that fish or consider it among all the other seafood,” says McKiernan. “If we see an increased price paid per pound, it becomes more profitable for the fishermen and everybody wins.”

A restaurant relationship gone sour

►**BREAKUP**
Continued from Page G1

misunderstood.

I know what you’re thinking: What did I do wrong? It’s not one thing; not really. It’s more a series of tiny paper cuts. I owe you an explanation, so let me try here.

You dazzled me in the beginning, beguiling me with your sleek design and attentive service. I couldn’t believe I’d found someplace that seemed to understand me so well, from the soundtrack (Steely Dan!) to the menu (sauce flights!).

We seemed made for each other, and more than that: You really cared. You remembered my name. My favorite seat. When you told me about the specials, you looked me in the eye. When you suggested a dish, you were honest. Transparent. Vulnerable. There was a sense of trust.

You were really trying, and even the occasional missteps — a warm cocktail, a forgotten appetizer — were easy to overlook. They didn’t seem like red flags, just the normal wrinkles of a new relationship. I was enraptured.

So enraptured, in fact, that I was willing to go to great lengths to make the relationship work. Your parking was bad, but I didn’t mind circling the block a few times. You booked up 30 days in advance, so I’d sit at my laptop, ready to pounce, as soon as reservations opened. But, hey, you commanded respect. I felt special, chosen even, when you made space for me. And let’s be honest: You weren’t particularly kid-friendly, either, but that was OK. I would gladly steal away and get a baby sitter.

Why did I care so much? Because, each time I walked in, I felt special. I’d fantasize about how the evening would play out as I got ready: What I’d order; the mood; the vibe. Approaching you, my pulse would quicken. And, stepping inside, there was always a buzz in the air. You were crowded, effervescent, delighted to see me.

And, each time I left, I’d plot my return: When could I see you again? It was hard to stay away, and what started as an occasional visit turned into a comfortable routine. You were “my” place, and truth be told, I enjoyed showing you off. I took friends to you; co-workers. I recommended you to neighbors; I described your best table; your perfect dish. And then I’d listen — OK, maybe a bit jealously — when they described your evening together. But all was forgiven when you remembered my birthday.

Who can say when it all changed? There were small disappointments: a few beloved dishes, switched out. A favorite server, replaced by someone else who said all the same lines — about the drinks, the specials, how many dishes to order — but in a slightly different way. The large, glassy ice cubes, shining like diamonds in my margarita, were replaced by crushed pebbles, cold and raw as they slid down my throat. The thrill was gone.

But I kept coming back. I didn’t want to admit what I knew was true. You had changed. The staff was new. The menu was different. The original chef? On to new horizons, I think, though I didn’t have the heart to ask: I was probably afraid to know the truth.

I’m not blaming you. Restaurants evolve. And, you know what? I’d changed, too. I’m not blameless here, not by a long shot. My nights began to fill up, with kids’ sports and practices. I couldn’t drink the way I used to in my younger years, so your amazing cocktails started to feel lost on me. Time that I used to spend refreshing my Resy app was occupied with registering for summer camps and soccer. Keeping our connection alive began to feel like work, especially when you began to post constantly on Instagram in a voice I couldn’t quite recognize.

But every relationship has a final act, and ours is no different. It was a couple months ago. Do you remember? I’d come to you with friends, eager to show them what I loved about you. I’d talked up your variety; the creativity. I promised them that they’d love you, the way I once loved you. But as I convinced them, I wondered: Was I convincing myself, too?

When we arrived, nobody recognized us. When we were asked if we’d visited before, I nearly said no — that’s how unfamiliar you felt. When asked if we had any allergies, I winced. You’d forgotten everything I’d told you about the grapefruit. But still, we ordered, and I told myself: Everything will get back to normal as soon as we eat. Just be open-minded, even though the prices had crept up, too.

The dishes came out quickly and haphazardly, almost as if you couldn’t wait to get rid of us. Some of them were cold. The portions were smaller, too. Were you withholding part of yourself? I think so.

And, all the while, my phone was dinging. One kid wondered how to turn on the oven. Another one wanted more time on a gaming app. I was distracted, fatigued. But there was one spectacular seafood dish — a signature, one that always stayed on the menu — and, as usual, it was sublime. Maybe, maybe, we could make it work. But when you brought us the check without even asking about dessert, I knew it was really over.

Walking out, past the luminescent bar, I think I knew I’d never see you again. I turned over my shoulder, gazing at the clatter of happy diners, saying a silent farewell to a place where I no longer belonged. Some were probably discovering you for the first time. But my time here was over, and I knew it. I closed the door and stepped onto the sidewalk, a sidewalk I knew so well, for the last time.

Sometimes, I still drive by you and feel a pang. If it’s dark out, I glance inside your windows and see people inside where I used to sit, framed with the yellow-amber light that I loved so much. And I smile, wishing you the best.

I don’t want to destroy you with a Yelp! review. I am not bitter. You have talent and good intentions. You are a proud independent neighborhood restaurant with a point of view, and, for a long time, you were special to me.

But I think we want different things: You want to make money and turn over more tables. Who can blame you? And, at this stage of my life, I need comfort. My budget has changed; my appetites have, too.

It’s time for goodbye. I’m grateful for our time together, and no — there isn’t a new restaurant to take your place. Really! I’m still figuring out what I want. In the meantime, I promise I won’t tell anyone about that time you charged me twice for scallops. I’ll still follow you on social media. And I’ll still recommend you to other people, hoping that one of them loves you the way I used to.

Wistfully,
Your former regular
P.S. I think you still have a pair of my pink Goodr sunglasses. Could you mail them back to me?

Kara Baskin can be reached at kara.baskin@globe.com. Follow her @kcbaskin.

THE CONFIDENT COOK GOOD FOOD AND KITCHEN KNOW-HOW

Apples and pancake batter are the two components that go into this pretty French clafoutis

The French region of Limousin, famous for cherries and Limoges porcelain, popularized a dessert called clafoutis (kla-foo-TEE). Bakers made batter similar to what they would use for crepes and poured it over black cherries, their pits intact, in a baking dish. Clafoutis evolved to become a dessert with pitted cherries, and then with all kinds of other fruits, such as apples, pears, and plums. Technically a no-cherry clafoutis is a flaugnarde or flaugarde, writes French-trained pastry chef Wei Ling on her blog, “Baking Heritage.” Since the word is virtually unknown to American bakers, we’re using the name clafoutis here.

For this apple clafoutis, make a pancake batter and refrigerate it for at least half an hour (it will be fine for two days). Pour it over very thinly sliced apples and bake it until the edges are set and the apples are tender. It’s very simple, you need little skill, and the results are stunning. The right dish makes a difference to the presentation. Use a deep pie pan or a gratin dish with ears; the dish should be shallow enough, about 2 inches deep, so the apples aren’t buried by the batter and you can see the slices after baking. Add a sprinkle of confectioners’ sugar after you let it settle a bit. Serve warm with whipped cream.

SHERYL JULIAN

Apple Clafoutis

Serves 6

- Butter (for the dish)
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup whole milk
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- ¾ cup flour
- ½ teaspoon salt
- ¼ teaspoon baking powder
- ½ cup granulated sugar
- 3 medium baking apples (Cortland, Golden Delicious, Rome Beauty, Jonagold, Baldwin)
- Confectioners’ sugar (for sprinkling)



SHERYL JULIAN FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

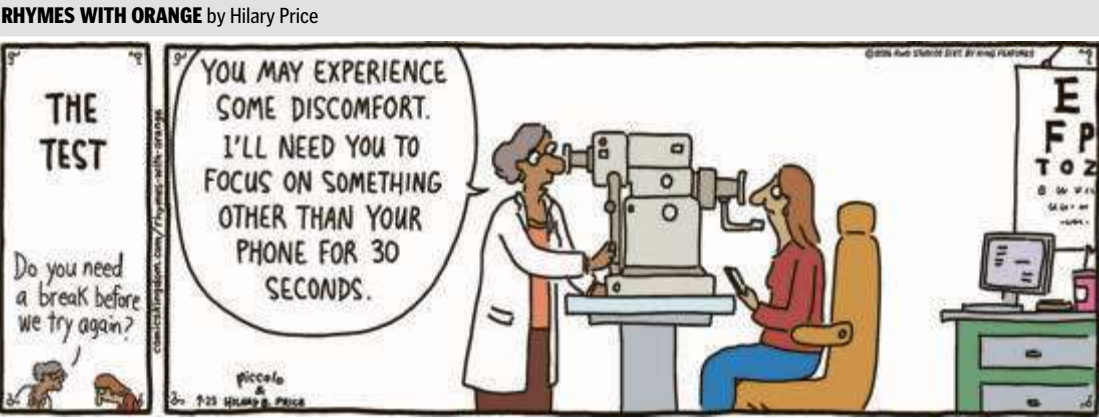
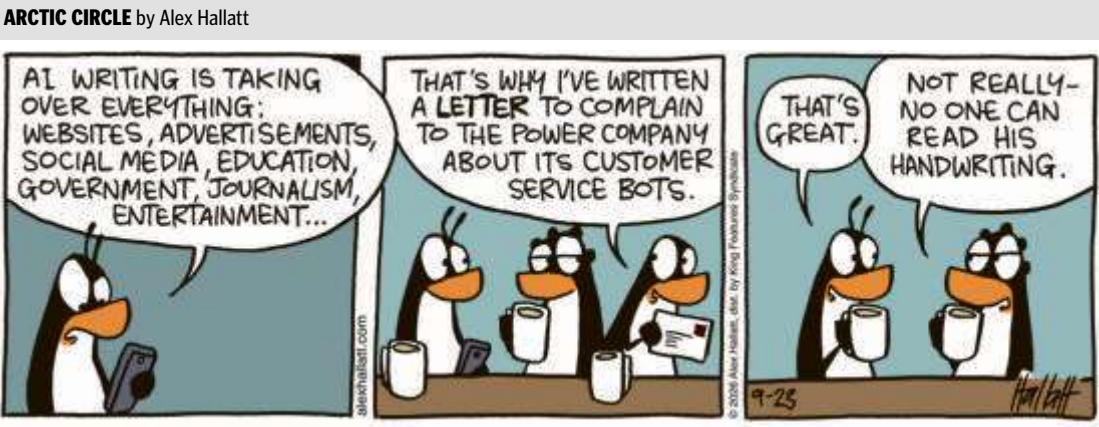
1. Generously butter a 10-inch baking dish or deep pie pan (2 inches deep).
2. In a bowl, whisk the eggs. Whisk in the milk and vanilla, then the flour. When the mixture is smooth, whisk in the salt, baking powder, and granulated sugar. Cover and refrigerate for at least 30 minutes or for up to 2 days.
3. Set the oven at 350 degrees.
4. Peel the apples and halve them through the core. Use the tip of a paring knife to remove the cores, keeping each half intact. Set the apples cut sides down on a cutting board. Holding the knife blade perpendicular to the core, slice 1 apple half thinly. Keeping the slices together, transfer them to the

- dish. Fan them slightly. Continue with the remaining 5 halves, setting them around the edge of the baking dish. Add one of the sliced halves to the center.
5. Whisk the batter until it is smooth. Pour it over and around the apples, letting it settle in an even layer.
6. Transfer the dish to the oven. Bake for 50 to 55 minutes, or until the batter is set at the edges and the apples are starting to brown. Let the dish settle and cool slightly for 15 minutes before serving. Sprinkle with confectioners’ sugar and spoon onto plates.

Sheryl Julian



You're a plugger if your legs are only tanned in the space between your compression hose and your shorts.

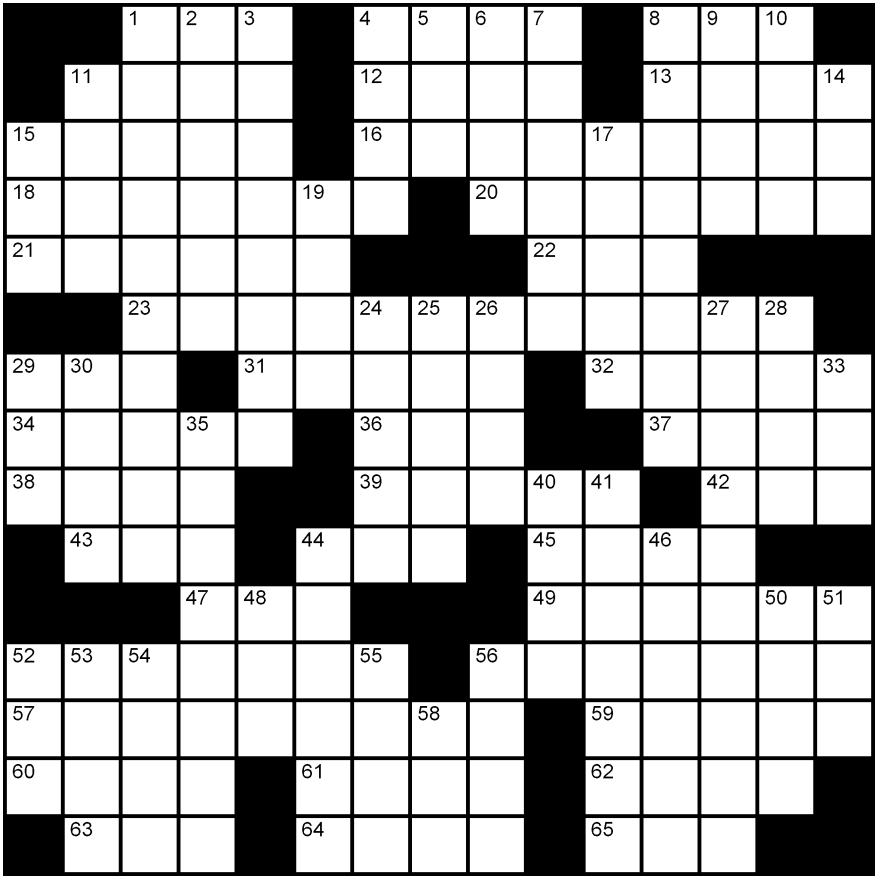


UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

STADIUM TOUR BY MATTHEW FAIELLA | EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG

- ACROSS**
- Deface
 - Light beams
 - Darien ____ (barrier between North and South America)
 - Land unit
 - Israeli airline
 - Skin care brand
 - Alarm status
 - Arena for Portland's WNBA team?
 - Politicians' attitudes
 - Unwilling to compromise
 - Missus, in Mexico
 - Hi-____ vest
 - Arena for Seattle's WNBA team?
 - Kimono sash
 - Rock for writing on, long ago
 - Less crazy
 - Animals with the strongest bite, for short
 - Cookie container
 - Exchange dollars for quarters?
 - "Starship Troopers" actress Meyer
 - Of a bygone era
 - Curly and Larry's pal
 - Baking amt.
 - Lead-in to "text" or "date"
 - "Jennifer's Body" writer Diablo
 - "That's so amazing!"
 - Hens' perches
 - Popular step trackers
 - Arena for Connecticut's WNBA team?

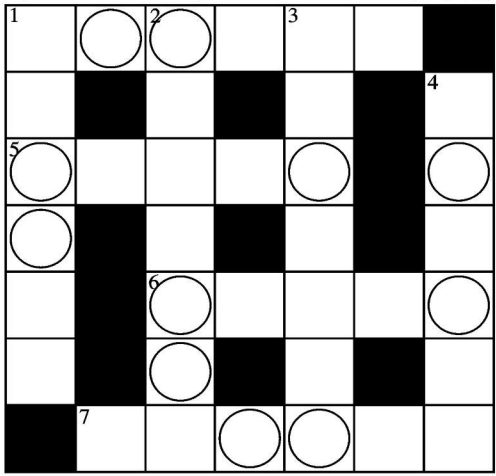
- Arena for Atlanta's WNBA team?
 - National flower of the Netherlands
 - The iconic MGM lion's was actually made by a tiger
 - Portent
 - Stone and Space, for two
 - Cybersecurity org.
 - "I'm finished helping this customer!"
 - Nod's meaning
- DOWN**
- Houses sometimes called "Garage Mahals"
 - "Am too!" response
 - Humanitarian organization
 - WNBA officials
 - Boxer Muhammad
 - One may be fenced in
 - Shirt feature
 - Part of a sheriff costume
 - "Woe is me!"
 - Marathoner's speed
 - Commedia dell'____ (early form of theater)
 - "Haven't Met You ____" (Michael Buble tune)
 - Stubborn animal
 - Tools for building sandcastles
 - Noble rank
 - Word before "key" or "league"
 - Like an overused joke
 - Group of goats



- KAOS agents, to Maxwell Smart
- Contractor's makeover, for short
- Psych. condition involving repetition
- Liverpudlian or Londoner
- GPS suggestion
- Largest living rodent
- Grayish-yellow
- 12:00 p.m.
- Introductory programming language
- Prescribed amount
- Objective
- Jettison
- Room in need of cleaning
- Longest-serving POTUS
- Anemic's need, usually
- Drinks at doll parties
- Not none
- Email folder
- Tex-____

JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

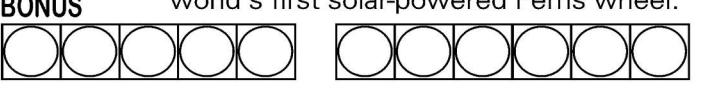
by David L. Hoyt 9-23-26



- CLUE**
- Front, exterior face
 - Sweet tropical fruit
 - Lively dance
 - Way
- ANSWER**
- FDAECA
NOAGM
MABSA
NANEMR

- CLUE**
- Extended ____
 - Rummy-style game
 - Entrance employee
 - Open-air market
- ANSWER**
- FLIMYA
NTCSAAA
DNOMRAO
ZRAAAB

CLUE: ____ Pier's Pacific Wheel was the world's first solar-powered Ferris wheel.



How to play

Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

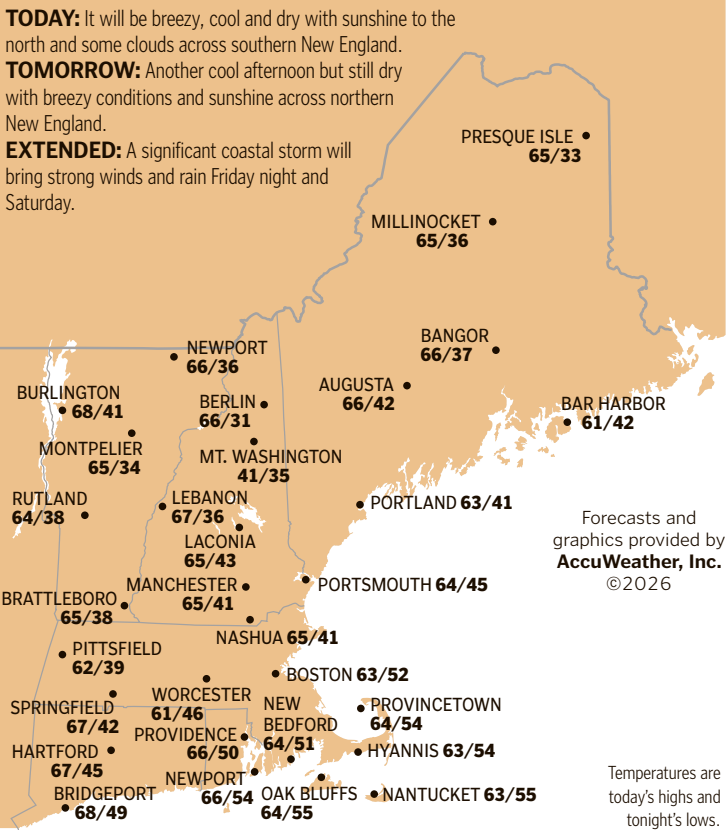
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ANSWERS: 1A-Facade 5A-Mango 6A-Samba 7A-Manner 1D-Family 2D-Caneado 3D-Doomman 4D-Bazaar 5D-Santa Monica
Send comments to DLHoyt@HoytInteractiveMedia.com

Boston's forecast

TODAY			THURSDAY			FRIDAY			SATURDAY			SUNDAY		
6 A.M.	NOON	6 P.M.	6 A.M.	NOON	6 P.M.	6 A.M.	NOON	6 P.M.	6 A.M.	NOON	6 P.M.	6 A.M.	NOON	6 P.M.
HIGH 61-66	Breezy with sunny spells. Winds NE		HIGH 60-65	A steady breeze with times of clouds and sun. Winds NE 10-20 mph. Partly cloudy at night. Winds NNE 8-16 mph.		HIGH 62-67	Breezy with a chance of rain. Winds NNE		HIGH 60-65	Windy with occasional rain. Winds NNE		HIGH 62-67	Chance for a bit of rain or drizzle. Winds NNE	
LOW 50-55	12-25 mph. Mainly clear tonight. Winds NE 8-16 mph.		LOW 52-57	12-25 mph. Mainly clear tonight. Winds NE 8-16 mph.		LOW 53-58	12-25 mph. Breezy at night with rain. Winds NNE 10-20 mph.		LOW 54-59	15-25 mph. Breezy at night with a chance of rain. Winds NNE 15-25 mph.		LOW 54-59	12-25 mph. A chance of rain at night. Winds NNE 10-20 mph.	

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New England



Cities

Travel delays possible, C Clouds, F Fog, H Haze, I Ice, Pc Partly Cloudy, R Rain, Sh Showers, S Sun, Sn Snow, Fl Flurries, T Thunderstorms, W Windy											
Today			Tomorrow			Today			Tomorrow		
● Atlanta	81/64	T 75/62	C	Los Angeles	88/67	S 84/68	S	Seattle	67/51	Pc 63/53	Sh
● Atlantic City	67/58	R 64/52	C	● Miami	85/76	T 90/76	T	● Washington	65/54	R 66/52	C
● Charlotte	68/58	T 65/51	C	New Orleans	94/77	S 91/76	Pc	● Beijing	90/67	Pc 77/66	T
Chicago	67/58	C 68/55	Pc	New York City	67/52	Pc 67/54	Pc	● Cancun	90/75	T 87/75	R
Dallas	96/75	S 95/72	Pc	Philadelphia	67/53	R 67/54	Pc	● Mexico City	78/56	Sh 79/55	Pc
● Denver	76/57	T 70/52	T	● Phoenix	95/78	T 97/78	T	● Montreal	67/44	S 70/48	S
● Detroit	65/54	Pc 69/49	S	Salt Lake City	78/56	S 81/62	S	Toronto	65/50	Pc 65/48	S
● Fort Myers	88/75	T 90/73	T	San Francisco	76/56	S 77/60	S	Vancouver	64/51	Pc 59/52	R

HOROSCOPES

HAPPY BIRTHDAY for Wednesday, Sept. 23, 2026: You are multitalented, charming, kind, and intellectually inquisitive. You're also energetic and resourceful. This is a year of service for you, perhaps service to family. Take care of yourself so that you can be a resource to those who turn to you for guidance, comfort, and courage.

ARIES (March 21-April 19) There's a Moon Alert all day, so restrict spending to food and gas, and postpone important decisions. However, you are the artisan of the zodiac, and a Moon Alert is an excellent time for socializing and making art! Tonight: Enjoy solitude.

TAURUS (April 20-May 20) The Moon is at the top of your chart today, which means people notice you, whether you're aware of this or not. In fact, some know personal details about your private life. Meanwhile, there's a Moon Alert all day! Avoid important decisions and shopping. Tonight: Be friendly.

GEMINI (May 21-June 20) This is a creative day for you!

Grab every chance to express your ideas and artistic talents. It's also a great day to socialize! Get out and enjoy sports events, fun diversions with friends, and playful activities with kids. Tonight: You're admired!

CANCER (June 21-July 22) There's a Moon Alert in effect all day, which means it's wise to restrict your spending to food and gas. In point of fact, this particular Moon Alert is taking place in one of your Money Houses, which means you'll be tempted to negotiate, borrow, or discuss how to share something. Caution! Tonight: Explore and learn.

LEO (July 23-Aug. 22) The Moon Alert all day is opposite your sign, which means communications with those who are closest to you — partners, spouses, and dear friends — are subject to misinterpretation. Don't volunteer for anything. Don't agree to anything important. Tonight: Check your finances.

VIRGO (Aug. 23-Sept. 22) Today's Moon Alert might create goofy mistakes at work along with delays and shortages, which might be a bit frustrating for you. Be aware of this and give

yourself extra time for wiggle room to deal with the unexpected. Tonight: Be cooperative.

LIBRA (Sept. 23-Oct. 22) This is a wonderful day to socialize and enjoy the company of others! The theater, the arts, sports events, and fun occasions will delight. There is a sense that anything can happen. Restrict your spending to food and gas because there is a Moon Alert all day. Tonight: Get better organized.

SCORPIO (Oct. 23-Nov. 21) Home and family are your focus today. However, you also might want to hide at home and relax among familiar surroundings. This might be a good idea, because this entire day is a Moon Alert. Restrict your spending and avoid important decisions. Tonight: Socialize!

SAGITTARIUS (Nov. 22-Dec. 21) This is a popular time for you and you're out there flying your colors talking to everyone! (Some of you are also dabbling in a secret love affair.) Meanwhile, this entire day is a Moon Alert, so be careful in your communications. Postpone important decisions and commitments. Tonight: Relax at home.

CAPRICORN (Dec. 22-Jan. 19) Be careful today. This entire day is a Moon Alert and it is taking place in your primary Money House. Do not be tempted to shop. Restrict your spending to food and gas. Commit to nothing financially; however, it's OK to window shop and do your homework. Tonight: Learn and discuss things.

AQUARIUS (Jan. 20-Feb. 18) This is a tricky day because there's a Moon Alert in effect all day and it's in your sign. In one way, it's a marvelous day to schmooze with others. You'll enjoy socializing. You'll also enjoy the arts and opportunities to be creative. But don't volunteer for anything. Restrict spending to food and gas. Tonight: Check your belongings.

PISCES (Feb. 19-March 20) Travel if possible, because you have a desire to expand your world and seek out new experiences. Competitive sports will also appeal. Meanwhile, this entire day is a Moon Alert. Keep your head down and your powder dry. Tonight: You win!

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SUDOKU

9	6			5			4	3
		5					2	
			1	2				
	2	9				6	8	
6								7
	7	1			4	3		
			4	7				
		8			3			
3	9			8		6	4	

Fill in the grid so that every row, every column, and every 3X3 box contains the digits 1 through 9. Puzzle difficulty levels: Easy on Monday and Tuesday, more difficult on Wednesday and Thursday, most difficult on Friday and Saturday. Tips and computer program at www.sudoku.com.

DAILY BRIDGE CLUB

BY FRANK STEWART
East dealer — E-W vulnerable

North

♠ K 3
♥ 10 8 7 5
♦ A Q
♣ K 10 9 8 5

East

♠ A J 9 2
♥ Q 3
♦ K 9 8 7
♣ A 7 4

South

♠ 6 5
♥ A J 9 6 4 2
♦ 10 4 3
♣ J 3

East

1 ♦
Dbl
All Pass

South

2 ♥
Pass

West

Pass
2 ♠

North

Pass
3 ♥

Opening lead — ♠ 7

"I fought the rules," a club player told me, "and the rules won."

"What happened?"

"You advise taking defensive 'rules' with a pinch of salt," he said, "but you do endorse one rule."

"The Rule of 11 helps on defense," I nodded.

My friend was today's East.

"Against three hearts, partner led the seven of spades, and dummy played low. I won with the jack and cashed the ace. Next I led the three of trumps. South took the ace and let the jack of clubs ride. I took the ace and cashed my high trump, but South won the rest, pitching diamonds on dummy's clubs. Making three. I shouldn't have fought the Rule of 11."

Assuming West's seven is his fourth-highest spade, East can subtract seven from 11. The remainder of four is the number of higher spades dummy, East and South hold. Since East can see all four, South doesn't have a spade higher than the seven.

East can play the deuce at Trick One. West will shift to a diamond, assuring five tricks for the defense.

DAILY QUESTION You hold: ♠ Q 10 8 7 4 ♥ K ♦ K J 6 5 2 ♣ Q 6 2. Your partner opens one diamond, and the next player bids two hearts, preemptive. West in today's deal passed with this hand. Do you agree?

ANSWER: West lacked the high-card values to bid two spades, but he could have made a negative double, promising spade length plus club length or diamond support. As it happened, West could have won at least nine tricks at spades. (He might also have bid more later.)

ZIPPY "Complaint Department" by Bill Griffith



BIZARRO by Wayno & Piraro



MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM by Mike Peters



ADAM@HOME by Rob Harrell



ROSE IS ROSE by Pat Brady & Don Wimmer



	S	E	A		I	X	E	N		V	S	N		
	S	E	G	V		N	E	W	O		R	V	O	R
A	S	I	V	D		E	M	O	H		V	E	R	D
T	O	D	S	N	U	S		S	L	I	B	E	I	F
S	L	S	O	O	R				A	V	A			
	A	O	D	C		E	R	P		D	S	T		
E	O	W		N	E	D	T	O			V	N	I	D
T	N	E	R		R	V	I		S	C	O	R	C	
R	E	N	V	S		E	L	V	T	S		I	B	O
	R	E	L	T	E	H	S	W	R	O	L	S		
		S	I	A				V	R	O	N	E	S	
T	E	S	D	V	E	D		S	E	C	N	V	I	S
E	C	V	T	P	E	R	I	F		D	E	M	R	V
A	V	T	O		T	A	T	E		E	R	C	V	
A	P	A	G		S	A	V	A		R	A	M		

Today's Sudoku Solution

4	9	5	1	8	2	7	6	3
2	7	3	6	9	5	8	4	1
6	1	8	7	3	4	9	5	2
5	3	4	9	2	6	1	7	8
7	2	6	5	1	8	4	3	9
1	8	9	4	7	3	6	2	5
9	5	7	2	6	1	3	8	4
8	6	2	3	4	9	5	1	7
3	4	1	8	5	7	2	9	6



CEMETERY CINEMA

A screening at last year's Cemetery Cinema.

Cemetery Cinema is back at Mount Auburn

By Daisy Levine
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Cinephiles are flocking to a less-than-traditional spot to see a movie: a cemetery.

Cemetery Cinema, an outdoor screening partnership with the Coolidge Corner Theatre and Mount Auburn Cemetery, is back in Cambridge this week with two films, “The Straight Story” and “Wings of Desire” on Wednesday night.

These aren't scary movies. And that's on purpose. The curators at the Coolidge are intentional about the films screened in a space like this, said Bree Harvey, vice president of cemetery and visitor services at Mount Auburn.

“It was really about introducing films in the cemetery setting that really were a reflection of the themes that you see in our landscape,” Harvey said. “[It's] a place that is thinking about your own mortality, contemplating the big questions that thinking about death often bring up for people.”

This year's double-feature was chosen around these ideas, rather than a glamorized image of death that one might equate to a cemetery, like a zombie movie, for instance. These films

CEMETERY CINEMA

Sept. 23. 7 p.m. Mount Auburn Cemetery, 580 Mount Auburn St. Cambridge. \$43.75. <https://coolidge.org/events/cemetery-cinema-straight-story-wings-desire>

invite the viewers to ponder one's own mortality.

“There's no shortage of films that can really thoughtfully approach the same themes that you would see in just a walk through the cemetery,” she said. “Movies can prompt those same questions.”

Harvey says she hopes Mount Auburn can be the environment where people find solace in defining what it means to be human.

For Mark Anastasio, the Coolidge's artistic director, the cemetery setting invites the cinema-goers to really appreciate the existential topics presented in the films.

“Being in a cemetery is a great place to take stock of where you're at in life, what your current relationships might be with people that you love, and just a reminder that our time here is not infinite,” he said. “If there is a regret that you have, or a connection that you're hoping to repair, there's no time like the present.”

Daisy Levine can be reached at daisy.levine@globe.com.

Q. After college, I moved to Chicago even though my parents wanted me to move back home. They live in a suburb outside of Indianapolis. It's fine for them but I wanted better career prospects and a social life that was different from what I had growing up.

I'm really happy here. It's been five years and I don't see any reason to move back.

Recently, I joined my parents on vacation at the lake, and they had what felt like an intervention for me. They and my aunt and uncle basically ambushed me at dinner and pointed out all these things that had changed about me. Each one of these things was an indication I was “losing myself.” Some of them were so silly, like I was letting my facial hair grow out and I once talked about a friend of mine and used “they” to refer to them (because they are non-binary).

They ended the meal by saying I had a lot to think about. I don't really know what to do with this.

CHANGED FOR THE BETTER

A. I'm not sure you do have a lot to think about. It sounds like they have a lot to think about, namely their acceptance and their expectations of you.

It's reasonable and understandable to be concerned about a young adult child, especially when that child is in a different city. And they may have been letting their anxieties get the best of them.

Try to hear the “note behind the note.” Is there something they want for you that you also want for yourself? If so, you may be able to find that without moving home, if you don't want to.

Recent sightings on Cape Cod (through Sept. 15) as reported to Mass Audubon.

The crested caracara continued at Duck Harbor in Wellfleet.

Late sightings of at least one swallow-tailed kite continued in Mashpee and Cotuit.

Birds at Race Point/Hatches Harbor in Provincetown included an American golden-plover, a buff-breasted sandpiper, a remarkable 16 stilt sandpipers, a pectoral sandpiper, 7 lesser black-backed gulls, 2 black terns, an Arctic tern, 250 roseate terns, 200 common terns, 27 Wilson's storm-petrels, 6 Cory's shearwaters, 3 great shearwaters, 11 Manx shearwaters, a pere-

ASKING ERIC

City-loving child faces family intervention

If you're curious, you might ask them to say more about what's really going on, encouraging them to stay away from surface details. Ask them if they feel your relationship with them has changed in ways that make them nervous.

If you were available enough to go on a lake vacation with just them and sit through an intervention dinner, it doesn't sound like you're neglecting them or your relationship with them. But it might be useful to poke around a bit to see if there's some unmet expectation.

Most importantly, remember that this is a growing time for them and for you. Some of that growth will happen in tandem; most will happen separately. Focus on maintaining your connection and be clear with yourself, and them, about what your goals are and how you aspire to walk through the world.

Q. I do ballroom dance and we dance with many different partners throughout the evening.

There is one gentleman that I dance with who likes to tell corny jokes. One of us will ask the other to dance, then he will invariably tell a corny joke or two before we begin dancing.

His latest was “What do attorneys wear to court? Lawsuits.” Corny.

I don't find the jokes funny, or even clever. I'm not sure why he tells me the jokes. I usually just smile or groan. I have never laughed or encouraged more.

I thought he would recognize that I wasn't enjoying them and stop, but that

hasn't happened. He seems oblivious to the fact. I'm sure he's this way with all the women that he dances with, not just me. I assume he's this way in life.

Is there a kind and polite way to tell this gentleman to stop telling me jokes? Or do I just continue to smile and groan since it seems like this is just the way he is? Why do people tell corny jokes at all? Is it anxiety or some need?

STOP THE JOKES, PLEASE

A. This may just be his way of breaking the ice, albeit one that's grating to you. For him, the annoying part of it may be part of the “charm.” There's a big audience for so-called “dad jokes.”

I'm mostly tempted to say just ignore it. You don't have to grin or smile, if you don't want to. You're there to dance and it's OK to keep your focus on that without offering a pity laugh to this man.

However, it's noteworthy that you wrote he's this way with all the women he dances with. He may consider this some kind of flirting and it's clear that, at least in your case, it's not welcome.

If these jokes are making you uncomfortable or you feel that there is a pressure to give him a smile, a laugh, or do some other kind of emotional maintenance, it might be helpful to address it head-on. You can say something simple like, “I'm not a ‘dad joke’ person and it takes me out of the experience. Next time, can we just enjoy dancing together?”

R. Eric Thomas can be reached at eric@askingeric.com.

BIRD SIGHTINGS

grine falcon, and a blue grosbeak.

Birds in Nauset Marsh in Eastham included 11 American oystercatchers, an American golden-plover, 300 semipalmated plovers, 19 Western sandpipers, and 15 lesser black-backed gulls.

At the south end of Monomoy National Wildlife Refuge, birds included 8 blue-winged teal, a Northern shoveler, 22 gadwall, 160 American black ducks, 3 green-winged teal, 8 ruddy ducks, 2 American coot, 4 pied-billed grebes, an American golden-plover, 3 red knots, and 22 lesser black-backed gulls.

Migrants along the Herring River in Wellfleet included a sora, an olive-sided fly-

catcher, a white-eyed vireo, a Philadelphia vireo, and a Cape May warbler.

Other sightings around the Cape included single little blue herons in Barnstable and Harwich, a Leach's storm-petrel off Chatham and 2 more in the bay off Barnstable, a golden-winged warbler at Fort Hill in Eastham, a summer tanager in Wellfleet, a white-throated sparrow in North Truro, and 11 red-necked phalaropes and a Leach's storm-petrel on Stellwagen Bank.

If you have questions or want to report a sighting, call the Wellfleet Bay Wildlife Sanctuary at 508-349-2615 or send e-mail to cape.sightings@massaudubon.org.

Wednesday September 23, 2026

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
2	WGBH PBS BBC News	R. Steves	Big Cats 24/7		NOVA "Knowledge Keepers"		Ages of Ice "Polar Seas" (N)		Amanpour and Company (N)	
4	WBZ CBS Wheel (N)	Jeopardy! (N)	Survivor "Permanent Uncertainty" (SP)		Big Brother "Episode 38" (N)		News (N)	(:35) Comics		
5	WCVB ABC News (N)	Chronicle	Who Wants to Be a Millionaire (N)		Who Wants to Be a Millionaire (N)		Shark Tank	NewsCenter 5 (N)	(:35) J. Kimmel	
6	WLNE ABC Videos		Whose	Whose	Whose	Whose	Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live		
7	WHDH Inside (N)	Extra (N)	Family Feud	Family Feud	7 News at 9PM (N)		7 News at 10PM (N)	7 News at 11PM (N)	Inside	
9	WMUR ABC Chronicle	News (N)	Million (N)		Million (N)		Shark Tank	News (N)	J.Kimmel	
10	NBC Boston NBC 10 Boston News at 7pm (N)		The Voice (N)		America's Got Talent "Finale Results" (SF) (Live)		America's Got Talent "Finale Results" (SF) (Live)	Boston News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)	
10	WJAR NBC News (Live)	Extra (N)	The Voice (N)		America's Got Talent "Finale Results" (SF) (Live)		America's Got Talent "Finale Results" (SF) (Live)	News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)	
11	WENH PBS Week-ends	Windows	Big Cats 24/7		NOVA "Knowledge Keepers" (N)		Ages of Ice "Polar Seas" (N)		Amanpour and Company (N)	
12	WPRI CBS Wheel (N)	Jeopardy! (N)	Survivor "Permanent Uncertainty" (SP)		Uncertainty" (N)		Big Brother "Episode 38" (N)	12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics	
25	WFXT FOX ET (N)	TMZ (N)	The Floor (N) (SP)		99 to Beat (N) (SP)		Boston 25 News at 10PM (N) (Live)	News (Live)	(:35) News (N)	
27	WUNI Rosa "Cintura de avispa"		Tan cerca de ti, nace el amor (N)		Tierra de amor y coraje (N)		Corazón de oro (N)	Noticias Univision	(:35) Noticiero	
36	WSBE PBS Milk Street TV	Mexican	Tim Janis: Our Natural World -- Returning to Earth		-- Visions of Italy, Southern Style				PBS News Hour	
38	WSBK Big Bang	Big Bang	WBZ News 8p (N)	Patriots 1st Down	Jeopardy!	Perfect (N)	Perfect (N)	Flip Side (N)	Flip Side (N)	
44	WGBX PBS Test Kitchen	Antiques	Whitstable Pearl "The Offer"		Dalglish		Sisi: Austrian Empress		PBS News Hour (N)	
50	WWJE Murder USA		Heartland Homicide		Killer Cases		Crime Stories		Unusual Suspects	
56	WLVI CW Young Sheldon	Young Sheldon	Police 24/7 "Food Fight"		Great "Gateway West" (N)		7 News at 10PM on CW56 (N)	Modern Family	Modern Family	
64	WNAC FOX Family Feud	Family Feud	The Floor (N) (SP)		99 to Beat (N) (SP)		12 News on Fox Pr (N)	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	
68	WBXP ION (:55) Blue Bloods "Samaritan"		Blue Bloods "Privilege"		Blue Bloods "Officer Down"		Blue Bloods "What You See"	Blue Bloods "Smack Attack"		
PREMIUM CABLE										
Cinemax	(:50) Lobster	(:50) On Becoming a Guinea Fowl ('24) Elizabeth Chisela, Susan Chardy.			Birds of Prey (and the Fantabulous Emancipation of O...		(:20) *** Joker ('19)		*** Joker ('19)	
Flix	(:6:20) *** The Prophecy ('95)		*** The Naked Gun: From the Files of Police Squad! ('88)		*** Jackass: The Movie ('02)		*** Jackass: Number Two ('06)			
HBO	(:6:40) Lanterns	(:40) Youth	(:05) Youth	(:40) Jay-Z in 8	(:20) Jay-Z in 8		*** Contagion ('11) Matt Damon, Marion Cotillard.	(:50) Youth		
HBO 2	(:20) A Killer Story "Person of Interest"		(:05) ★ The Strangers: Chapter 2 ('25) Madelaine Petsch.		(:45) Lanterns		(:40) Youth	(:10) *** Sicario ('15) Emily Blunt.		
Paramount-Sho	(:6:25) *** Smart People ('08)		★ Just Go With It ('11) Jennifer Aniston, Nicole Kidman, Adam Sandler.		★ He's Just Not That Into You ('09) Jennifer Aniston, Ben Affleck.					
Showtime 2	(:5:45) Terminator: Dark Fate		*** Blade Runner 2049 ('17) Harrison Ford, Ana de Armas, Ryan Gosling.		(:45) *** Patriot Games ('92) Armas, Ryan Gosling.		(:45) *** Anne Archer, Harrison Ford.			
Starz!	(:20) Turbulence ('25) Jeremy Irvine, Kelsey Grammer, Hera Hilmar.		★ ★ Michael ('26) Colman Domingo, Nia Long, Jaafar Jackson.				(:10) *** The Bourne Legacy ('12)			
TMC	(:5:55) Shakespeare in Love		Doin' It ('24) Sonia Dhillon Tully, Lilly Singh.		(:40) *** Young Adult ('11) Charlize Theron.		(:15) *** Life During Wartime			
SPORTS										
CBSSN	Inside College Football		NWSL Soccer				PWBA Bowling			
ESPN	MLB Baseball (N) (Live)						MLB Baseball Houston Astros at Seattle Mariners (N) (Live)			
ESPN2	NFL Live Marcus Spears		Football	LSU Football	Storyed Becoming Hines Ward		Florida State		Them Dawgs	
Fox Sports 1	Gronk & Jules	High Limit Racing Kokomo Speedway (N) (Live)			Suárez		All In: Indycar		High Limit Racing Kokomo Speedway	
Golf	(:6:00) Live from the Presidents Cup									
NBA	(:6:30) WNBA	Chasing	Stories		NBA Playback					
NBC Sports	(:6:30) Early Edition		Quick Snap	Tom Curran's	Quick Snap	Boston Sports (N) (Live)		Boston Sports		
NESN	David Ortiz: Welcome		Red Sox	Red Sox	Red Sox	Red Sox: On This Day				
FAMILY										
Cartoon	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty
Disney	Big City Greens	Big City Greens	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Place	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Kiff	Ladybug	Ladybug
Encore Family	(:6:30) Mistress of S...		(:05) The Ladybug		(:25) Oddball ('15) Alan Tudyk.				Pegasus: Pony With ...	
Nickelodeon	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang
Nick Jr.	PAWPatr...	PAWPatr...	PAWPatr...	PAWPatr...	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	PAWPatr...	PAWPatr...

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; TV-Y7 For children age 7 and older; TV-G General audience; TV-PG Parental guidance suggested; TV-14 May be unsuitable for children under 14; TV-MA Mature audience only Additional symbols: D Suggestive dialogue; FV Fantasy violence; L Strong language; S Sexual activity; V Violence; HD High-Definition; (CC) Close-Captioned

	News		Specials								
	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30	
BASIC CABLE											
A&E	Live PD: Police	Live PD: Police	Live PD: Police	Live PD: Police	Live PD: Police	Live PD: Police	Live PD: Police	Live PD: Police	(:05) Live PD	(:35) Live PD	
AMC	★★★ Ferris Bueller's Day Off ('86)					★★★ True Lies ('94) Arnold Schwarzenegger.					
Animal Planet	Naked and Afraid "Don't Cave In"		Naked and Afraid "Two Tarzans, One Jane"				Naked and Afraid "Twinning"				
BBC America	Movie	★★★★ The Shining ('80)		Shelley Duvall, Danny Lloyd, Jack Nicholson.			Terror: Devil (N) (P)				
BET	Celebrity Family Feud Dee Snider		Celebrity Fam. Jolo Siwa, Loni Love		The Oval "Agent Stan Bennett" (N)		All the Queen's Men "Trick Daddy" (N)	Martin	(:35) Martin		
Bravo	Housewives SLC "Chosen Family"		Real SLC "Après-Ski with Lisa B" (N)		Next Gen "Reunion Part 2" (N)		Watch What (N)	Housewives SLC "Après-Ski with Lisa B"			
CMT	Mama's	Mama's	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Gold Girls	Gold Girls	
CNN	OutFront	(Live)	Cooper 360		The Source With		CNN NewsNight	Laura	(Live)		
Comedy Central	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	The Daily Show (N)	(:35) South Pa..	
CSPAN	(6:00) U.S. House		C-SPAN Primetime				C-SPAN Primetime				
CSPAN2	(5:35) Se..		Public Affairs Events			Public Affairs Events			Public Affairs Events		
Dest. America	BBQ Pitmasters		BBQ Pitmasters		BBQ Pitmasters		BBQ Pitmasters		BBQ Pitmasters		
Discovery	How to Catch		How to Catch		How to Catch		Dirtbag (N) (SF)		How to Catch		
Discovery Life	(6:00) My 600-Lb		My 600-Lb. Life "Shakyla's Journey"				My 600-Lb. Life "Krystal's Journey"				
E!	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	National Lampoon's Christmas Vacation				
Encore	(:10) ★★ Jack Ryan:		Shadow Recruit ('14)		★★★ Minority Report ('02) Tom Cruise.			Looper			
Food	Grocery "Friend or Foe"		Grocery "Bad to the Bacon"		Grocery "Masters of Cheese"			Grocery "Red, White, and Food"			
Fox News	Ingraham (Live)		Jesse (N) (Live)		Hannity (Live)		Gutfeld!	Fox News (Live)			
Freeform	(6:30) ★★ Toy Story 3 ('10) Tom Hanks.				(55) ★★ Toy Story 4 ('19) Tom Hanks.			The 700 Club			
FUSE	The Beatles: In the Life			Killing John Lennon			Cheaters Cheaters		Cheaters	Cheaters	
FX	(5:30) Captain Marvel		★★★ Captain America: Civil War ('16) Robert Downey Jr., Chris Evans.				Movie				
FXM	(:10) ★★ Bringing Down the House ('03)				(:05) ★ John Tucker Must Die ('06)			Bringing Down the ...			
Hallmark	(6:00) Absolutely De...		Haul Out the Halloween ('25)				Gold Girls Gold Girls		Gold Girls Gold Girls		
Hallmark Myst.	(6:00) Hello, It's Me		Hailey Dean Mysteries: A Marriage Made fo...				Murder, She Wrote		Murder, She Wrote		
HGTV	House Hunters		House Hunters	House Hunters	Totally '90s House (N)		Botched Homes (N)		House Hunters	House Hunters	
History	Pawn Stars "The Mad Pawn"		Pawn Stars "Siegfried and Rick"		Pawn Stars "From Page to Pawn" (N)		(:05) Pawn Stars: Best Of (N)		(:05) Pawn Stars		
HLN	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	
HSN	Perlier Beauty		Heidi Daus Jewelry		Beauty Report (N)		Beauty Re (N) (Live)		Perlier Beauty		
ID	Monster "Friends Outside of Work"		American Monster "Weight Control"		To Be Announced		To Be Announced		American Monster "Double Take"		
IFC	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	
Lifetime	Rizzoli & Isles		Rizzoli & Isles		Rizzoli & Isles		(:05) Rizzoli & Isles		(:05) Rizzoli & Isles		
LMN	(6:00) Secrets on Gr...		Killing All My Sisters ('24)				Secret Life of a Sorority Girl ('24)				
MAGN	Maine		Maine		Maine		Maine		Maine		
MSNBC	The Weeknight		All in (Live)		Briefing (Live)		Last Word (Live)		The 11th (Live)		
MTV	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	
National Geographic	Catch a Smuggler "Sewn-in Stash"		Catch a Smuggler "Cocaine Cop"		Catch a Smuggler "Cocaine CEO"		Catch a Smuggler "Sneaky Seniors"		Catch a Smuggler "Cocaine Carnival"		
NatGeoWild	Zoo: Tampa		Zoo: Tampa		Zoo: Tampa		Zoo: Tampa		Zoo: Tampa		
NECN	News	News	Dateline		Dateline		Rescue OpenHou..		1st Look Rescue		
NewsNation	Vargas Report (N)		Cuomo		On Balance		Katie Pavlich		Jesse Web		
Ovation	Hudson & Rex		Hudson & Rex		Blue Skies		Hudson & Rex		Hudson & Rex		
OWN	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	
Oxygen	Dateline: Secrets		Dateline: Secrets		Dateline: Secrets		Real Murders		Dateline: Secrets		
Paramount	(6:00) ★★ The Hangover			★★ The Hangover Part II ('11) Bradley Cooper.			Hangover Part III				
QVC	Kitchen (N) (Live)		Kitchen (N) (Live)		Countdown to Christmas Sale (N) (Live)						
Science	Catastrophes		Catastrophes		Catastrophes		Catastrophes		Catastrophes		
Sundance	Law & Order "Savior"		Law & Order "Deceit"		Law & Order "Atonement"		Law & Order "Slave"		Law & Order "Griffhinds"		
SyFy	★★★ The Hunger Games ('12) Jennifer Lawrence.						The Ark (N)		The Forever Purge		
TBS	Big Bang		Big Bang		Wrestling AEW Dynamite (Live)		Collision Charleston		Collision Office		
TCM	(5:45) Mrs. Miniver		Chuck Amuck: The Movie				★★★ Gay Purr-ee ('62)		Looney		
TLC	ER: Ca.		ER: Ca.		ER: Ca. (N)		Clinic (N)		1000-lb Roomies		
TNT	Movie		★★★★ Jumanji: Welcome to the Jungle ('17)				★★★★ Jumanji: Welcome to the Jungle				
Travel	Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		
TruTV	Foul Play		★★★★ Rudy ('93) Ned Beatty, Sean Astin.				★★★★ Rudy ('93) Ned Beatty, Sean Astin.				
TV Land	Raymond		Raymond		Raymond (:20) Raymond		Raymond Raymond		King	King	
TV One	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	Jeffersons	
USA	9-1-1 "Don't Drink the Water"		WNBA Basketball Atlanta Dream at New York Liberty (Live)				WNBA Basketball Dallas Wings at Seattle Storm (Live)				
VH-1	Chris (N) Chris (N)		★★★★ Love & Basketball Omar Epps, Sanaa Lathan.					★★ Bring It On			
WE	NCIS "Once a Hero"		NCIS		NCIS "Smoked"		NCIS "Driven"		NCIS "Suspicion"		